

DE PROFUNDIS

Sessions 1-4

July 4, 2026 - July 31, 2026

August 10, 1968 - August 13, 1968

Cast:



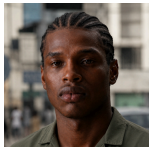
Handler — POTUS47th



MSG Cillian F. MacAllister —
Q.E.



IA Bryan Carlyle — S.L.



SSG Michael Giles — K.G.



SSG Nuair A. al-Attar — X.A.



SA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois
— L.E.

DE PROFUNDIS SESSION 1

July 4, 2026

August 10, 1968

Chandu: *CHAPTER III - DE PROFUNDIS "Out of the depths I have cried to Thee, O Lord."*

Chandu: *AUG 10 1968, 1700C Istanbul BNDD Offices, Turkey*

Chandu: *Fontaine.*

Chandu: *It's your seventh week in the BNDD offices in Istanbul. The rest of the team has been out and about since their arrival to the city a few days ago, mostly on document runs as they get settled into their new posts-- and their new career tracks, as you've come to learn.*

Chandu: *Your promotion came at a cost. After the meeting in Saigon and your transfer to Istanbul, you spent the first three weeks in talks with men with CIA and DIA credentials, all cluing you into your new place in the highly secretive Program.*

Chandu: *Your personal, shorter version of it: you're expected to remain ready for sudden retaskings, as well as to abuse your authority, adulterate official documents, misuse and misappropriate BNDD assets and protocols, kill extrajudicially, et cetera-- all in the effort of destroying and burying that which should not exist, and ensuring that the rest of the world remains none the wiser while you're at it.*

Chandu: *All at your own expense, if necessary.*

Chandu: *You agreed. How could you have not? You're here. How do you feel?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: *Well, for one -- fuck everything I stood for. If learning about the unnatural breaks the conception of the world for just about everyone, it did so for me twofold. Between my reassignment to Istanbul, the introduction to 'DELTA GREEN', and whatever I've been occupying myself with in the last couple days, I'm trying to grip my head around the future ahead of me. I know it'll only get worse.*

Chandu: *"Don't jinx it", you think to yourself.*

Chandu: *A sealed brown envelope with a small green triangle marking on its top right corner is sitting on your desk. It came from D.C., and it begs to be opened.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I give the room a glance to make sure nobody's gonna come in at the most inopportune moment before I peel it open.

Chandu: *There's about fifteen people here, all minding their own business or chatting around the water cooler. You're in the clear.*

Chandu: *You rip the seal and reveal its contents.*

Chandu: *A seemingly unrelated assortment of papers. A page from an archaeological journal, a death notice cutout from the London Times, and a map of Eastern Anatolia.*

Chandu: *A red circle is drawn over a specific spot in the drylands to the northeast of Diyarbakir.*

Chandu: *There are no instructions nor further information. What do you make of it?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Nothing on this is overtly unnatural, I should be in the clear to seal the letter back up. I'll keep it on me until I get to show the others.

Chandu: *So you do. The guys will probably see it tomorrow morning.*

Chandu: *AUG 11 1968, 1000C*

Chandu: *All of you are in the office now. Has anyone made any guesses as to what the papers in the envelope could mean so far? Maybe over a talk by the water cooler or breakfast.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: The end of our little vacation.

SA Michael Giles: We gotta check it out and investigate the site and the death of the archeologist.

SA Michael Giles: Then put a stop to whatever caused it.

SA Michael Giles: Simple as.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Someone saw something odd and died for their trouble? A-Cell clearly know more than us and it'd be nice for them to communicate that knowledge in plain fucking English for a change.

SA Michael Giles: This is as plain as it gets.

SA Michael Giles: For A-Cell.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Doubt they know that much more than us. All of this is public information -- that's something we could've gotten on our own if we knew what to look for.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Well, Whiteman obviously got murdered. Or he killed himself. It wasn't an accident.

Chandu: *As you speculate...*

Chandu: *The door comes open, and a woman walks across the office-- not one of the secretaries.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This is immature as hell. If these people want to fire me from the military to make sure I work for them the rest of my life they better fucking face up to it.

SA Michael Giles: This bitch again.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She snaps her fingers twice as she walks past your desks and heads into meeting room No. 2.

SA Bryan Carlyle: I audibly groan.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Boys. You look refreshed."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I was just on my way out."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Who are you again?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She ignores the remarks and upnods at Fontaine. "Did you get my mail?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt wipes the sweat that's accumulated on his forehead with a napkin. "I have."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Great. We're back in the saddle." She draws a pack of Marlboro 100's from her pocket and proceeds to light up.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "While you gentlemen worked on your police credentials, I tied up a few loose ends and read Charrière's journal from top to bottom. Bad news first: it's all real, there's bigger fish up the ladder, and we've got nothing pointing toward the rest of the Order's whereabouts. So, we're shit out of luck on that front."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "It's not all bad." She adjusts her glasses. "We know more about Charrière-- he had effectively taken over what was left of the Kuen-Yuin network in Saigon. What he was building it around looked like necromancy, experimental genetics, and surgical enhancement. That is the best plain-English description for that madness."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "...There's also the matter with Dr. Frank. Stillman is apprised and stateside assets are working it. You'll hear about it as it develops, but not today."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Any questions before we begin?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Why do you talk so damn fast?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She breathes in deeply and exhales slowly.

SA Michael Giles: "She's got a hot date scheduled, can't you tell?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I do, it cost a pretty penny." He jabs his shoulder with his elbow.

SA Michael Giles: "Boy you best get a refund on that cause that's a noooooo shoooooww."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Do we know that any of this even relates to what happened over there? We crossed the damn Pacific for crying out loud, for all we know we could have killed everyone involved in this plot already."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan watches the two with a smile.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Who fucking knows? Our last lead died with Antonio Gomes."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "But enough talk about ALONSO, it's time to get to work."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Baww waww...", he does his best imitation of a foghorn.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Well they seemed pretty sure that we ought to be in Turkey, of all places."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That was my decision. It's nice out here, isn't it?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You get to grow your hair out. Maybe a mustache and beard."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Anyway..."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "You're withholding information from us."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Whatever."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Alright. You're all going to be flying out east. There's our little friends smuggling heroin through Turkey. There's also that dead archaeologist, Charles Whiteman--passed away in Bozukepe, a site just about a hundred miles from the city by road."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "We have a legitimate reason for showing up. We know Turkish heroin is moving into Europe. We're aware that there's a route for product that passes through Kurdish territories, then it is exported by ship to Germany and France. What we don't know is the cover they're using to move the merchandise."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You'll base yourselves out of Diyarbakir Air Station. Officially, you're going to track and monitor heroin smuggling routes in the area and work out how they're getting it out of the country."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Now, the Program's interest here is in the death of Mr. Whiteman." She puffs on her cigarette.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Some of his earlier reports from the dig at Bozukepe got flagged by our ARCHINT analysts as hinting at possible unnatural connotations, though they never crossed the threshold for a detailed investigation."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What analysts?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "D.C. people. Do you want their driver's licenses?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "No I mean what was that word you just said."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Anthropomancy. Divination by entrails."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Get the fuck outta heeere."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Ah." She taps her head. "Archaeological intelligence. It's what they did at that Khmer temple during ROUNDUP, for example."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Archaeological intelligence. Really. This chick, man..." He facepalms.

SA Michael Giles: "Ain't no fucking way you know what that word means Nolan."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Point is, it got bogged down in bureaucracy. Please be quiet-- I'm trying not to fling a chair over the desk right now."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I just told you what it means."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "How the hell do you distinguish an unnatural dig site from a plain old temple or something anyway?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Gut feeling?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That's what I'm getting at." She pauses. "The dead man vanished on his way back to England. We don't know whether someone's stolen his body, whether Whiteman faked his own death, or whether there's a cover-up going on. I've got a hunch it's worth looking into, and the best place to start is where he died."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Whether you throw objects at us or not won't change the fact that we have been picked to do the job. What I don't get is why we don't get a headstart via informants."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We can't pull that infiltration shit again."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "That makes me wonder. Is it just us at the Air Station? Will we meet anyone else with the group as part of this mission?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "We'll get to your support later."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "The body was driven to Diyarbakir and flown to Istanbul. It was supposed to go from Istanbul to London, but disappeared somewhere along the way."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I know you're going to ask-- Whiteman was a British citizen, credentialed through the British Institute of Archaeology in Ankara."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Luckily for us, he was partially funded by a grant from the US National Science Foundation. It's a shit justification for a bunch of feds to go investigate his death, but it's enough for a BNDD tasking to go and ask some questions. You're likely to face friction, so it is key to avoid unnecessarily involving local authorities."

SA Michael Giles: "I heard they reliably take bribes here."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That's a way to go about it."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Our contact in Diyarbakir is USAF Captain Kurt Campbell. He's uh..." She crosses her arms. "Used to be read into the Program, had a lateral career move. Still dependable."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yeah, while we're at it we can use her as a bribe and pocket the op cash."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He laughs.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Continuing. I've already spoken with him. He'll give you a hand and knows enough not to be surprised."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan checks her reaction.

Chandu: *Roll HUMINT.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: SA Nolan A. al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 62 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 30%)

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She's veritably annoyed.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Any real questions now?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What do you mean used to be read into the Program."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "He was on the payroll, now he's not. We don't get into their business, they don't get in ours."

Chandu: *Roll HUMINT, Mac.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Lateral? Did he get into another clearance?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Can I?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 1 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Sure.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Success** -> 51 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 60%)

Chandu: *You both can tell that she's uncomfortable talking about this specific topic.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Damn is that it for a 1

Chandu: *No-- she's more than uncomfortable. She's dancing around the topic, and the wild thought comes to your mind that it might be somehow, if faintly, related to that "Dr. Frank" situation back in the States.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I think you just slipped a bit too hard."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 77 (Rolling POW Target: 40%)

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Have you, uh..."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Are you familiar with the Roswell incident?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "What?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Am I? Is she talking about fucking aliens?

Chandu: *She's talking about THE ONE incident in that bumfuck nowhere.*

Chandu: *It was on the news!*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You gotta be kidding me."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "This whole thing stinks. I'd believe in God before I believe we were sent here, the perfect place to chase up this spontaneous lead about the folk we were fighting in Vietnam, without any prior knowledge from the higher ups."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Can you shut up for a second."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What did you just say about Roswell?"

SA Michael Giles: "You mean the flying saucer shit? I thought that was a B-flick."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Yeah yeah."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "No. The Air Force is still, to this day, conducting research on material recovered from the site, as well as several others that fall in the same ballpark."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Well, part of the Air Force." She coughs. "Remember when I said that the Program is not the only agency of its kind?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "These are the same people Charrière was corresponding with through Frank. He's a nobody on his own, of course-- but he works through grants."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "We've been following the paper trail and we're about ready to take him out in D.C." She wipes a drop of sweat off her brow. "This doesn't leave the room, of course."

Chandu: *Everyone: you just pretty much got confirmation that aliens are real. Hit the SANLOSS macro.*

Chandu: *No need to put it on private, it's automatic.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "This is nuts. If news of this get back here before we are done we are dead meat."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't care what you say about this anymore. If they seem to be a threat he's going back to the states in a coffin."

Chandu: *What's more: the United States government is in some way involved. You all take the revelation pretty well; be it denial, hopeful thinking, or sheer bafflement. But you'll be thinking about this one whenever you see a bright light in the sky.*

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "As always, government agencies aren't hiveminds. Get whatever assistance you can from Campbell, just don't get in the way of him looking for bullshit saucers over the USSR."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Our relationship is amicable enough."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Anything else?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It feels so reassuring to be on the wrong side of this conflict with an annoying bossy bitch."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "They study it, we try to destroy it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Guess who's going to win in the end?"

SA Michael Giles: "You did destroy that mask."

SA Michael Giles: "Don't be a hypocrite."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Beats me. We're here to do our jobs."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "And they have alien technology. They'll turn you into a chicken that glows green the next time."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "On that topic."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I haven't said a word about it since we last saw each other in June, but Saigon was an absolute cover-up nightmare. You did well in the moment, and believe me when I tell you that I commend it, though it didn't seem like it at the moment. But the fact remains that we are blind and reaching for straws to hunt A-M down."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I put my ass on the line for your sake and protected you. You weren't the ones sitting alone across a table with the Executive Committee, getting dressed down for ALONSO's exposure. Stillman thinks I'm fucking stupid for not throwing you overboard."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I've made narcotics agents out of you and put enough paper between you and Saigon to keep you out of an underground black site. I expect you to remember the favor."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "We don't need to be on the news, nor do we need any of you dead or arrested. Understood?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Jesus, you still think that it's you who goes out there to do all this crap. Did you really think I was okay with tracking down that negro back in his man cave and risk getting chewed down by another fucking lizard monster?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You did well. That's not the point."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Your presence here should be proof of my appreciation for you."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "I doubt they'll let us infiltrate another drug ring so this feels a little otiose."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh I'm so glad and grateful for our queen so high above us."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Are you happy?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She chuckles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Jesus fucking Christ. I can't take another second of this. Let's just get it done."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I've gone ahead and gotten you tickets." She slides a paper envelope across the table.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You'll be there by midday."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Anything comes up, I'll be in Istanbul for three days. Use the air station's telex machine to get in contact."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "And good luck."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "In through one ear and out the other." Unfortunately killing her can't save us from this psycho skank, so we have no other option.

Chandu: *A few hours later...*

Task Force MARTEL: *EASTERN ANATOLIA Diyarbakir Air Station, 1300C*

Chandu: *Diyarbakir Air Station is in essence a large radar station. The listening posts are two huge radar arrays monitoring objects in flight and in space over the Soviet Union; radio dishes listen to whispered radio traffic across the Caucasus. The radar array rises like a spectral monolith over the drylands around the base.*

Chandu: *Security is intense. You've been asked to show your badges and papers twice since the moment you stepped out of the plane, but as long as you stay in the barracks and offices areas and away from the listening post, it won't get too bad.*

Chandu: *You know where Bozuktepe is-- you only lack a method of transportation. You can act now.*

SA Michael Giles: Is there a BNDD office room/building?

Chandu: *Fuck no. This is all USAF.*

Chandu: *Your contact is somewhere here, though.*

SA Michael Giles: How far is the Bozuktepe site?

SA Michael Giles: In terms of hours of driving.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Maybe Kurt the Slave can help us hitch a ride.

Chandu: *About 100 miles to the northeast-- a drive through the country should take about two hours.*

SA Michael Giles: We should just fenagle a Jeep and head out immediately.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm still reeling from the fact that a) aliens are real and being studied by the USAF and b) our case officer is a no joke genuine psychopath. I'm mentally sidetracked from this whole shit.

SA Michael Giles: Giles is up for this task.

SA Michael Giles: In the words of hood wisdom: "Bitches be tripping."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aliens aren't the craziest thing I've heard of by now.

SA Michael Giles: Don't worry about it.

Chandu: *As you head over to the motor pool, a couple of airmen in a Jeep approach the group. They inform you that Captain Campbell's been notified of your arrival and they'll happily take you over to the office complex for a chat.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This was inevitable. We're not on home territory.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Let's just get it over with.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Hot as a motherfucker in here."

SA Michael Giles: "Eh."

Chandu: *You're led to a conference room in the air-conditioned office complex. It's nice indoors, and you don't have to wait more than three minutes for your man to walk in.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt's kept his sweat napkin close the entire time. "This whole country is."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Gentlemen, Kurt Campbell," he says, nodding at each of you as he walks around the table giving out firm handshakes, introducing himself.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: He takes his seat. "What can I do for you?"

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Boys told me you were on your way to the motor pool. We can certainly part with a Jeep or two."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He sucks in air through his teeth and then blows it back out slowly.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Anything more civilian, you'd have to buy yourselves."

Chandu: *I FORGOT TO MENTION THIS:YOUR OPERATIONAL BUDGET IS \$3000 1968 AMERICAN DOLLARS.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Have you heard of what happened to that Brit nearby, captain?"

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Our friend in common told me a little about it after the fact." He strokes his jaw. "Only then did I realize. A truck came here from the site with the coffin, more Englishmen with it."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Credentials were legitimate. We flew the coffin over to Adana."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "That's the extent of our participation in the affair. They were supposed to fly out to Istanbul, if I recall correctly-- and I did check the records after Marty rang. It got to Istanbul."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm going to interrupt any questions about this towards him- we can not make him think this is an interrogation.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We can do our own homework.

SA Michael Giles: Best not to mention the aliens.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Marty?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "You remember what they were posing as to get through here?"

Capt. Kurt Campbell: He nods. "Ruth. We go back."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh yeah, probably wasn't called Satan back then."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He laughs.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: He reciprocates the laugh, adjusting his eyeglasses, then turning to Carlyle. "Not posing, in my opinion. British Institute of Archaeology."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "It wouldn't surprise me if they were in on it, but I digress."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yes, let me make it clear though. This is about third country nationals, I'm sure Adana side will say the same about passing it over to Istanbul."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Most likely you'll get the same result as I if you went over to the airport there. We asked to read a few records and they gave us no trouble."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "It's a fact that the coffin got to Istanbul."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "After Istanbul..." He shrugs. "Poof."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I genuinely am not doubting what he says. This sounds like an incredibly bad thing to be responsible for from a green army man standpoint. Plus, any kind of serious infrastructure to pull off such an operation (if it was stolen by humans) is logically only present in or around Istanbul. Otherwise, it would be driving and sailing towards West.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "I didn't think to check in, but since you're already here, be welcome to use the landline and get in touch with the people in the city. It'll be like finding a needle in a haystack at this point, though."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Or maybe I am jumping the gun and he was really boated out of the country. I don't know, I just don't want to piss off a guy that I might have to kill soon.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Who do you have for us?"

SA Michael Giles: Just a hunch but it might be good to look into cargo heading towards Marseille.

SA Michael Giles: If we're ever around in Istanbul.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "You could get in touch with the customs office in Istanbul yourselves, or have whoever you've got parked in the city give it a try for you."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Otherwise, in terms of support, I can provide you with those two vehicles. You need weapons, you ask. But we're still working on Turkish soil, keep that in mind."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hopefully we won't need them. Thank you captain."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I do wonder, though. Do you know Kurdish?"

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Picked up a bit here and there. Most of the city people you'll find do speak Turkish, in my experience."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "I don't head that way often."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I can imagine why."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: He smiles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I don't have more questions. If anyone does go ahead.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Unless they put the guy into tins of dog food or something it'd be obvious if a body coffin-and-all left the country. He's probably still in Turkey."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "That, or anywhere else in the world."

SA Bryan Carlyle: I say with a shrug.

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "I'm heading back to the listening post. Let any airman here know if you need to see me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Of course."

Capt. Kurt Campbell: "Not going anywhere." He shoots a thumbs-up as he stands up. "I'll notify the motor pool of our arrangement."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Great, this fucking guy not only is a part of the other side of the program he also knows that RUTH sent us here. We're 0-10.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Awfully dorky looking for a guy who chops up aliens on the low.

SA Michael Giles: Let's just keep our heads down and get this shit done so we can fuck off from flying carpet genie land back to places with no turbans.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Or maybe I should just freak out and kill myself right here. It's always an option.

Chandu: *Well, she did say she'd already had a word with him. You're getting the impression that this mystery organization and DELTA GREEN get along decently nicely, in fact.*

Chandu: *Besides the main point of conflict, that is.*

Chandu: *Anyway, your way into the motor pool is cleared by an airman. Two Jeeps await you.*

Chandu: *It takes about two hours to get there, but between the five of you, you can read a map and drive across the rolling plains and dusty hills-- the Jeep is more than adequate for these conditions.*

Chandu: *Along the valley, you spot small scattered fields of opium poppies waving in the breeze, cultivated by the inhabitants of small villages.*

Chandu: *BOZUKTEPE, 1500C*

Chandu: *As you approach, the mound of Bozuktepe can be seen from a distance; it's all alone in the middle of a flat river valley, rising from the earth as if pushed up from below. A dirt road runs through the valley to the mound and the small settlement of tents and sheds around it.*

Chandu: *Separate large tents are used for storage and sorting of artifacts from the dig. Oddly, the wide area around the mound itself has been left wild, as in not cultivated. The closest remote village is 30 minutes away from here.*

Chandu: *Upon your arrival, a middle-aged Turkish man approaches the group as you stop and park the Jeeps.*

Asil Demir: "Hello, hello!" He brings a hand to his chest. "My name is Asil Demir, I am supervisor for the laborers here."

Asil Demir: "You are here to investigate Mr. Whiteman's death?"It's clear that the Turkish authorities have been informed of American interest in the matter at hand.

Asil Demir: "Do you need any food? I can make some coffee, I will help you in any way possible."

SA Michael Giles: "We've been driving for 2 hours, man. Let's go sit down for a moment."

Asil Demir: "Yes, yes." He nods. "Come with me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's not so different from the jungle, save the lack of trees."

Chandu: *The site is actively being worked. You'd say there's about fifty people in total working here, most of them being laborers.*

Chandu: *However...*

Chandu: *Any of you can go ahead and roll Alertness.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 3 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

Chandu: *As for the workers themselves: they look like regular men, compared to those you've seen so far during your stay in Turkey.*

Chandu: *Some of them, however, like these two, are just... lazing around.*

Chandu: *They're sitting in the shade and slowly drinking water without talking to each other, in a male gesture of silent understanding.*

Asil Demir: Demir turns to them and claps twice.

Asil Demir: "İşe koyulun, sizi aptallar!!!!"

Laborer: They look at each other...

Laborer: And dispirited as they are, they stand up, gather their tools, and head out to the camp.

Asil Demir: "I apologize. These men are not very well paid."

Asil Demir: "Motivation is difficult to find these days."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: All the better for someone who holds American dollars.

SA Michael Giles: "You speak good English. You the foreman?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Let's have some tea and go through your findings."

Asil Demir: "Yes." He wipes sweat off his brow. "We have been working the site for two years."

Asil Demir: "Please, sit. I will bring Mr. Pope."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Was that when they first started the dig?"

Asil Demir: "That's right." He points at the armuds and pots on the mess table. "Help yourselves. Will be back shortly."

Asil Demir: He walks off somewhere.

Chandu: *Do any of you have ARCHAEOLOGY?*

SA Michael Giles: Giles sits his black ass down.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's exactly like how I imagined."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You must know some shit about the dig." He nods at Bryan.

Chandu: *Carlyle, try an Anthropology roll, blind.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: "I'm very hungry but if I eat anything here I'm gonna be shitting myself all night."

SA Michael Giles: "It's probably gonna be fine."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Whatever college boy."

SA Michael Giles: "They muslim and shit. They like being clean. Ablutions and shit."

Chandu: *You picked up bits here and there during your time in Sorbonne. You don't know the first thing about archaeology, but you can tell that the dig has been moving quite slowly if they've been at this for two years.*

Chandu: *Might be the wages. Who knows.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "These men probably eat better than the average American."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "It's the diet."

Chandu: *As in --too-- slowly. Archaeological digs are slow work already, but it's evident to you that the site's been somewhat badly run.*

SA Michael Giles: "Ain't nobody eat better than Americans."

SA Michael Giles: "Fuck are you talking about?"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "You'll see if we get to eat properly."

SA Michael Giles: "They'll feed your ass hummus. The rest of us are getting the good stuff."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You know what. I'm just gonna say it."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "This place is a Potemkin village."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Shit, I'm up for some hummus."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We should just defect to the side managed by Air Force officers and not get yelled at by a Latina who does not give a shit about our well being."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "What makes you think so Carlyle?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Apart from that we, uhh, ought to work out what's really going on here."

Chandu: *Carlyle, make a public Anthropology roll.*

Chandu: *Mac's comment made you think of something.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 75 (Rolling Anthropology Target: 40%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I bet that guy's at least as much of a freak as our latina."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "White dudes are scary man."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Fucking psychos."

Chandu: *You can't really place Carstairs' accent-- it's definitely not foreign, though. You'll have to ask, I guess.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Yeah, right. Like being clued into this shit doesn't make you a freak by default."

Chandu: *TWENTY MINUTES LATER....*

Chandu: *You're still sitting at the table and nobody's come to greet you.*

SA Michael Giles: "Dr. Pope is a bullshit fuckin' name. Let's go wander."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Nah wait."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I have a feeling that we're just meant to stay here for a while longer."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Sit tight."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Pretend everything's fine."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Trust me."

SA Michael Giles: "Yo, Fontaine, let's eavesdrop on the staff tents."

SA Michael Giles: YES.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "This place is a cover for something and the British guy was in on it. He died finding one of those macguffins we saw in Vietnam and they're making off with his body while it's in his possession. That's the closest thing I have to a working theory so far."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt holds up a palm. "We'll have time for it. This dig ain't moving anywhere. God knows it hasn't in years."

SA Michael Giles: Michael shakes a pack of cigarettes: "The ultimate excuse for loitering near somewhere."

SA Michael Giles: "Man, whatever, pussy." Giles will go to smoke at the back of some important looking tent.

SA Michael Giles: At the staff tents.

Chandu: *Go ahead and move.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Fuck around and find out."

Chandu: *As you head over to this part of the camp, you see part of the archaeological staff. You run into two women first-- one older.*

Dr. Jale İnan: She's talking to the other one in Turkish as they look over a paper.

Dr. Jale İnan: And then she spots you.

Dr. Jale İnan: She's middle-aged and dressed for the field, with a fine coating of dust all over her, arrives to speak with you. Anybody with a considerable HUMINT value can tell that her look just screams "Not another fucking thing for my day." American feds is most definitely not what she wanted-- but she does look like a competent professional.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Yes? How can I help you?"

Dr. Jale İnan: She dusts her hands off on her pants.

SA Michael Giles: Giles is just leisurely shaking out a smoke from his pack of camels.

SA Michael Giles: "Is Mr. Pope around?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Well, if you could call that being around." She glares at one of the tents.

SA Michael Giles: "We're a party of five waiting on him."

SA Michael Giles: "Is he deep in the field or something?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "...Not quite." She shrugs. "I can give you the rundown of the place. The rest are waiting for you, I suppose?"

SA Michael Giles: Giles throws the cig into his mouth and then offers from his pack: "Smoke?"

Dr. Jale İnan: She holds her hand up.

Selma Aydın: "YES."

SA Michael Giles: "Be my guest."

Selma Aydın: She takes it from your hand and hangs it on her lips. "Thanks."

Dr. Jale İnan: She says something derisive at her in Turkish.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Let's meet the rest of you. Come on."

SA Michael Giles: He takes out his commemorative MACV-SOG zippo and helps her light up.

Chandu: *Also, use the Contested CHA macro.*

Chandu: *No need for blind, it's automatic.*

Chandu: *Alright. We're heading back to the central mess.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm getting up first, staring at Giles for his **successful** attempt at "eavesdropping."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Right, well. I'm sorry for the wait, I got no word of your arrival."

SA Michael Giles: Giles just shrugs.

Dr. Jale İnan: "State Department, I suppose? Can I see your identification?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "BNDD, ma'am."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He ups ID.

SA Michael Giles: He walks up next to Cillian and whispers "Pope wasn't around."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Ah. Narcotics?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Strange, but oh, well."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Right, well. I will give you a broad overview of what's happening here."

Dr. Jale İnan: "As you can see, there's the mound here, and we have two trenches; Trench #1 on the west side of the mound, and Trench #2 at the eastern edge of it. This camp is positioned on its southwest, and we do have an auxiliary storage facility directly around Trench #1 where outgoing cargo is stored."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Trench #1 is dug through Seljuk ruins which are dated circa 1000 to 1200 A.D. Then there's two millenia of fill and rubble, then a small Urartian townsite. Iron Age, circa 1000 B.C."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Lady, please."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We have much different understandings of 'trench'."

SA Michael Giles: I do not fucking care. "Mac, say somethin'."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll just wave her off and stomp my way into Pope's tent.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Digsite. I intuit you're curious about Whiteman's death site-- right."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Ouuu."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Not bad."

Selma Aydın: She waves as she smokes.

SA Bryan Carlyle: I just laugh.

SA Michael Giles: "Don't mind him."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hey. Do you happen to speak English?"

SA Michael Giles: "Where was the death site again?"

Chandu: *Let's pause Mac's interaction for a minute.*

Dr. Jale İnan: "Right, trench #2 is where he had his accident. It is deeper and was dug out more recently."

SA Michael Giles: "What was the 'accident'?"

Dr. Jale İnan: Roll HUMINT.

SA Michael Giles: "Did he slip and fall on his miniature pick head first?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Sure.

Dr. Jale İnan: "I... he..." She looks off into the distance. "...His death was... a tragic accident." Silence ensues.

Chandu: *She's dodging the topic.*

SA Michael Giles: Yeah, obviously. But was she sworn to silence or what?

SA Michael Giles: Damn.

Chandu: *You could try insisting.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt interjects. "Must've been gnarly to witness, then? You seem to struggle just talking about it, ma'am."

Dr. Jale İnan: You come across as understanding, Mathieu, so she seems to acquiesce.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Alright. Look, he hung himself. He..." She sighs. "I don't want to speak ill of the dead. In fact, Edward Pope, his assistant, who should be here, by the way? He knew him a lot better."

Dr. Jale İnan: "You could try to speak with him."

Dr. Jale İnan: "...though he took it harder than most."

Dr. Jale İnan: "I knew Whiteman professionally, but I never met him. I know he was knowledgeable, a curious and inquisitive sort of man, eager for gossip about new discoveries. Although I do think that... like any other British archaeologist, he dreamed of being the next Howard Carter."

Dr. Jale İnan: "I'm here only as a favor to the British Institute. My real work is waiting for me in Perga."

Dr. Jale İnan: "My field of expertise is the Hellenistic period, you see, not these, eh... barbarous Bronze Age temples."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Finally, for reference; the dig involves five archaeologists, three Turkish and two British. We have some thirty assistants and laborers. Two more British archaeologists have also worked here, but they are both back in England for the moment, and aren't expected to return for weeks."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He folds his arms across his chest, the matter of archaeology going out the other ear.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Maybe earlier, since, you know." She purses her lips.

SA Michael Giles: "Can we examine the site now?"

Chandu: *For everyone chatting with her: she seems competent, but harried and distracted. It's clear that she doesn't want to be here.*

Dr. Jale İnan: "You could, but it's closed off."

Dr. Jale İnan: "It's dangerous, Whiteman himself signed the closing order."

SA Michael Giles: "How is it dangerous?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Not physically dangerous per se. The trench is shored up and supported, but there are records of a few accidents happening before the incident. Cuts, workers trampling over rubble and getting themselves hurt."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Whiteman's death has been the only one, thankfully."

SA Michael Giles: "Ma'am, with all due respect, if we were afraid of cuts and sprained ankles we wouldn't be in this line of work."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Can't say I got my shoelaces in a knot. I'm sure none of us will have trouble walking over some rubble."

Dr. Jale İnan: "If you really want to see the trench, well-- I am far too busy right now. My assistant could guide you." She shrugs. "I don't think Pope would."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Is Pope available?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "He found Whiteman... that day."

Dr. Jale İnan: "In his tent." She upnods over that way.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He bumps shoulders with Giles, whispering. "This bitch is useless." He says a little louder, "Can we visit him now?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Nobody's stopping you. Be my guest."

Dr. Jale İnan: "He's a good kid. Don't be too rough on him."

Dr. Jale İnan: "He's still rattled."

SA Michael Giles: "We'll try to be helpful," he smiles (No we fucking won't.)

Chandu: *Let's tap back to Mac, who's been there for a few minutes.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Well?"

Selma Aydın: "I do." She nods.

Selma Aydın: "There is not much practice here, though."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I can't help but notice the lack of headscarf. Are you her assistant?"

Selma Aydın: "Right. I'm from Istanbul."

Selma Aydın: "I grew up in London, though."

Selma Aydın: "What'd you come here for, may I ask?"

Selma Aydın: "...other than Whiteman's suicide, I suppose."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This one is definitely going to be hard to impress, so no need for any clownery.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Well, actually, we're looking for signs of aliens and the unnatural. You mind pointing me towards it?"

Selma Aydın: She cackles.

Selma Aydın: "Maybe you'll find some if you talk to Edward. He's been going on and on about... weird things."

Selma Aydın: "Honestly? I think he lost the plot after he found Charles hanging from that support strut."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Does he need to be yelled at to get his ass to work? I mean we've been sitting for a good thirty minutes."

Selma Aydın: "I'd be surprised if he wasn't drunk and blacked out at this very moment."

Selma Aydın: "He keeps complaining that nobody'll drink with him."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh he found his drinking partner alright."

Selma Aydın: "It's a Muslim country, I keep telling him."

Selma Aydın: "Ha. Well, enjoy."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He ruffles his head and looks around.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We still couldn't figure out where to stay the night. You know any good places?"

Selma Aydın: "Diyarbakir is the closest place with a hotel, really. But it'd be a pain to drive back and forth while you're working here."

Selma Aydın: "Jale can probably get the workers to set you up with a tent."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: She didn't get the hint.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Well then. Thanks."

Selma Aydın: She nods as she continues smoking.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll slowly walk to Pope's tent.

Selma Aydın: You still have a few minutes of alone time. Go ahead.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Is he passed out?

Chandu: *You find Edward Pope in his tent. He has several bottles of spirits thrown around the place, and it does reek strongly of alcohol. As for the man himself, he's sweaty, pale, and overall looks like shit. He's sulking in the darkness of the tent, lying on the bed with a book covering his face.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Perfect. I'm snatching his journal and going out.

Edward Pope: You stuff it in your pocket before he really reacts. He's not snoring, it's more like he's lazing around.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...I'll jinx it if I walk out.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He clears his throat, loudly.

Edward Pope: "....whaaaaaat now..." He shoves the book off his face.

Edward Pope: "Who in the world are you?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's not good manners to make your guests wait for 30 minutes."

Edward Pope: You do get to see a picture placed down on the table, by the way, as you pick his journal up.

Chandu: *He certainly looked more cheerful back then.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This is an UK national right.

Chandu: *That's right.*

Edward Pope: "Huh... guests?"

Edward Pope: "You certainly don't look like one of the workers..." He chuckles softly to himself as he puts his head back on the pillow.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He exhales. I was expecting a slacker but he genuinely looks all over the place.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm gonna pour some water for him and booze for myself.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Pick yourself up son. We're BNDD. Americans."

Chandu: *It's whiskey. Not bad at all, you think, as you sip.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm sorry for what happened."

Edward Pope: He sits up and places the book aside. You see its title as he grabs the glass of water from your hand. "EGYPTOLOGY DETAILED, VOL. IV."

Edward Pope: "Ah, well. What're you going to do."

Edward Pope: He sips.

Edward Pope: "What do you need?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I reckon you've heard what happened to him. We're here to set things right."

Edward Pope: "What happened to him, huh..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The shipment."

Edward Pope: "Look, you look like the first remotely smart person I've seen in months."

Edward Pope: He sits up. "This is... you're standing on a sight that will soon be spoken of in the same breaths as Troy and Pompeii. It's going to be... it's not just the physical traces of the past that are present here, there's something else... something that'll make my career..." He stares off into a corner of the tent.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: False fucking start but I'll take it.

Edward Pope: "Whiteman's death? It doesn't fucking matter in the long run..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Go on, let out the steam."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm listening."

Chandu: *By now the rest of the team can have arrived here, by the way. You can go ahead and move yourselves to Pope's tent.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What was that about Pompeii?"

Edward Pope: "...I can't talk about it yet." He lies back down and throws the book over his face again.

Edward Pope: "This is going to make my career." He mutters.

SA Michael Giles: Giles looks around and waves a hand in front of his face.

SA Michael Giles: "Not like this it ain't."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We're bound by secrecy, plus, we're not in the academia. We are constitutionally blocked from undermining your work."

SA Michael Giles: Bullshit squared.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The matter of fact is, I really need help from a smart guy around here."

Chandu: *For the rest, you do see the picture.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Gonna just hang around outside for now since I doubt crowding the poor fucker is gonna make him talk more.

Edward Pope: He shoves the book off his face again and looks at the others.

Edward Pope: "Well."

Edward Pope: "I, uh..." He sits back up. "T.C. Lethbridge. Have you heard of him?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I won't interrupt.

Chandu: *Carlyle, you're listening to this too. You can come in and make an Anthropology roll for that one.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Sure.

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 36 (Rolling Anthropology Target: 40%)

Chandu: *T.C. Lethbridge. A total fucking nutcase, as far as you know. He's a mildly obscure academic with two doctorates: archaeology and psychology. You haven't read his work, but what little you've heard has led you to the conclusion that he's another charlatan with too much time on his hands.*

Edward Pope: "He's an archaeologist and a parapsychologist. His work explains that some places hold psychometric impressions--" He tilts his head, like he's piecing together an explanation that a child could understand.

Edward Pope: "Ghosts, and psychic memories of the past, that is."

Edward Pope: "I believe this is one of such places." A subtle smile forms on his face. "I've had such intense, vivid dreams here-- dreams of past lives, so detailed and coherent, they must've been actual memories."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Psychometrics. I know that word from the mental health tests at the army.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Hah.

Edward Pope: "Eh... it's hard to describe..." He picks up a bottle and lies back down as he sips from it.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hard because it was not you?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I get it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Entertain me, then."

Edward Pope: "Well, if you're so interested."

Edward Pope: He stands up and starts slowly pacing around the room with his hand on his chin.

Edward Pope: It's an unprecedented burst of focus since your arrival, that's for sure.

Edward Pope: "I can tell that-- I know that back in 1200 A.D., the Seljuk Turks... the river valley, well-- it was the same seven, almost eight hundred years ago, as it is in the present day. I had this dream... the mound was here."

Edward Pope: "And back then, even back then, they recalled rumors of ghosts and monsters in this place. Even that long ago, it was ancient for them."

Edward Pope: "Wisely did the Prophet forbid alcohol, for it is in weakness and depravity that ghosts find purchase in the human soul. Do you understand? I know this. I saw it in my dream. And I'm an atheist, before you say anything."

Edward Pope: "I've had others. This-- this mound, it has been here for THOUSANDS and THOUSANDS of years."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He looks at his own cup of drink and slooowly places it back on the desk.

Edward Pope: "Every culture that's encountered it has had intense experiences here... this is a place of psychic importance, where one can commune with those of the past. That's why I think it'll be much greater than Troy. Imagine the troves of knowledge we could unearth here."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt looks to the side in disbelief. He takes the fedora off, fanning his face with it.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This guy is far gone. I'll have to garotte him once we're done with what we came here for.

SA Michael Giles: I'm sensing a pattern here.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Well. You didn't really pay any attention to the advice then."

Edward Pope: "Ha. One does as men do."

Edward Pope: "Anyway... it's not like we'll get anywhere while the trench is closed off."

Edward Pope: "You should keep an eye on Jale."

Edward Pope: "I don't trust her. I think she's trying to bury it all."

Edward Pope: "We need to continue the excavation, but she closed it off and shifted work to trench #1 after she arrived. I want to get into the ceremonial building, you see. I believe it is of great importance, but she's not letting us work on it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Do you think he, your friend, was impressed by the visions?"

Edward Pope: "Whiteman?"

Edward Pope: He laughs loudly. "Oh, he was a degenerate. He was-- hooked on this Turkish heroin that's so cheap here. So potent he was hopelessly addicted to the substance, and... always sneaking off into the hills. Maybe there's a woman out there or something, I don't know what he was doing out there."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Jale may actually be on our side. I need Carstairs to run back intelligence on her. This might be a huge case of friendly fire if we act on the words of an insane man.

Edward Pope: "Total bastard. I don't know, I couldn't trust him. He was compromised, I think. He was certainly not as dedicated to the site as I am."

Edward Pope: "But then again, before all this, back in London..." He sighs as his shoulders droop.

Edward Pope: "He was a good man. I found him that day, you know."

Edward Pope: "He was cold. I helped them pull him down."

Edward Pope: "And now his family won't even get to see what was left of him."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I need your mind off the scene for now."

Edward Pope: "Nobody deserves that-- right."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Teach me how to achieve the visions."

Edward Pope: "Achieve the visions?" He smiles as he sits on the bed.

Edward Pope: "I don't know how I accessed this. They just came one night, in my sleep."

Edward Pope: "I've been trying to recreate it, but I am quite short of guinea pigs here."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Are you the only one around here who drinks a lot?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Being a Muslim country and all."

Edward Pope: "Gah. These Turkish savages won't drink with me, but I know they drink when they're alone."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Did they exhibit any strangeness?"

Edward Pope: He shrugs.

Edward Pope: "They don't like the work. It's like they hate being here."

Edward Pope: "They're unaware of the greatness that could be uncovered here. And we're running out of time."

Edward Pope: "That damned dam is going to drown the site in two years."

SA Michael Giles: Yeah this site is dead in the water and is being held frozen by the program.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I could work something out."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Get them high on their spirits. We got a bit of green on our side."

Edward Pope: "You have to work something out. You have to speak to Inan, get her to reopen the trench."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We're quite disciplined, although we don't really understand jack shit about dig engineering."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What authority does she hold over this?"

Edward Pope: "She was assigned here as the lead archaeologist after Whiteman put the noose on his neck."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I mean judicial."

Edward Pope: "She runs the site, but, well, the delays started well before she came here."

Edward Pope: "She does have the support of the Turkish government."

Edward Pope: "They're very territorial about their archaeology. They think we pilfered Egypt." He shrugs.

Edward Pope: "Like they'd know what to do with all that ancient history."

Edward Pope: "They'd probably destroy it all or put it on a table as a weightholder. Plus she's a woman. Weak-willed."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hypothetically what would happen if something happened to her?"

Edward Pope: "Archaeology is a man's field, you know."

Edward Pope: "Something such as what?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't know. Slip and fall?"

Edward Pope: "Well... I'd first ask you if you were totally off your rocker if you were seriously considering this."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Don't give me that shit. I recognize the look in your eyes."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I can make your dream come true."

Edward Pope: "A second important death here would see the site closed off and swarmed with policemen, I think."

Edward Pope: "But... no. I don't want anyone dead. Come on..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Then it would have to be not-here.

Edward Pope: He lies back down.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "For every great thing there must be a great price paid."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You have until tomorrow to think it over."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm leaving.

Edward Pope: "...Right. Yes... just try talking to her first."

Edward Pope: "Come back when you've made some progress, your words are like daggers in my brain right now..."

Edward Pope: He flops back down onto his bed, picks up one of the bottles and throws the book back over his face.

Chandu: *Anyone got any more questions for him?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He's very immature and very crazy, though that's exactly what we need.

SA Michael Giles: This dude is insane.

SA Michael Giles: Let's get the fuck out of this tent and into that trench.

Selma Aydın: "What's up." She waves.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm interested in Whiteman's tent.

Selma Aydın: "Jale told me to give you guys a tour of the trenches when you're done here."

SA Michael Giles: "Guy's a few eggs short of a carton."

SA Michael Giles: "Let's get going."

Selma Aydın: "Eh... he's sad, you know... but he'll get over it."

Chandu: *Selma can guide you over to the trenches at your leisure, though we're staying for Mac's search of Whiteman's tent.*

Chandu: *The walk to the trenches is going to be ten minutes from the laborer camp. Trench #2 is of most interest, so that'll be first.*

Chandu: *Who's going with Selma right away?*

SA Michael Giles: Me.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: If they are going ahead I can lag behind and hear out Jale.

Chandu: *The three on the right will accompany Selma while you look over Whiteman's tent.*

Chandu: *You can proceed inside.*

Chandu: *Whiteman's tent. The furniture's been left untouched, but there are crates around containing Whiteman's possessions, some letters and documents, even a diary. You can start going through those.*

Chandu: *Make an Alertness check first, blind.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 55
(Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What the fuck is this?"

Chandu: *The first obvious thing after a cursory rifle through the pages for loose bookmarks is at the very end of the diary. You notice fine cutting marks: the last two or three pages were removed with a sharp blade, whoever did this didn't try to make it look subtle.*

Chandu: *What you do notice is that, apart from legitimate archaeological notes on the site which corroborate Inan's summary, the last pages contain his itinerary from the last days before his death. An entry mentions heading out by the coast to the city of Mersin, and "dinner with Claude".*

Chandu: *Riding off that critical success... you find a slip of yellowed out paper-- a cutout, between the pages here.*

Chandu: *It's a simple piece of yellowed paper, with a note written in spindly handwriting. "Make sartain all that was there inhumed is taken up - leave not one scrap behind. The full body, not a grain less."*

Chandu: *On the reverse of the page, in the same handwriting, is a list or recipe, mostly crossed out.*

Chandu: *"1 parte MERCURY XXXX partes SULFUR to 10 XXXX. XXXX joints and grind with mortar and pestle until--"*

Chandu: *The message cuts off abruptly as if the author decided against finishing, scribbled it out, and turned the page over to write the first instructions.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh fuck. They are going to resurrect him with magic."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I already made up my mind with Jale. Anyway.

Chandu: *Your Pharmacy rating is low, but the signs are obvious: you do notice several scraps of aluminum foil that've been heated by a flame, which indicates to you that the guy was definitely using heroin.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Nothing here otherwise looks like the dwellings of a heroin addict, though.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Is there heroin itself here?

Chandu: *Just the signs of it having been all smoked up.*

Chandu: *Hit a Search roll, blind. You'll spend a while rifling through the rest of the tent.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: It's coming to me. Do they commune with eachother this way? Heroin? Or is it something they mix into it?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 37 (Rolling Search Target: 40%)

Chandu: *There is an account book with a Turkish bank's notes, which lists his expenses along with money from the British Institute of Archaeology and the National Science Foundation.*

Chandu: *There's no sign of any illicit payments from drugs that you'd say, although heroin's cheap here. There are, however, several unusual payments for "cargo freight" - why was Whiteman shipping archaeological finds home out of his own pocket? It might be worth it to search the stores.*

Chandu: *Lastly...*

Chandu: *There is an unsent letter to the British Archaeological Institute, praising Edward Pope's "irrepressible energy and stamina". Is he talking about the same guy you just spoke with? He looks anything but energetic now.*

Chandu: *More letters!*

Chandu: *There are other letters from Whiteman's sister Eloise that suggest Whiteman was unhappy in Turkey. There aren't any copies of his letters to Eloise, but in her replies, she worries that her brother is "keeping himself in exile" and that whatever problems he has can be overcome. It's clear that she's worried about Whiteman, but doesn't know why he's remaining in Turkey when he doesn't want to stay there.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Maybe I am looking at this the wrong way. The way the setup is we are totally balls deep into enemy territory and we either kill no one or everyone. I'd rather kill no one until we have the prey in sight.

Chandu: *What's more-- judging from the collection of documents here, Whiteman did make that trip to Mersin on personal business. He spent a lot of time alone in his tent, and you also find a written order dated shortly prior to his death for the teams to stop the work in trench #2 and to focus only on the archaeology on trench #1.*

Chandu: *Roll INT, blind.*

Chandu: *It becomes clear to you that Whiteman appeared to be working in trench #2 alone at night after the order was issued, ordering the workers to leave him alone and not to disturb him. One morning, Edward Pope found his body hanging from a support beam in trench #2. He was cold-- he must've killed himself early in the evening.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Something is not right. He had his own tent-palace right here and possibly more than enough heroin to overdose.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: If he really wanted to just kill himself and be over with it there was a much cleaner way to pull it off, given how reclusive he is.

Chandu: *It's a mystery! We're tabbing over to the guys in trench #2.*

Chandu: *TRENCH #2, 1800C*

Chandu: *By now the sun is close to setting, but there's still a little daylight left to work with.*

Selma Aydın: "So, here it is."

Selma Aydın: "How much do you guys know about archaeology?" She turns and bends over to pick an oil lantern up from the ground.

SA Michael Giles: "It's a trench alright."

Selma Aydın: "Hopefully I'll be of some help. The trench's been closed for a while, even before Whiteman kicked the bucket. The laborers get this bad feeling around it, too."

SA Michael Giles: "And you?"

Selma Aydın: "They're glad it's closed off. Some of them had to pick Whiteman off the noose, you know."

Selma Aydın: "I'm not superstitious. I outgrew my fear of darkness a while ago." She smiles.

Selma Aydın: "Come, watch your step."

SA Michael Giles: "Deeper than it looks from the outside."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I hope this shit doesn't collapse on us or something."

Selma Aydın: "Yes, it's shorter and deeper than trench #1." She laughs on her way down. "Don't worry. It's relatively safe."

Selma Aydın: "Just watch your arms near the rocks."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Relatively."

Selma Aydın: "Here we are. This is the current endpoint of the excavation."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan makes a whistle that echoes throughout.

SA Michael Giles: "And these stones are the fruits of the dig?"

Selma Aydın: "This is part of the lower structure. It's what Whiteman called Hurrian." She gestures over the stonework.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Suffocating place."

SA Michael Giles: "Anything interesting to be told about this brick?"

Selma Aydın: "Sure."

Selma Aydın: "He called it Hurrian, but I'd be more careful. Middle Bronze Age, yes. Ritual use, probably. 'Temple' is too easy a word." She pauses.

Selma Aydın: "Archaeologists typically say 'temple' when they want journalists and national associations to give them more funding."

Selma Aydın: "Still, he described the exposed ruins here as a Hurrian ceremonial building from around 2500 B.C., which was later expanded and occupied by Hittites around 1550 B.C. Then it was burnt down."

Selma Aydın: She looks down at the mud. "This trench should be dry. The valley isn't dry, but this trench shouldn't look like this."

SA Michael Giles: "What kind of rituals did they do here?"

Selma Aydın: "Your guess is as good as mine, at the moment. Sacrifice, offerings to their gods-- enna turena, they called them."

Selma Aydın: She points out one of the stanchions.

Selma Aydın: "He hung himself here." She looks at it for a few quiet moments.

SA Michael Giles: "Human sacrifice?"

Selma Aydın: "Well, nearly every Bronze Age civilization practiced some form of it. Be it figurative or literally."

Selma Aydın: "Some conducted mock rituals. That's not the point."

Selma Aydın: "Trench #1 has been dug more thoroughly, I can't say much about this one. We did find human remains back in the first."

SA Michael Giles: "Yeah but that could just be burial, right?"

Selma Aydın: "Now that you mention it, this one set of remains..."

Selma Aydın: "It was buried, yes. But it exhibited signs of injury."

Selma Aydın: "This is back in trench #1, to be clear."

Selma Aydın: "What we could say at a simple look over is that the wound seemed caused by something or someone who was very close to that person."

Selma Aydın: "Maybe even self-inflicted." She moves her fingers in a "boo" gesture.

SA Michael Giles: "Like distancewise?"

Selma Aydın: "That's right."

Selma Aydın: "So, Whiteman ordered work ceased here, then continued on his own. Then he tried to make sure no one else could examine it properly. It's a professional insult to us."

Selma Aydın: "And then he hung himself. He was a great archaeologist, don't get me wrong, but..."

Selma Aydın: "It's difficult to understand."

SA Michael Giles: "What do you mean make sure nobody could examine it properly?"

SA Michael Giles: "Did he cover something up?"

SA Michael Giles: "Deface an edifice?"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Sounds to me like you should keep digging."

Selma Aydın: "Yes. Not much, but it did make the trench unstable for a time. The workers shored up the struts on Jale's orders just in case anyone found their way down here. You, for example."

Selma Aydın: "Eh, Jale has a genuine concern for worker safety and the digsite being closed off. You can see the type of attention Whiteman's suicide's brought us."

SA Michael Giles: Can we (keyword we) roll alertness to look around for any marks of tampering and/or interesting symbols?

SA Michael Giles: or search

Chandu: *Hit a roll, blind.*

Chandu: *As you look around, you do find the now unused support strut that Whiteman hacked at to collapse a section of the trench. In fact, if you look behind these rocks, you can see that it went a little deeper than this.*

Chandu: *The rubble's covering it up now.*

SA Michael Giles: Theoretically how long would it take to clear the way forward?

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "What a motherfucker."

Selma Aydın: "If work were to resume? I think the dig could get back on track, at least at the spot it was before the collapse... in a day, probably."

Selma Aydın: "Further digging, it's hard to say. It definitely goes deeper."

Selma Aydın: "There's not much to see here, but personally, I think there was no foul play here."

Selma Aydın: "They looked him over for injuries. It was just the rope. No one had attacked him before he did it."

Selma Aydın: "What do you think?"

SA Michael Giles: "I think it's a headache that we'll have to spend several days at least untangling."

Selma Aydın: "If you really are interested in cracking this back open, I'd talk it over with Jale. She's pretty dead set on not risking any more incidents."

Selma Aydın: "You know-- he wasn't incompetent, which is what irritates me. An incompetent man leaves ordinary damage. He knew better."

Selma Aydın: "He wanted significance. Some archaeologists want to be right, some want to be first. He wanted to be remembered."

Selma Aydın: "If you were to ask me..." She's just speaking her mind now.

Selma Aydın: "I think he found something he did not understand. And he was dealing with personal problems of his own."

Selma Aydın: "But I can't come up with a reason as to why now, why here."

Chandu: *To wrap the visit up, she can share the archaeological knowledge you'd otherwise be unable to piece together.*

SA Michael Giles: Sure.

Selma Aydın: "We did find a few things here, before work stopped. The pottery and other items show an odd lack of variation and are of comparatively crude design. Suggests that the people of the mound were isolated and cut off from any neighbors. Possibly even shunned."

Selma Aydın: "And also... the "ceremonial building" seems to have been burned to the ground, but the foundations survived. There's certainly more remnants to be uncovered."

Selma Aydın: "Just so you get an idea, the traces are at the lowest stratum, implying this site has not been inhabited for even longer than the first one-- it appears to have been abandoned around 1400 B.C."

Selma Aydın: "It's a marvel. I can't say I'm not curious."

SA Michael Giles: Is the floor of this trench muddy?

Chandu: *It is. She did comment on it, in fact-- while the plains above aren't dry, the ground here should not be wet.*

Chandu: *The mud is dark and humid. It's not being flooded, but water's seeping in from somewhere.*

SA Michael Giles: "Why's it wet down here? The whole area looks like a desert almost."

Selma Aydın: "Good question. The easiest explanation would be an aquifer."

Selma Aydın: "But the area's been surveyed before. There shouldn't be one here."

Selma Aydın: "Of course, we don't know what's deeper down."

Selma Aydın: "That's all there is to it for now, unless the excavations were to be resumed. You could swing by trench #1, but I doubt you're interested in it."

SA Michael Giles: "You said human remains so I guess we could take a look at it for a second."

Selma Aydın: "Sure thing. We still have some daylight."

Chandu: *So, trench #1.*

Selma Aydın: "Right. As I said, Seljuks above, then a long interval of filling before we arrive to the Urartian material beneath. It's not glamorous, but it tells us that people came back to the mound after a long absence."

Selma Aydın: "The gap matters. People leave places for ordinary reasons: water, war, disease... but when they return much later and still avoid certain parts or aspects of a site, it does become interesting."

SA Michael Giles: This looks more like an actual archeological site instead of a prepper's tunnel.

Selma Aydın: "They didn't farm on the mound or the ground surrounding it. Other sites in the region show wine culture clearly enough. There's nothing here."

SA Michael Giles: "Why? Were they biding their time?"

SA Michael Giles: "Was this just an outpost?"

SA Michael Giles: "Or were they guarding this shit because it was taboo?"

Selma Aydın: "No, it looks more like an actual township. Seljuks in 1200 A.D., Hittites thousands of years before."

Selma Aydın: "What's interesting is that both layers show no sign of alcoholic consumption."

Selma Aydın: "Seljuks, of course, that explains itself. Islam."

Selma Aydın: "But the Hittites were adept at the trade. If they had done it here, there'd be signs of it."

Selma Aydın: "That could mean our sample is poor, it could mean we haven't yet reached the relevant area. It could mean local prohibition, even then."

Selma Aydın: She stops and points at a half-interred Seljuk skeleton remains. "This is the one I spoke about. He was found almost complete. The wound is here, low, under the rib..." She crouches down.

Chandu: *Mathieu, roll Forensics, blind.*

Chandu: *The wound is strange, you can confirm that. You'd put money on it being self-inflicted.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "It's hard to put my finger on it... It seems to be a sign of self-harm, however..."

Selma Aydın: "Yup. Several other remains in the site show similar signs."

Selma Aydın: "Across both eras, even."

Selma Aydın: "Seljuk and Hittite remains both show signs of self-harm. If it were only a few of the lot, you'd be able to dismiss it. But Jale and I think it strange that both strata show such consistent signs of self-inflicted wounds."

Selma Aydın: "Ritual suicide? The Seljuks weren't about that. The Hittites, perhaps they're a little more justifiable."

Selma Aydın: "If I was insane..." She strokes her jaw.

Selma Aydın: "I'd say the site itself may have had a culture of self-harm during the Hittite era. But across thousands of years?"

Selma Aydın: She shrugs.

Selma Aydın: "That's not something I'd put in a report."

Selma Aydın: She looks over at the horizon. "The sun's almost down. Will you be staying? Your tent must be ready by now."

SA Michael Giles: "Yeah, I think it's time to call it a night."

Selma Aydın: She nods and leads the way back to the camp.

Chandu: *Mac, you managed to find Jale for a chat. We're tabbing over to you specifically.*

Dr. Jale İnan: "Could you find anything of interest?"

Dr. Jale İnan: She's reading over some logs as she speaks.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yes. Was it you who decided to report the death as an accident?"

Chandu: *Roll HUMINT, blind.*

Dr. Jale İnan: She looks up from the papers into your eyes as she purses her lips.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm not gonna blame you for it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's the easiest explanation."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The real one, much more complicated."

Dr. Jale İnan: "...yes. My colleagues in the British Institute couldn't afford to have the site closed off due to the incident."

Dr. Jale İnan: "So, while I was aware of the situation when I arrived, and Whiteman's body had already been shipped off, I did not object to it."

Dr. Jale İnan: "The fact becomes clear to anyone who looks into it, of course."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm gonna probe her a bit."Look, this just so happens to concern the American taxpayer, partly, and that the death took place at somewhere very relevant to drugs. Imagine someone died to a heart attack at a bus stop, although it's no fault of the bus driver the transport authority would still drop by to see what's up right?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Do you see where I'm getting at?"

Dr. Jale İnan: She sighs. "There were rumors. Heroin is cheap enough here to ruin a man quietly. While I do not know if that killed him, I know it did not improve his work."

Dr. Jale İnan: "He had problems of his own, from what I know. It could've been only his addiction. Perhaps something else."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Drug addicts are pliable, after all, by those who provide the 'medicine'."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This seems to be a boundary I can't un-cross. I'll save it for later."On that matter, all work here has effectively been halted by you no?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Didn't his death virtually shut the whole thing down?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Only trench #2. Whiteman closed it off before he died, so I decided against opening it again."

Dr. Jale İnan: "The work in trench #1 is more revealing, even though I am not a Bronze Age expert-- I'd rather not risk blowback from incidents in the second trench during my stay here."

Dr. Jale İnan: "I'm waiting to be relieved by whoever they send, after all."

Dr. Jale İnan: "It can be their problem." She shrugs.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "When are they coming?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "I haven't gotten word, but it should be maybe a week or two from now. I expect they'll bring another expert from Cambridge."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I heard they had someone from Sorbonne in mind."I'm gonna act shocked and pretend I shouldn't have said that.

Dr. Jale İnan: "The British Institute giving up their work to the French? That would be amazing."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: No reaction?

Chandu: *She genuinely just wants to up and get out of here back to her work at Perga, but she's associated with the British after all.*

Chandu: *She's not really bothered by the comment.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Interesting. Very interesting.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "In any case is there anything else we may have forgotten to discuss today?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Perhaps you'd like to search the stores, but that'll take hours. There's material from both trenches that're awaiting shipping to Mersin."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I've the time and the hands."

Dr. Jale İnan: "At your leisure. I've had the workers prepare a tent for you, either way."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Where are the lazy asses? Let's get this over with.

Chandu: *They are now arriving...!*

Chandu: *From the tour.*

Chandu: *You can proceed. The stores are that-a-way.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Get your ass down from there now!"

Dr. Jale İnan: "I'll leave you to it. Until later."

Chandu: *As you head over to the tent...*

Asil Demir: Asil runs over from the camp.

Asil Demir: "Gentlemen! How is it going?"

Asil Demir: "I saw you come this way, come. I can help you sort through the crates."

Asil Demir: "It's in disarray. Excuse us."

Asil Demir: He nods as he leads the way inside.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Okay."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Whatever he touches is suspicious, this is like a free pass.

Asil Demir: He walks over to a set of crates and pulls a few aside, spreading them out.

Asil Demir: "Alright. This part here," he points at a set, "is from trench #1. The other pile is trench #2."

Asil Demir: "Feel free, they are all yours. I will stay with you, I have to shut the lights off after we are done."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Here."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Okay then. Hands up, hands up!"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Let's do this before midnight."

SA Michael Giles: I'm checking numero dos pile.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'll check the first pile.

Chandu: *With the four of you involved, getting through it is simple work. Asil just leans on a table and makes small talk as you go ahead, helping with a crate here or there.*

Chandu: *Let's go through the list...*

Chandu: *A Hurrian cylinder seal, an inch-tall cylinder made of bone, carved with glyphs and images of the gods. It's designed to be rolled over clay, leaving an impression.*

Chandu: *Carlyle, roll Anthropology.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 59 (Rolling Anthropology Target: 40%)

Chandu: *It's curious. One of the glyphs is similar to the later Hittite depiction of Nergal, god of the underworld, but it looks like it's overlapping with the symbols for water and darkness. You'd have to ask someone else for further information, maybe one of the archaeologists.*

Chandu: *Mathieu, roll History.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Failure** -> 78 (Rolling History Target: 50%)

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Ehhh... I don't know.

Chandu: *At a simple lookover: Fragments of pottery, mostly from Trench #1, and mostly comparatively recent work that can be dated back to the Seljuk era; there's some other pottery that resembles material from the Hittite strata in Trench #2, but according to the notes and photographs, it was found with the Seljuk material. It must be an intrusive find-- an artifact that got disturbed and moved from its original context.*

Chandu: *Next, the more straightforward ones...*

Chandu: *Giles, you find Fragments of bone, some of which show marks that might indicate violence. Alarming, similar fragments were found in both trenches and at all periods of habitation, suggesting the site has a long and violent history.*

Chandu: *Mac-- you lay your eyes on some Preserved thorns, found at the lowest exposed stratum of Trench #2. The team found several curious pieces of preserved vegetation; small branches from a thorn bush.*

Chandu: *Hit a blind Occult roll.*

Chandu: *At a closer look-- these don't look like thorn branches at all. They're structurally strange.*

Chandu: *That's as much as a look will get you. They're strange.*

Chandu: *Would you like to do something to them?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll poke it.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'll poke the pile that Cillian doesn't.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Assuming we still have things to find on both of them.

Chandu: *You each poke them with a finger. Both of you observe how the almost crystal-like material has taken up some of the qualities of vegetable matter. What's more, it seems to react to the warmth of your hands.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Okay..."

Chandu: *Nolan, you first. The crystal changes shapes just slightly as you poke it. It becomes a little pointier just as you come into contact with it-- it leaves you with the equivalent of a paper cut.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This could be an ingredient in magic.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "That's sharp."

Chandu: *Cillian, you next. The crystal does change shapes-- it becomes almost liquidy. At the next moment, it recoils from you.*

Chandu: *It's like it's retreating. You don't get a poke.*

Chandu: *No further interactions. You chase it along the crate with your finger-- it doesn't move too fluidly or too fast, but it's definitely moving away from you.*

Asil Demir: Asil is just smoking a cigarette as he chats over the other finds. He hasn't seen this.

Chandu: *Nolan, make a BLIND CONSTITUTION ROLL.*

Chandu: *Parsed. It's just a paper cut.*

Chandu: *It's been about an hour and a half of searching, and the activity outside at the camp has died down.*

Chandu: *Any next moves?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Drink a little and go to sleep.

SA Michael Giles: Drink a lot and check the mound itself.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'll help Giles out.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Did I draw blood from the poke?

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I bet at least some of the artifacts here will do shit with blood.

Chandu: *Just as much as a paper cut does, which isn't much at all. You could smudge it in a rag if you pressed your finger on it.*

Chandu: *Everyone's heading to the tent for now...*

Chandu: *Pick your individual cots.*

Chandu: *Who's drinking? I gather some of you are drinking and going straight to bed?*

SA Michael Giles: Giles is drinking but he's going to check the actual mound.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'm drinking a little too.

Chandu: *You drink some cheap liquor you took from the bottles Pope had lying around his tent, he didn't seem to object.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'll drink too.

SA Bryan Carlyle: None of them are bunk beds or something so who really cares. If anyone is dumb enough to try and self-induce a hallucination that's their problem, I'm just sleeping.

Chandu: *Excellent. Those of you who drink up do so without issue.*

Chandu: *We're visiting the mound and then calling it time to sleep.*

Chandu: *The walk up the mound is a short one, it's just fifty feet. It takes ten minutes to get to the top.*

Chandu: *You have a commanding view of the camp from up here, as well as the fields around the site.*

Chandu: *It's not a bad sight at all. Giles, Mathieu, you can roll Alertness.*

SA Michael Giles: SA Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 12 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Success** -> 21 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

Chandu: *You take notice of the grass on the mound. It's sparse-- but there certainly is grass here.*

Chandu: *What's peculiar about it is that it's brittle, and it's crushed as you step on it.*

Chandu: *It looks debilitated, almost unhealthy.*

Chandu: *Not much else of note up here.*

Chandu: *What now?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: We should head to bed. Probably.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Giles?

SA Michael Giles: Probably. Or we can just keep drinking here.

SA Michael Giles: Unless it's too cold to do so.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Sleep here too...?

Chandu: *It does get cold at night, despite it being summer. You stay for a few hours drinking, nothing happening, before coming back down to camp...*

Chandu: *The others are snoring already. You get set up on your cots.*

Chandu: *Everyone make a blind SANLOSS test before we call the session.*

Chandu: *it's in MACROS*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I'm glad the Hittite Sasquatch didn't grab you two."

Chandu: *You all drift into blissful sleep. It's not dreamless.*

Chandu: *Tune in for session 2 next week. Thank you for playing.*

SA Michael Giles: ALLAH

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: ALLAH

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: reddit de profundis: le profundis

DE PROFUNDIS SESSION 2

July 10, 2026

August 11, 1968 - August 12, 1968

Chandu: *DE PROFUNDIS - II*

Chandu: *A warm summer night. A windy one, for a mercy.*

Chandu: *Sleep. It has never failed to be a safe refuge. For some of you, at least.*

Chandu: *The scientific nature of sleep, not to mention dreaming, is to this day a large unknown. The brain reconstructs memories, feelings, wishes... all in an often more incoherent than not manner.*

Chandu: *There is much yet to learn.*

Chandu: *BOZUKTEPE, 1200 A.D.*

Chandu: *Suleyman. You are at Bozuktepe, standing guard at your nighttime post at the market where people, mostly passers-by, make trade during daytime.*

SA Michael Giles: *It's for a good reason that most of the activity observed by the settlement of the Broken Hill, as they call it, is that of passing trade caravans and logistical convoys using it as a temporary rest stop on their way to more hospitable settlements. Some two hundred people live in this remote place-- you yourself will be glad to return to your hometown of Konya once your troop lifts its heels.*

SA Michael Giles: *The hill or mound in question is an ominous shape looming in the distance. It carries with itself age-old tales of ghosts and djinni inhabiting its surroundings, often taking interest in tormenting and living false lives among the local populace.*

SA Michael Giles: *How do you keep yourself awake throughout nights like these?*

SA Michael Giles: *Ya Allah. Such nonsense is naught but tales to scare children for a believer. Ayatul Kursi and we move on.*

SA Michael Giles: My thoughts are to my piety - travel has limited my possibilities to give my thanks to the Creator of the Universe and sustainer of the movements of the cosmos. I cannot wait to be back home and attend the Friday prayer among familiar faces.

Chandu: *Wise words, passed down through generations.*

Chandu: *As you make time, you look closer at the moon for a moment.*

Chandu: *Use the SANLOSS macro.*

Chandu: *It is the very same moon you've been looking at every month since you were old enough to remember.*

Chandu: *Your gaze is drawn in a different direction, to the Banāt Na'sh. Ever present, the sisters Dubhe and Merak help you pinpoint Al-Qutb, true and honest pointer of the certain north.*

Chandu: *As you follow the natural curve of the sisters, your eyes land on Al-Simak al-Rāmiḥ, the uplifted one, the steadfast defender.*

Chandu: *East, or rather, directly overhead-- Al-Nasr al-Wāqi‘ watches over the hills. The swooping eagle, ready to grasp its prey.*

Chandu: *You stop for a moment as you don't quite feel, but see a warmth emanating from the area between the guard and the eagle. It is Al-Iklīl al-Shāmālī, the Northern Crown, led by the bright Al-Fakka.*

Chandu: *This is a sight vivid like no other; never have you seen such a bright reddish-golden beam pour its celestial light upon you like so. You are filled with a certainty that it is, indeed, greeting you with the well-known warmth of an old friend.*

Chandu: *Before you've the time to formulate your thoughts about the sight, and consider why it appears to be calling to your attention, you feel a hand lightly tapping on your left pauldron.*

SA Michael Giles: Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him, has re-affirmed the moon's servitude by splitting the moon with his fingers. Allah has revealed to us its importance, but the stars - they are a mystery not yet commanded to be revealed to us.

SA Michael Giles: Who is it?

Chandu: *No one you recognize.*

???: "What do you make of the sight?"

SA Michael Giles: "I leave understanding to the astrologists. For me - it is the creator showing the beauty of the universe and permitting sight of it to us, but not reach."

???: "Thámboš," she says, in a language other than Arabic. "It is difficult to verbalize its magnitude."

SA Michael Giles: "What do you do unaccompanied at this hour?"

???: "Wrapped too tightly, I see. I've kept you long enough."

???: She rests her hand on your left pauldron again, still looking at the constellation. "Michael Giles, Staff Sergeant."

???: As she does, you are no longer Suleyman. Of course... this is a dream. An awfully vivid one, even so.

SA Michael Giles: "Huh? Where the fuck am I?" he draws back and looks around dazed.

???: "I'd attempt to explain, if it weren't for..."

Chandu: *As you speak with the redheaded apparition, a fellow Seljuk soldier walks past the two of you. He looks back and nods at you respectfully, then stops when he sees her face.*

Seljuk Imprint: "Brother?"

Seljuk Imprint: She points at the woman.

Seljuk Imprint: "Why does her hair show?"

SA Michael Giles: Giles snaps back, momentarily, "I do not know - she looks like our ancestors who were idol worshippers in their day- wait.... this is all a dream right?" he pinches his cheek really hard.

Chandu: *Giles will roll HUMINT, Ariadne will roll PERSUADE at a disadvantage.*

SA Michael Giles: SA Michael Giles rolls **Failure** -> 56 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 10%)

???: ??? rolls **Success** -> 48 (Rolling Persuade Target: 99% (80%+60%))

???: Actual rating after disadvantage: 20. **FAILURE.**

???: "I...--"

Seljuk Imprint: The soldier has already drawn a small curved blade from his hip sheath before she's had the chance to finish her sentence. The blade connects.

Seljuk Imprint: It's a practiced cut. The edge draws across the side of her throat and sections her carotid artery cleanly.

???: Bright, warm blood jumps out over the soldier's wrist and spatters across his lamellar plates. She reaches for the wound with both hands, as if offended by it more than afraid.

???: Her knees give in. She drops onto the ground-- her mouth moves once, no sound coming out of it.

???: Condition Changes Dead

Seljuk Imprint: He wipes the blade on his sleeve without ceremony.

SA Michael Giles: "What-" Giles jumps back from the blood spurts.

Chandu: *You've another chance to roll HUMINT on him.*

SA Michael Giles: SA Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 9 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 10%)

Seljuk Imprint: His motions look not only automatic, but rehearsed. It's like you're reading a reenactment book-- all you can tell is that his body language is unreadable, alien to even the dream you are currently inhabiting.

Seljuk Imprint: He turns without addressing you, and steps back on his route, unbothered by the mess he's left.

Chandu: *What now?*

SA Michael Giles: It's best I leave the area lest I be mistaken for a murderer.

Chandu: *You may move.*

Chandu: *Your boots scrape over dust and packed earth. The sound carries farther than it should.*

Chandu: *You'd expect a place like this to be somewhat more lively, despite the late hour. Contrary to that belief, there is no one here.*

Chandu: *The houses stand low and close together, built roughly. Cloth hangs from their windows without moving, a clay over still gives off heat beside a wall, but nobody tends it...*

Chandu: *You don't know this village, you don't know the streets. But you know where you are going.*

Chandu: *Your feet keep choosing turns before you do. Left past a house, right beneath an archway. Straight past a wall where someone's painted a line of Arabic script you cannot read.*

Chandu: *For a moment, it seems to glow in the moonlight.*

Chandu: *You hear a voice ahead. Low, male-- praying, maybe. It's Arabic.*

Chandu: *The mosque is small, just a low stone building with timber beams and a plain doorway. The door is open.*

SA Michael Giles: Nobody here.

Chandu: *The air is cooler inside. The floor is covered in reed mats and rough rugs. Oil lamps sit in shallow niches along the walls, giving off a dull yellow light. It smells of damp stone.*

Chandu: *At the far wall is the mihrab, indicating the direction of the Kaaba in Mecca. The praying voice continues. You don't step too far in before you see him, knelt down, dressed as one of the soldiers outside, mail under cloth.*

Chandu: *Hasan. You've been kneeling here for a long time.*

Chandu: *Long enough that your knees have gone numb against the mat, and long enough that the lamp smoke has dried your throat. It is not often that you do this. A small curved blade sits neatly on the rug in front of you. You've placed it there.*

Chandu: *What have you been praying for?*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Health and wisdom.

Chandu: *Mistake. Use the SANLOSS macro.*

Chandu: *You pray not for anyone else to hear, but for Allah's forgiveness. You ask forgiveness for your weakness, for your regret, for the knife in your hand.*

Chandu: *Then, your mind shifts. You pray for a woman who'll be born in some seven hundred years. Laos.*

Chandu: *You did it because the room had to stay quiet, because Lung had to die. Because you'd already crossed the river, and there was no point in becoming delicate at the foot of the bed.*

Chandu: *As you take the blade and press it under your jaw, you understand, with the calm certainty of someone else's despair, that there is only one clean thing left to do.*

Chandu: *Giles, you can act now.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I let the blade cut into my skin as blood drips on the floor.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I get ready for a big motion, lifting my arm.

SA Michael Giles: Giles walks up and tackles Nolan - "Wake up, man!"

Chandu: *Roll POW, blind, Hasan.*

Chandu: *It is a dream, after all. Whose past are you living? And why is Giles on top of you now, wearing heavy lamellar plate armor?*

Chandu: *You are no longer Hasan.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "What... where..."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan catches his breath.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "What the fuck are you wearing?"

SA Michael Giles: "Boy, look at yourself."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan looks around the room.

SA Michael Giles: "If you're here then others gotta be here - get the hell up" Giles stands up and extends a hand.

Chandu: *Lamellar plate armor, in an arrangement similar to his own.*

Chandu: *The small prayhouse is quiet. Only the two of you are here.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I take Giles' hand, still dazed.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Did you see anyone else?"

SA Michael Giles: "Some chick - she got killed for not covering her hair. And a soldier - not someone I know."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "For not what? Come again?"

SA Michael Giles: "I think we'll be able to tell what's a dream and what's not as we go along."

SA Michael Giles: "Brotha, don't even trip."

SA Michael Giles: "Let's move."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan nods.

Chandu: *Cold wind blows in from the open archway.*

SA Michael Giles: Giles heads out into the streets.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I follow his lead.

Chandu: *The mound is visible from out here. Again, an ominous presence in the drylands.*

SA Michael Giles: "Shiiiiit - that can't be it right?"

SA Michael Giles: Giles points to the mound.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Gotta be it."

SA Michael Giles: "Let's go, then."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Shit gives me the creeps."

SA Michael Giles: "It's just a dream. Right?"

SA Michael Giles: "Unless we actually time travelled in this bitch."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I fucking hope not."

SA Michael Giles: Giles moves to the mound.

Chandu: *You walk for some ten minutes under moonlight until you reach the mound. The sight from here, Giles, is unequivocally the same as the one you remember from earlier this very night...*

Chandu: *The mound, indeed, has been here for a very, very long time. Edward Pope's words echo in your mind.*

SA Michael Giles: "Shiit - we're here. Medieval times, I think."

Chandu: *And always, has it been considered a wrong place.*

SA Michael Giles: "Given the swords."

SA Michael Giles: Giles tugs at his sabre sheath.

Chandu: *As Corona Borealis becomes even easier to lay eyes upon, a foreign thought goes through your minds at once. "Wisely did the Prophet forbid alcohol, for it is in weakness and depravity that ghosts find purchase in the human soul."*

Chandu: *Elsewhere...*

Chandu: *Carlyle, you don't sleep. Not really.*

Chandu: *You lie there in the dark with your eyes closed, doing the thing you have learned to do since leaving Vietnam: keeping your body still enough that it can pretend to rest while your mind works through every sound in the room.*

SA Michael Giles: Giles kicks a rock - "We gotta wake up sometime soon, right?"

Chandu: *Canvas shifting. Someone breathing through his nose. A fly, a mosquito, or some other Turkish bastard flying in circles over your head.*

Chandu: *Everyone else is asleep, or drunk enough to have earned it.*

Chandu: *What's on your mind?*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "No doubt. Unless we lose our minds here."

SA Bryan Carlyle: The fact that aliens are real and there's a government agency out there chopping them up B-movie style? Well, maybe that isn't too crazy-- not much difference between aliens and the other stuff, when you really think about it. Maybe 'The Unnatural' is all the work of a bunch of Martians.

Chandu: *As you ruminate...*

Chandu: *You hear Nolan muttering something, whispering to himself in his sleep. Must be.*

Chandu: *His lips move with a dry, steady murmur. It's Arabic.*

Chandu: *Giles, lying on his back, is also muttering to himself in his sleep...*

Chandu: *...But it's also in Arabic. They're not speaking at exactly the same time. While Nolan's sounds like a minaret's prayer call, Giles' accent is wrong; like he doesn't know how to make the words cleanly. The cadence is there, though.*

Chandu: *As this goes on, you hear something moving outside the tent. Slow footsteps, several sets of them, stepping over dry ground and brittle grass as they unhurriedly walk away.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'll leave those two to their dreams and try eavesdropping on whoever's outside.

Chandu: *You can step outside.*

Chandu: *As you do, you're met by a strange sight.*

Chandu: *Three laborers, their eyes closed and backs hunched over, are walking towards the mound itself.*

Chandu: *Without a need for closer observation, you can tell that they are not wearing any shoes. Bare feet upon dry ground and brittle grass.*

Chandu: *They seem to be muttering to themselves individually as they walk, but you can't hear them from here.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm gonna walk right up to these guys, silent, just to see if they react.

Chandu: *Hit a Stealth roll.*

Chandu: *Make it blind.*

Chandu: *You quietly follow their footsteps. They don't seem to be disturbed as you step carefully.*

Laborer: "...can't have it..."

Laborer: "...rocket fuel for..."

Chandu: *As far as you can recall, none of these men speak a shred of English.*

Chandu: *You can follow them to the mound and keep listening, unless...?*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Since the idea is that the people here live out past lives in their sleep, can I hit a history roll to see if I know what they might be talking about?

Chandu: *Hit an INT roll instead.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 61 (Rolling INT Target: 70%)

Chandu: *The context is sorely lacking, but "rocket fuel for..." and "can't have it..." are certainly not the words of a Seljuk scholar, as Pope seemed to imply earlier today in his tent.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Maybe this place was a military base during the Cold War or something? Whatever, I'm gonna check that mound and head to sleep if nobody's there.

Chandu: *You keep trailing the laborers, being careful not to disturb them as the four of you make the walk over to the mound.*

Chandu: *Elsewhere...*

Chandu: *Cillian-- your dreams have not been the same since leaving Vietnam. You'd swear that in San Francisco, you replayed repeated memories of high school education, gym class, and chasing small animals when you were little.*

Chandu: *What's one particular memory you'd wish you kept replaying in these dreams? A happy one?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Tough call. I guess when Connor took his first steps.

Chandu: *So small, he was. Martha was there, laughing her heart out.*

Chandu: *Use the SANLOSS macro.*

Chandu: *There wasn't a fourth person there. You'd swear by it.*

Chandu: *However, you seem to remember a fourth.*

Chandu: *"You'd better wake them up," she says, in this faux-memory.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Condition Changes Asleep

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh yes, my wife's girlfriend, right."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He jumps out the cot in a rehearsed motion and starts kicking each of the stooges in the base of the heel.

Chandu: *It is effective!*

SA Michael Giles: Condition Changes Asleep

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Condition Changes Asleep

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Condition Changes Asleep

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Danger."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "ALLAH!"

Chandu: *Giles, Nolan, you have a clear memory of the dream.*

Chandu: *Mathieu, you're still drunk.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Condition Changes Stunned

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan trails a hand across his neck where the cut was.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I never dream. Don't know why I thought tonight would be different.

SA Michael Giles: Giles gets up out of bed.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I rub my eyes as I stagger up.

Chandu: *Nothing. Before leaving the dream, however, you noted that the blood was a thick black sludge, Nolan.*

SA Michael Giles: "Fuck you mean, danger?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...He exits the tent pointing the revolver outside.

SA Michael Giles: Giles draws his sidearm as he follows.

Chandu: *There are two footstep trails. One leading up towards the mound, one leading around to Trench #2.*

Chandu: *Roll Survival, Cillian.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 55
(Rolling Survival Target: 50%)

Chandu: *No effect. Both trails look the same, you're not able to tell which one's more recent than the other.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt rubs the side of his face, slowly drawing his piece.

SA Michael Giles: Giles remembers the dream - "To the mound, man."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm heading to the trench, then.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll wave to Giles to take Nolan and head up.

SA Michael Giles: "Whatever, man," Giles shakes his head at Cillian.

Chandu: *The other two of you are heading to the trench, then?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Yes.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan trails behind Giles.

Chandu: *The mound first, since it's closer.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Sorry, who's heading where?

Chandu: *You're going to the trench with Cillian, ackshually.*

Chandu: *You're up here, Carlyle. You have a few minutes until the two others get here, but you're unaware of that.*

Chandu: *The laborers themselves are milling about. Asleep, still.*

Chandu: *You haven't alarmed them yet. They're still muttering. English, Arabic, and a third, even a fourth, language you cannot understand.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Presumably the phenomenon I'm witnessing right now is the very same one which led to a British expat's corpse being spirited away, so I'm just gonna let this play out.

Chandu: *You hang back and focus on observation.*

Chandu: *As you do, you can hear them.*

Laborer: "I cannot let him have it..."

Laborer: "Rocket fuel... for an arsonist..."

Chandu: *Roll History once again, normal roll.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling History Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Though you're not familiar with it, it is curious; they're speaking not only in Turkish and English, but also fragments of Hittite and other, even more ancient tongue in there.*

Chandu: *Giles and Nolan are running up the mound by now. Both of them will make a blind STEALTH roll.*

Laborer: As you approach, the workers perk up in unison.

Chandu: *All three of you see them. Their eyes are still closed, they're still slumping. But now, they're slowly walking towards each of you, their fists tight.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I just turn around and look at these two like they came here off the short bus.

Laborer: One of them pulls his fist back as if preparing an imaginary blade for a stab.

SA Michael Giles: Do we remember any of the Arabic shit we said in the dream?

03 Cemal Öztürk: 03 Cemal Öztürk rolls **Success** -> 14 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Laborer: Carlyle, you've turned around. You can't resist this one, but it's quite pitiful. He basically bumps your shoulder with his fist.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Calm down, brother" says Nolan, in Arabic.

Laborer: Were that to be a real knife, that would've been a nasty stab.

Chandu: *He's unresponsive, Nolan.*

SA Michael Giles: Guess that don't matter.

Chandu: *You do remember some of the Arabic, Giles, but they're not responding to speech.*

SA Michael Giles: I guess it's best we restrain them.

Laborer: This one's going for Giles.

01 Doruk Bele: 01 Doruk Bele rolls **Success** -> 18 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Chandu: *The dream knife goes for your abdomen. You have no trouble stepping out of the way.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm thinking we just leave and see if they ignore us instead of having to explain why we beat up a bunch of day laborers.

Chandu: *Roll Alertness, Carlyle.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 56 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Looking at them closer, you can tell that their bare feet are covered in prickly flesh injuries.*

Chandu: *It's like they stepped in a thorn bush.*

06 Ibrahim Yilmaz: 06 Ibrahim Yilmaz rolls **Success** -> 30 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Chandu: *No effect. You slap his arm away, Nolan.*

Chandu: *They'll keep rolling until you do something, just so you know.*

01 Doruk Bele: 01 Doruk Bele rolls **Failure** -> 92 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

03 Cemal Öztürk: 03 Cemal Öztürk rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 55 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm leaving to see if they follow us.

Chandu: *He trips. Pitifully.*

SA Michael Giles: I guess there's nothing left to do but follow Carlyle as we interrupted his eavesdropping.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'll put this one on his ass and try to walk away.

Chandu: *Your guy slowly gets up and slumbers your way for a few seconds, Bryan, but then stops and returns to the mound. Back to milling about.*

Chandu: *No roll needed, Nolan. You easily push him over with force.*

Laborer: "I cannot let Vénice..."

Laborer: He stands up and hunches.

Laborer: This one will try a last faux stab at Giles before you go.

01 Doruk Bele: 01 Doruk Bele rolls **Success** -> 29 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Chandu: *It misses him as he's already turned around and walked a few steps.*

Chandu: *Are you heading back to the camp?*

SA Michael Giles: I guess we can head to the trench now.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Sure.

Chandu: *Okay, you've made it to the trench. Let's speed through this-- you've walked down, guns drawn...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh come on."

Chandu: *You find Edward Pope lying on the ground, dead. A rock fell on his head.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt grits his teeth. "How the hell did he end up here?"

Chandu: *That's the obvious subject matter. That's what it looks like.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Run his pockets. I'll see if he left something around, then we'll go bury him."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We can't waste any time now."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt pats him down.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Anything?

Chandu: *Mathieu, hit a blind Forensics roll as Cillian examines the site.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Did he slide off? Check for displaced bones."

Chandu: *Cillian; part of the wall has collapsed-- seemingly at the same time that Edward Pope was here, and on top of his head. The collapse has revealed more archaeological remains. There's definitely a semi-intact structure buried under the mound in Trench #2.*

Chandu: *As you're at it, you spot...*

Chandu: *Some of the mud flowing and glistening as if there's some dark liquid or slime welling up from underneath the earth.*

Chandu: *It's being sucked back down into the mud. Hit a SANLOSS roll.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm compelled to collapse this whole bullshit with Pope inside but I don't think Carstairs has any more patience for that.

Chandu: *You're baffled at the sight. The crystalline substance fleeing from you in the crate was something-- this is bigger, of course.*

Chandu: *Mathieu. He was killed instantly by the stone-- but it is an unlikely way to die. It looks more like someone bludgeoned his head with a rock before causing the collapse.*

Chandu: *As for his pockets, there's nothing of interest. He didn't leave a suicide note.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt cross-references the collapsed area and the body's location. He concludes, "Someone hit him with a stone, wasn't an accident."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Do you think it was a male or a female?" Obviously, number one should cause much more catastrophic wounds.

Chandu: *His skull is crushed in by the rock, Mathieu-- additionally, the rubble on top of him shows signs of being banged at with possibly the same rock that was used to kill him.*

Chandu: *It was a male, you'd guess from this.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Male."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Shit."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "This is not good. We have no time to play whodunnit with a bunch of Turks."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Let's get outta here and get the jeep. Doubt there's a shortage of shovels and picks."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He leaves the body, keeping a hand on his piece.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I mean fucking grab him you moron."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Watch for your head."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "I don't read minds, man." I lift him by the shoulders.

Chandu: *By the time you're done lugging him outside, you meet the other three up top.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We found him like this."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We need to get rid of him. Now."

SA Michael Giles: "The hell? Wasn't this dude daydrinking this afternoon?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "You sure?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He was murdered."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We need to run the block in case the killer isn't fast asleep yet. I need two volunteers to go put him underground."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "I'll dig."

SA Michael Giles: "I'll do it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Perfect." I throw the Jeep keys at Giles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: The other two will move up with me, I reckon they'll find something.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt lugs the body over to Giles. "All yours."

SA Michael Giles: Giles will get this corpse to the jeep with Nolan.

Chandu: *Alright. As Giles and Nolan carry and stuff Pope's corpse into one of the Jeeps, the others will search the camp for the murderer...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Going to his tent first is the logical start, and then we could trace the steps.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We also need to grab whatever to make it look like he packed up and left.

Chandu: *Easily done. I assume you're loading his bags into the other Jeep, then roaming the grounds.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Yes, if we find nothing special in his tent.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Unfortunately he'll just have to vanish.

Chandu: *It's done in no time. He left absolutely nothing new on his tent-- his Egyptology book is still there, and there are no loose bookmarks. Open liquor bottles still reek the place up. You make sure to stuff some of those in the bag as well.*

Chandu: *Once you're done, you search through the camp. Nothing. Some of the cots in the worker tents are empty, though-- Carlyle knows why.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Where did they go?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "They were out sleepwalking, believe it or not. Giles and Nolan can vouch for me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

Chandu: *You can lead them up to the mound in no time. You make your way over there...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Let's go see them, if they bashed his head in with rocks they would certainly have some roughening in their palms.

Chandu: *Here they are. They've been joined by two others.*

Chandu: *These are five out of the thirty total workers in the site, for reference. They're all sleepwalking, eyes closed, slumping around.*

Chandu: *Mac can make a stealth roll for the approach.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He looks at them for a moment with his hands on his waist. "What is this nonsense..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 12 (Rolling Stealth Target: 70%)

Laborer: "Cannot let him have it..."

Laborer: "Rocket fuel..."

Laborer: "...for an arsonist..."

Chandu: *They don't react to your careful steps. They're just here, doing fuck all.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You think they are trying to communicate?"

Chandu: *They are all barefoot with tiny injuries on their feet.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Rocket fuel for an arsonist? Is it about what's buried here?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: They saying anything else?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I see it making sense."

Chandu: *Cillian, you can also recall that none of these men seemed to speak any English during your tour here.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "...Sounds disjointed to me."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Or maybe they're being figurative and talking about Edward."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You wanna find out?"

Laborer: "...forgive me..."

Laborer: "...Eloise..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm going to address one of them. "What's the big deal?"

Chandu: *He just turns towards you and raises his fist, as if handling a large knife.*

03 Cemal Öztürk: 03 Cemal Öztürk rolls **Success** -> 3 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Chandu: *It is effortless to swish his hand.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm just trying to ask you a question, asshole."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Answer me before I knock you awake."

Laborer: "...cannot..."

Laborer: "...have it..."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "C'mon, man, this is all they did last time too. They're basically zombies."

05 Ali Karaca: 05 Ali Karaca rolls **Failure** -> 90 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

Chandu: *He misses.*

Chandu: *They're all, as far as you can tell, OUT COLD.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm going to backstep from these stooges."

Chandu: *Sleepwalking.*

Chandu: *They slowly slumber, following your steps.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "They might fall off."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hmm..."

Chandu: *It'd be a roll downhill rather than a brutal fall, you reckon.*

Chandu: *Fifty feet, light incline.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "As I said, if they brutalized the man with a rock, they might have injuries inside their hands."

Chandu: *Now that you remind me, Mathieu does observe dust on this man's hands.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'll get close."

Laborer: "It's the same color as the rocks down in Trench #2. Of course, for a prosecutor, there'd have to be chemical tests involved."

Laborer: "You can tell, though."

Laborer: "Vénice... cannot..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Who knows how many months this is going to take. And to charge him for a murder he doesn't even know he committed.

Laborer: "...have it..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This whole thing is fishy. I'm just gonna let them talk for a while, they seem unresponsive.

Chandu: *You listen for a while, piecing the scraps together as they slowly chase you around slashing with mock knives. "Vénice cannot have it." "It would be like giving rocket fuel to an arsonist." "Forgive me, Eloise."*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: If he didn't bother washing his hands after killing him- he was almost certainly like this when it happened. This makes pulling that drunk stunt again insanely dangerous, we can't sleep here again.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Let's just go back.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "They're guarding the place subconsciously or something."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't intend to stop them."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What are the ladies up to?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Maybe they're possessed... in some way. They didn't speak English before."

Chandu: *By the time you're done up here, and the guys are done giving Pope an improvised burial, the sun will be about to rise up. Do you want to head back to your cots and pretend to have slept through everything, or are you heading off somewhere else with the cars?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: There is no explanation as to how Pope made the voyage outside of here, but we could all come up with a lie.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We could tell the rest that he woke us up and made him drive to Diyarbakır.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He would be picked up by a friend but we left before we could see him. I think it beats having a very mysterious missing persons case.

Chandu: *We'll expedite it.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Since we're out there we really really need to get to a phone and call Carstairs.

Chandu: *12 AUG 1968 - 0700C*

Chandu: *Jale was baffled at your explanation, but doesn't really contest it. She says she's forced to drive over to Diyarbakir herself to get in contact with the British Institute about Pope up and leaving.*

Chandu: *Nolan and Giles buried Pope without inconveniences or interruptions. He won't be found out here-- even less when the dam is constructed in two years, and the whole plain is flooded.*

Chandu: *What's the next move? It's the early morning.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Phone call.

Chandu: *No phone here. You'll have to head over to Diyarbakir AS.*

Chandu: *Proceed?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Yes.

Chandu: *0900C*

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Yes, hello?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's on. We can't talk over the phone."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Too much detail."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "The line is secure, Campbell won't chirp. Speak freely."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "My coffee's getting cold..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I really do not trust you with that."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I mean it."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Unless you tell me what you've got on Whiteman, this phone call will have been an excellent waste of our time."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "What happened?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We know the truth and a lot more. Can you arrange a two way flight for me at least? Or for yourself if you would grace us with your presence."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Fine. Better for you to stay in the area. I don't need you waiting around for me for four hours, though."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Unless you want to. I suppose."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Goodbye."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yeah."

Chandu: *Phone's dead!*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Cool, now I guess I get to spend some time in the city.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Or at the base where might be a fresh Coca Cola.

Chandu: *The air base's just east of the city itself, it's about a twenty minute drive there. However, there's plenty of shade and air-conditioned rooms at base.*

Chandu: *It'll be five hours on the dot.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Aren't we about done investigating the dig site anyway? We could shoot some shit with the team.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Not a very bright idea to dig in any further without direction.

Chandu: *The conference room is free to use. So is the outside, but it's a scorcher out there.*

Chandu: *Speak freely, we'll skip over to 1400C otherwise. You're hydrated and fed.*

SA Michael Giles: "Did anyone else dream anything weird?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Sh."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He points at his ears.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Not the place."

SA Michael Giles: "Aight."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This is why I said we could go out to the city.

Chandu: *Well, you have a shower and a meal at base then split off to Diyarbakir.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: In fucking fact I don't even trust the cars we have been issued.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Can we like tear them apart and put them back together for bugs or something.

SA Michael Giles: Just leave them and don't talk in them.

Chandu: *Does anyone have Craft (Mechanics) or another skill they might consider relevant? The difficulty is in how thorough you'll be.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Negative.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: What Giles suggested. We could just move on.

Chandu: *Diyarbakir itself is a relatively small city, though one of, if not the biggest out this far east. People go about their days in shirtsleeves You can easily find a clearing to park the Jeeps at and look them over.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Actually we could find a nice establishment to meet with Carstairs in. Rather than the boonies.

Chandu: *Fifty meters away from the cars ought to be enough. Feel free to speak.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'd like to do that.

Chandu: *You find an ubiquitous café. You ring the base and leave a message for her to meet you out there?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll just pick her up from there.

Chandu: *We skip through it.*

Chandu: *DIYARBAKIR, 1400C*

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She places a backpack on a hair and swipes a drop of sweat off her forehead. You're all sipping on glass coke bottles by now.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Alright, what've you got?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He's dead to suicide. His student too, but he got murdered earlier today."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "That's not it. Something huge is down there."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That's strange. Was he coerced into suicide?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "In the excavation?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Below the excavation. They are close to it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's real."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Why'd Pope get murdered?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "And-- do they know, the staff?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He got killed by a fucking sleepwalking day laborer- he probably doesn't even know he just killed someone before he woke up."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Something is controlling people there."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The staff totally knows something is there, but they don't know what."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Blowing it to high heavens would be complicated."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "With so many civilians involved at the dig, I mean."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I was thinking of caving the whole thing and killing the staff in their sleep, but eeeh..." *He clicks his tongue and looks away in embarrassment.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She remains silent for a moment.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You have to look into why Whiteman killed himself, have you dug anything up concerning that?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "How does an archaeologist kill himself mid-dig? It makes no sense."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He was probably driven to kill himself by the same thing that puppeteered that day laborer to kill Pope. He was also an addict, so he was open to influence. We suspect that substance use has something to do with being possessed."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...We tried to pull it off."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Worked for the two of us."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Whatever is down there wants to kill whatever that gets too close to it, that's the highlight."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "It's not a question of proof, then."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She strokes her jaw.

Chandu: *Roll INT, Mac.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 62 (Rolling INT Target: 60%)

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Did you think of Whiteman's movements before he ended it?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He left some sobby notes for a certain Eloise, not to mention the staff having been on dinners with Claude Bonaventura. He was almost certainly tied to A-M."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Might give some insight into why he killed himself-- Pope's death was violent, Whiteman's was self-inflicted, the way you tell it."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You mean Claude Francisci, from Saigon? That's nonsense, the guy hasn't set foot outside the Continental since the shootout."

SA Michael Giles: "Man - can't those A-M mothafuckas resurrect things? You think he killed himself cause he getting initiated into the immortal freaks gang?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Where did you say they met?"

SA Michael Giles: "Maybe that's why his body disappeared."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Do I just have the notes and the photo?

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She points at Giles and nods slowly, as if thinking about it.

Chandu: *You do, Mac.*

Chandu: *As she looks them over.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh shit, I forgot to mention."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Here."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "'Dinner with Claude, Mersin'."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll show her the note about the alchemical crap.

SA Michael Giles: "He finds himself in a conveniently corrupt country then kills himself. Body gets taken by people who have the money to easily buy anyone."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She reads it over, her eyebrows perking up as she does.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't know precisely who facilitated this but as far as glowing goes Jale's assistant is someone we know suspiciously little of."

SA Michael Giles: "Hell - maybe the site itself was required for him to get initiated into the gang - infused with juju or somethin'."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "And she grew up in London, so totally not just some academic jabroni."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "This is a goldmine. It does look like he was being inducted, judging from this. But his diary tells a different story."

SA Michael Giles: "Red herring?" Giles shrugs.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "He was regretful about staying in Turkey..." she flips through the pages. "Eloise is his sister. There are letters here." She brandishes them.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Anyway. We can't patrol the site at night anymore, not without the risk of having to kill several people."

SA Michael Giles: "Regretful about staying in Turkey, missing his family after sacrificing them to pursue his career.... sounds like a boiler plate suicide note to me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The whole place is a hazard. As far as I'm concerned we did our jobs here."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Of course. Sleep at the air station, only head there during daylight-- if you think that's relevant."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Well, not quite."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Dinner with Claude at Mersin."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What do you mean not quite?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Look into this. This is not Claude Francisci, I'm certain of it."

SA Michael Giles: "We goin' to try and find a restaurant they would have dinner at or what?"

SA Michael Giles: "I presume they probably just had dinner at a hotel restaurant."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That man is nothing but a pencil pusher, plus he's terrified out of his breeches."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Jale said something about leaving in two weeks."

SA Michael Giles: "We gotta find the most continental one, I guess."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Did you ask the people around camp for this Claude's identity? Pope's dead, of course, you're not getting anything out of him."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Did anyone else seem outwardly suspicious?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "No. Given that we found out about him by breaking into his tent."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We'll have to come up with an excuse to start that conversation."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "As for the rest, it's just a series of dumb to dumber day laborers. I don't think they have the slightest idea."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Their cargo is goldmine too."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "You're narcotics agents investigation the French Connection. You can work something out, you can exert some pressure."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We could drive you there if you want, but you might have other ideas."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I need to be back by tonight, really-- was anyone else in the room as you looked through their cargo?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Their boss."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He didn't stop us."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't think he knows."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Uncharacteristically cooperative, you say?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Are you sure he wasn't standing between you and some crates?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I get it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Although the poor guy was just trying to get a tip in dollars, whatever, we'll do our best."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She tilts her head. "You don't need a pat in the back. Be yourself."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Put some pressure on it."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "So, this Claude is a person of interest. The cargo hasn't been searched thoroughly."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Looks like a checklist to me. Anything else?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "So do we try to halt the dig or to proceed the dig?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "As far as you've told me, the dig seems to be at a standstill."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "The lead archaeologist isn't letting them dig in the second trench, correct?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Make sure it stays that way-- though it's apparently leaking already."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Okay. Just needed to see where this whole thing was going."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Take this." I'll write a small number on a notepad."Caesar cipher for the next phonecall."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Gonna be annoying but beats being leaked."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "This is real, all of it."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She reads it over and stuffs it in her pocket.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "If you insist. We'll talk soon."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Actually I have one last question before I go."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Right?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "All five of us wonder where you're from."

Chandu: *Hit a Persuade check.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 94 (Rolling Persuade Target: 20%)

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "That information is wholly classified."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What the fuck?"

SA Michael Giles: "Yeeeeaaaah right." Giles sucks his teeth.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm more baffled than ridiculed.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "I'm joking. This isn't the time for games, anyway. Florida."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Is that it?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You almost got me there."

SA Michael Giles: She's Cuban then.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Maybe you aren't a lizard after all."

SA Michael Giles: Miss Bay of Pigs.

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Yeah, yeah. Let's get back on track now."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Be thorough, don't die."

Chandu: *It is...*

Chandu: *1530C*

Chandu: *By the time it's all said and done. Where to?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: It's gonna be a long way to the damn dig site from here isn't it.

Chandu: *Two hours, not that long a drive. Before we proceed, let's take our ten minute break here.*

Chandu: *BOZUKTEPE, 1720C*

Chandu: *You're back here. The camp is back to life.*

Chandu: *There are no alarms ringing out nor any Turkish gendarme vehicles parked out here. At a first glance, it appears Pope's death hasn't had any catastrophic repercussions.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Because he is gone, not dead.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: That being said I think we should search the cargo again without the foremans interference. Maybe secretly get some laborers on it with some ten dollar bills?

Chandu: *You can #proceed into the Camp.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "These two are lazing around again?"

Chandu: *As you step over to the central mess area, you see Asil Demir chatting with these two guys.*

Asil Demir: He turns to you. "Ah, no, my friend. We were speaking about the progress in trench #1."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What about it?"

Asil Demir: "It is slow but fruitful work. We were going over safety measures."

Asil Demir: He shrugs.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "So do you actually need these two?"

Asil Demir: "They are about to set out. I have free time on my hands."

Asil Demir: "How can I help?"

Chandu: *The two guys pick their shit up after Asil says a couple of things in Turkish and look about ready to leave.*

Chandu: *Mathieu, you understand it: "Get to work."*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Alright, you can go back to work."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Nothing."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We're five people, we can just go do it.

Asil Demir: "I will be here if you need coffee, food, or anything else. Simply shout 'ASIL!' and I will come running."

Asil Demir: He smiles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yeah"...I really don't think this guy is in on it but Carstairs had a fair point.

SA Michael Giles: "Don't have to tire yourself on our account, man. Take it easy."

Asil Demir: "No, no, Americans are guests of honor here. It is the Science Foundation funding, you see."

Asil Demir: He nods and heads over to the mess itself.

Chandu: *WHAT NOW?*

SA Michael Giles: Let's go to the stores, then.

SA Michael Giles: We were going to look it over, right?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Yes.

Chandu: *AS YOU HEAD OVER.*

Asil Demir: He comes running, as he said he would!

Asil Demir: "Ah my friends!"

Asil Demir: "I will help you again. The workers made a mess inside."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

Asil Demir: He nonchalantly walks across and inside.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I didn't say anything about that now did I?"

SA Michael Giles: "Maaaaan."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't think it could be any more obvious." He signals the group to come closer.

Chandu: *He just saw you coming over this way and reacted, nothing to it.*

SA Michael Giles: "I hope we don't have to kill this guy."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Let's tie him to his bed tonight and just do it."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "No need for a kill, maybe just some disgruntled laborers."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He shakes his head. "He seemed sincere. I bet the workers messed the place up while sleepwalking."

Asil Demir: He's arranging the crates out for you again. It's the full, same spread.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "If you choose to believe that."

Asil Demir: He then heads over to the other side of the room.

Asil Demir: And he just waits. The crates are out for you to check over again.

SA Michael Giles: "I guess some of us can stay here sorting."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt walks ahead and into the tent, just to check it out. Is this guy just a slave or something? There's no way he's that eager without any ulterior motive.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Can I roll HUMINT? Maybe he's nervous.

Chandu: *Go ahead and roll it up.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Success** -> 13
(Rolling HUMINT Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Mathieu, it isn't until now that you've noticed that he's sweating like a fucking faucet. He's studying every single one of your moves, and now that you think about it-- he has been always within visual range for as long as you've been in the camp, except during your trench visit.*

Chandu: *It's hot out here, but not that hot.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Okay. I'd just like to go over the shipping manifest again."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm just wasting his time on purpose to get out of here.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt gives Asil a side-eye, standing beside Mac.

Asil Demir: "Ah, of course!" He quickly reaches for a clipboard and hands it over to you.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Nothing important, lets just spend some time here and get the hell out.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We need to talk to Jale.

SA Michael Giles: This guy is a fucking narc.

Chandu: *It's innocuous enough. It lists bills of lading for "EURY INTL SHIPPING" at MERSIN. This appears to be the company handling ship transport for cargo from Bozukepe to England.*

Chandu: *Logically, this would be the same company handling the transport of Whiteman's corpse.*

Asil Demir: "Everything in order, you see?"

SA Michael Giles: We might have to investigate that in Mersin later.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm gonna pull out the photo with Claude.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What can you tell me about this?"

Chandu: *Which photo did you mean?*

Chandu: *The one of Whiteman and Pope?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Dinner.

Chandu: *Ah, the appointment.*

Asil Demir: He scratches the back of his head.

Asil Demir: "Professor Whiteman and the CEO of our shipping company. He often went and came to and from Mersin every other week."

Asil Demir: "Claude Eury, you can see it here." He points at "EURY SHIPPING INTL" on the clipboard.

Asil Demir: "Very honest man. Excellent rates." He nods and smiles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Have you heard any rumors about Jale and her assistant?"

Asil Demir: He strokes his jaw.

Asil Demir: "Rumors?"

Asil Demir: "Are they lesbians, my friend?"

Asil Demir: "That is haram."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "That's none of our business. I didn't mean that."

Asil Demir: "Professor Inan is married. I doubt it." He looks into the distance, truthfully thinking about it.

Chandu: *Hit an Alertness roll.*

Chandu: *Any of you can hit it, you're all looking at him.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: We're all psychoanalyzing his bald ass.

SA Michael Giles: SA Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 29 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Giles. He's leaning on a tarp-covered surface. By the indentations on the dust and canvas, you can tell that it's a crate.*

Chandu: *He was leaning on it last night, too, when you searched through the rest of the crates.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Giving Mac a nudge. He whispers, "He's suspicious. Either he knows more than he lets on or feds put him on edge. Could be both."

Chandu: *You just all failed to notice it.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I've had it with this fucking farce we know what to do. Let's go.

SA Michael Giles: Giles nudges Nolan and points to the crate.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan nods.

Chandu: *What're you looking to do as you head out?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Jale, the photo.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hey. Bet you missed me."

Chandu: *She's poring over some claywork brought back from trench #1, laid on canvas.*

Dr. Jale İnan: "Good afternoon..." She's brushing away at it with a tiny brush.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Have you found anything out?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Can you tell me more about this photo?"

Chandu: *She looks over the picture of Whiteman's dinner arrangements, squinting her eyes...*

Dr. Jale İnan: "Claude? It must be Eury, the man in charge of shipping the recovered samples and remains back to England."

Dr. Jale İnan: "It's no secret. Although I can't say why he'd have dinners with him on such a regular basis."

Dr. Jale İnan: "Perhaps they became good friends." She turns back to the brush and clay.

SA Michael Giles: "Keep the rates reasonable, huh?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We do wonder, do you have any theories as to why Pope packed up and left for no reason?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "No, I was about to ask," she stands and looks at his tent, left ransacked and abandoned.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Does your assistant have any ideas?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Did he say anything to you on the way to the city? I knew he took Whiteman's suicide very harshly, but..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Well. All he said was that in the end his death did not matter in the long run."Which is something he actually said to me.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Selma is out in trench #1, but she is just as clueless as I am. Attributes it to depression."

Dr. Jale İnan: "That is macabre."

Dr. Jale İnan: "I don't know. Either way, I've gotten in contact with the Institute. They will leave a message when they hear from him."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Okay then."Barring the fact that no one but me is doing any talking I think the next stop is Trench #1

Chandu: *We're jumping over.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Could we think of something more sophisticated to KO the foreman?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Does Matthieu have enough pharmacy to get some of that good good from a laborer and slip it to him?

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Well... I have 70%. Chandu's fiat if it's enough without a roll.

Chandu: *Hit a roll, we'll call it.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We need sleep and heroin has plenty to give.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 1 (Rolling Pharmacy Target: 70%)

Chandu: *Mathieu-- out of the 30 workers in the camp, you find the one honest heroin addict in this place. He not only agrees to sell you some injectable horse at a premium (taken from ops*

budget), but also informs you that...Asil Demir provides this to the two or three other addicts in the camp, but he's a small guy in the grand scheme of things. Logistical piece, that is.

Chandu: *The point is: he has a connection. The extent of it, or what for, besides slinging small amounts of dope, is unknown to you as of now.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Intriguing. I won't press the guy lest I scare him off- Asil will have more to say, anyway.

Chandu: *He's happy to have made your acquaintance and compliments your rudimentary Turkish.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We'll bide our time.

Chandu: *We're now in trench #1.*

Selma Aydın: She bobs her head. "He was depressed, broken, shellshocked. Whatever you want to call it."

Selma Aydın: "They'll send a replacement soon, just as they will with Whiteman."

Selma Aydın: "I did find some new rubble in trench #2, though."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "And this?"

Selma Aydın: She looks at it closer.

Selma Aydın: "I didn't really interact with Whiteman past basic instructions, but he was out and about every week or two."

Selma Aydın: "Went on his own, came back two days later, usually."

Selma Aydın: "If Edward was here, I'm sure he'd tell you all of it."

Selma Aydın: "Anyway, about that rubble. It looked strange."

Selma Aydın: She eyes the five of you over.

Selma Aydın: "Did any of you head back to trench #2 after we got done?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "What about it?"

Selma Aydın: "I think someone went hog wild at it and tried to cause a bigger collapse than Whiteman's. It's impossible that the stanchions would collapse."

Selma Aydın: "It did reveal even more of the structure underneath, though. I suppose I should thank whoever it was."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...Is it trying to be found instead?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You look too pretty to be doing all this shit. It's a shame."

Selma Aydın: "I'm plunging head-first into a fulfilling career in an illustrious field of science. I suppose I wouldn't mind flinging pistols in another life."

Selma Aydın: She shrugs.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You got a big mouth that's for sure. Maybe the hypothetical guy is lucky he got spared, after all. Have fun."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm out of things to do. ANYONE HAVE SUGGESTIONS?

Selma Aydın: "Bye-bye." She turns back to her work.

Chandu: *You'll be heading back to the central mess...*

Chandu: *As you gather your thoughts, time seems to be progressing.*

Chandu: *1800C.*

Chandu: *As it does, you observe a single vehicle arrive at the parking spot. You can see it from here.*

Chandu: *It is easily recognizable-- it belongs to the Turkish Army.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Oh no.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: About time we talked to someone serious.

Chandu: *As soon as it comes to a stop, and the dust starts to settle, the front doors open. So does one of the back passenger seat doors.*

Chandu: *Out come two soldiers, who simply start milling about and smoking. The most interesting arrival is the passenger.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He cuts an almost comical figure-- his face is mostly hidden by a bushy beard, dark glasses, and a wide-brimmed Panama hat. He appears to be astoundingly clumsy and awkward, tripping over upon dismounting and nearly losing his hat in the wind.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He walks over to the central mess-- Jale Inan has already come over to see who it is.

Chandu: *They'll be having a chat. You can just hang back or come up closer.*

Chandu: *What are we doing?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Of course we want a damn chat.

Chandu: *Feel free to move.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: His voice is raspy, sunken.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Professor Inan..." He nods, reaching for his hat.

Dr. Jale Inan: "Eh... and you are, sir?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: You note the British accent as he speaks. "Doctor Austen Gilbert. I've been sent here from Greece, responding to the Institute's demands of a new lead archaeologist..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "...I am ready to relieve you and send you on your way."

Dr. Jale Inan: She raises her eyebrows, in the first sign of amenability you've observed from her so far.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He just comes out of nowhere and takes over? With soldiers in tow? Can I get a HUMINT on this freak.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I want to put a hand on this guys shoulder.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hello Professor."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He reaches into his bag, pulling out a bundle of letters as he turns around to greet you.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "...Yes?" He asks, his voice raspy.

Dr. Jale Inan: She grabs onto the paperwork and reads it over.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I just wanted to say welcome."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "BNDD."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "This place has been under investigation for a while. I'm sure you know why."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah..." He nods, looking you up and down. "Well met... Austen Gilbert."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Yes... a tragedy..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Doctor Whiteman was a great man..."

Dr. Jale İnan: She's done reading over the paperwork.

Dr. Jale İnan: "Well, it looks legitimate. You understand that I will have to check in at Diyarbakir before leaving, yes?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "So, may I hear of your plans on what to do with the site?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He turns to Inan. "Of course, of course... no insult. You seem to be a professional." He turns once again to you.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah, well.... we will continue the excavation in earnest..." he coughs, his throat stuck with phlegm. "And get this site back on track..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He raises his fist in a triumphant gesture.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Like a lamb to the slaughter. I have a plan.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Would you like to have a chat tonight?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Seeing you just arrived."

Dr. Jale İnan: She raises one of the letters. "There's letters from Whiteman here." She passes one over to you, Mac.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Are you sick, sir?" Matt interjects. Why is his voice so raspy?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: THE PLAN: Get him drunker than me.

Chandu: *It is Whiteman's handwriting. It indicates that should anything unexpected happen, such as an accident or debilitating injury that required hospitalization, Dr. Austen Gilbert, from Cambridge, would take over the site in his stead.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We'll just drive him crazy and this whole shit will be sealed in no time after he offs himself.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah yes... very well... I will have to set my tent in order and get... a feel for the current state of the excavation..."

Chandu: *Mathieu, roll Medicine.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Perfect. I'll see you at 8."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Failure** -> 61 (Rolling Medicine Target: 20%)

Chandu: *I'm certain your rating is higher. We'll address that later. At a glance at his pallid skin, you'd say that he's suffering from porphyria, a rare condition that makes the skin vulnerable to sunlight.*

Chandu: *He does appear to be sick, like he's caught a heavy cold.*

SA Michael Giles: Does Mac still have that fungicide?

Chandu: *Apart from that, he's wearing gloves and his clothing is packed quite tightly. He should be boiling dressed like that, but he's not sweating.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: The can of unknown shit we don't know how to use. Can wait.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "You were doing what in Greece, you said, sir?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: Dr. Austen Gilbert rolls **Failure** -> 92 (Rolling CHA Target: 55%)

SA Michael Giles: I just had a thought. A hunch.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah yes... I was conducting excavations in Crete... very fruitful, but I could not let this opportunity to honor my friend's wishes come to pass..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I was torn apart when I heard of Charles' death..."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Oh, did you just... drop them?"

Dr. Jale İnan: "Alright, I'm off to Diyarbakir. I will be back by tonight. If everything is in order, I am leaving at first light tomorrow."

Chandu: *The name was French, Cillian. It was not an Englishman, most certainly.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "The work in Crete can wait... this excavation is nearly finished... it needs only a little push..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "What brings you... gentlemen here...?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He coughs.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Besides Charles' death... nasty business... but narcotics...?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: What WAS our official reason to be at the excavation? Maybe we can press him for a search, if we got a good one.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...I think you might need to hire a new foreman."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We'll discuss it later."

Chandu: *BNDD is officially in the area to track down heroin trade in this stretch of land, and find out how they're getting it out of here.*

Chandu: *Whiteman's research was partially funded by the US National Science Foundation, again.*

Chandu: *Anyway. Gilbert is going off to assess the situation in the trenches.*

Chandu: *What are you doing for now?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We'll find an opening to get that heroin in the foreman's blood.

SA Michael Giles: This guy is a fucking alien.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: One of us should shadow Gilbert.

SA Michael Giles: We should kill him.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'm not good at sneaking around, myself.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Or maybe he is just English how do you know.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: He's here to transcend for sure.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'll handle drugging Asil.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll help.

Chandu: *Alright. Let's abstract this a little.*

SA Michael Giles: We got Dawid Bowie in our squad we know how Englishmen look.

Chandu: *Do you intend to do it now, or during the night? There is no "wrong" approach here, I just need to know how you intend to do it.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Whatever that puts him to sleep long enough to go rummage the cargo after I beat Gilbert in a drinking contest.

Chandu: *Yes, he's out and about the site. We're abstracting it AFTER you determine a semblance of a plan, so we can determine what would be appropriate to roll.*

Chandu: *Oh, also.*

Chandu: *Asil Damir approached Gilbert right as he made his way out.*

Chandu: *He's enthusiastic to be working with a new lead archaeologist.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: We inject him Dexter style.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Let's slip it into his dinner?

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Asil is a Grade S hustling weasel.

Chandu: *Let's have a Stealth roll by Mac, followed by a Pharmacy roll by Mathieu.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Is the Pharmacy roll for figuring out a dose...?

Chandu: *Yes. Eating heroin isn't really a safe way to do this sort of thing.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I thought I had a high enough rating to just pass it. But alright. I love gambling.

Chandu: *It's a good way to die.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 2 (Rolling Stealth Target: 70%)

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: --It's why I suggested injecting, but it's Mac's call.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Fuck.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Yeah I'm not gonna go against your wishes here.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I can pin him easily.

SA Michael Giles: Wouldn't eating heroin be less effective as a delivery method than injection?

SA Michael Giles: Stomach acid and so forth.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Let's do that instead...? Eating heroin is a really, really stupid way to go about it. I'd interject if Mac allowed me- if there's so many addicts here, they gotta have syringes lying around.

Chandu: *You got a few clean syringes from that initial addict you found. Okay, let's backtrack. No eating it.*

Chandu: *We'll use that stealth roll, though.*

Chandu: *Mac-- you can choose the place where you'll ambush him. Your Melee rating is so high it isn't even a question of whether you can hold him down effectively, and Mathieu can easily find the vein to inject in.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: His tent? Can't think of a better place to KO him.

Chandu: *Alright, We'll skip forward to after sunset...*

Chandu: *1900C*

Chandu: *So, by now, the staff and laborers have either gone to bed, or are ready to go.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: A quick takedown over his stomach should help us stay anonymous.

Chandu: *You carefully step through behind and around the tents until you find his own. He's reading over some records before sleeping, and the place is secluded enough.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll press his head against the ground.

Chandu: *You slip under his tent's canvas, popping up right behind him. As said-- he's surprised, your successful Stealth and high Melee rating is overwhelming.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt already has the smack ready for injection. It's a second's work.

Asil Demir: "M--MMHMHMMHMMHMH!!!"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

Chandu: *Mathieu, you pin the syringe in his arm, into the big fat vein running vertically across it. Just the right dosage to take him out for the rest of the night, and maybe so more.*

Chandu: *He'll not die.*

Asil Demir: Condition Changes Unconscious

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Anything worthwhile in his tent before we correct him on the bed and go?

Chandu: *Let's see...*

Chandu: *Hit a Search roll, visible.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 57 (Rolling Search Target: 40%)

Chandu: *There's not much here besides the typical record and document arrangement. There's an itinerary for material pick-up, though-- the trucks that are supposed to come in and take the crates out to Mersin for transport.*

Chandu: *They're delayed-- they've been delayed since Whiteman's death.*

Chandu: *That is all you get to see here.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Fortunate. They could have been gone instead. Let's move.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Can we split here. 4 searches the crates while I make sure Gilbert is not going anywhere.

Chandu: *You note that Gilbert has appropriated Whiteman's tent during his stay here. Furthermore, to recap: Inan did just return-- the paperwork is CLEAR and Gilbert is, according to the British Institute, authorized to take over the site.*

Chandu: *She'll be leaving at first light tomorrow. So she says.*

Chandu: *Alright. Back to the stores.*

SA Michael Giles: Giles will be in the stores checking the crate he was leaning on.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Yeah I'm wondering about that too.

Chandu: *Alright, team. You get your hands on it...*

SA Michael Giles: Slimy fuck.

Chandu: *There's a few things here.*

Chandu: *A simple search turns up an unsent letter from Demir to Claude Eury, listing the contents of the next shipment of archaeological remains to England. It's simple enough. Archaeological stuff.*

Chandu: *Giles, hit SEARCH, blind.*

Chandu: *In the crates...Archaeological samples, archaeological samples... and a thin layer of archaeological samples covering a stack of bricks of heroin. Clearly, someone's smuggling heroin here.*

Chandu: *Carlyle, roll Alertness, blind.*

Chandu: *Mathieu, you roll instead.*

Chandu: *We'll park his.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: SA Bryan Carlyle rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 1 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Firstly, Mathieu.*

Chandu: *You note that some of crates containing heroin are marked with a small mark that resembles the letters A-M.*

Chandu: *You couldn't be sure, though. They're scribbly....*

Chandu: *As for Carlyle...*

Chandu: *You find a crate containing a mummified corpse. You'd provisionally date it to around 1000 A.D., so it's possibly not from the mound dig, but from one of Whiteman's mystery expeditions into the hills. The corpse has been wrapped in plastic, but it's been bundled into the crate without any care for preserving the archaeology of the find. There are a handful of black and white photographs tucked in with the remains, showing the hill tombs where it was found. This crate is also marked "A-M."*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I couldn't be sure about what I saw at the temple, so I'll just say it: "The heroin's branded with 'A-M'."

SA Michael Giles: "That's what I mothafuckin' thought."

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm gonna stab this corpse's head in before I even tell the others about it.

Chandu: *The mummified skull crackles and collapses under the weight of your blade.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Come look at this."

Chandu: *It's inanimate, as it was before. However-- you do notice that it looks like it was stuffed here without much care for the packing.*

Chandu: *It's like they just shoved it in here, not like an actual valuable piece of archaeological cargo.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I genuinely think I have an idea here.

Chandu: *You'd expect such a find would be packed more carefully.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: What if the evil A-M heroin is evil because they mix up mummy dust in it.

Chandu: *An interesting theory. Chemical analysis would be able to tell.*

Chandu: *Whether it's been adulterated, that is.*

Chandu: *You'd need facilities for that.*

SA Michael Giles: I don't think it's mummy dust.

SA Michael Giles: It's more likely the crystalline shit we found.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Lets secure samples and incinerate the body, I don't think its a good idea to disrupt heroin right now.

SA Michael Giles: The one that reacts to people.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Actually in fact lets just straight up not disturb anything because Carstairs will peg me if we break the lead again

Chandu: *Mac-- these are likely to be Asil's main concern, the fact that the heroin shipments have been delayed.*

SA Michael Giles: Have they been delayed because of the corpse theft/suicide?

SA Michael Giles: I presume the shipping company is in hot water and they can't move any of this shit.

Chandu: *That's the only relevant event to put the digsite in a chokehold, besides Whiteman's personal addiction.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We could let them do it and trace it.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Destroying here looks like a stupid idea now.

SA Michael Giles: Do we have any way to trace it? Bugs? I don't think we have access to such tech in 1968 or whatever year it is.

Chandu: *Negative. Your best bet would be good old reliable observation.*

Chandu: *Although...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: That's up to Carstairs and beyond our scope, but if it goes out, someone might be able to follow it.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Better than nothing.

Chandu: *Nevermind, forget it. Regarding the drug bust assignment: it's legit, you have the authority to interrupt, tag, adulterate, steal, and do whatever the hell you feel like doing (if you feel like doing anything) to this heroin.*

Chandu: *Carstairs concern is, as always, the risk of exposure. Drugs and A-M are all fair game.*

SA Michael Giles: GPS wasn't introduced until 1993 so we're hampered in terms of geographical tracking aside from straight up following them like hayduts.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Well we know it goes to Mersin.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I think this is our ticket to their distribution center so my vote is on tagging it for easy ID'ing and then follow the trail it creates.

SA Michael Giles: That's not a guarantee but it is a likelihood.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Yeah, no need to bust this insignificant amount and raise alarm bells.

SA Michael Giles: It's highly likely to go straight to Diyarbakir and then we can track it if we infil any logistics centers there.

SA Michael Giles: My guess it goes by air freight to Mersin and then sea further on.

Chandu: *Let's see an Accounting roll by Mathieu to try and piece this together.*

SA Michael Giles: Or just overland.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Success** -> 14
(Rolling Accounting Target: 45%)

SA Michael Giles: Overland to Mersin is also likely but A-M might want to expedite any marked crates.

Chandu: *The shipping documents, as far as you can trust them, paint a picture: Archaeological cargo from Bozukepe is picked up by truck by EURY INTL SHIPPING then driven overland to Mersin, where it is then moved overseas by the same company.*

SA Michael Giles: So it's all overland which complicates things if they don't stop.

SA Michael Giles: Just one big tailgate all the way to Mersin.

SA Michael Giles: Do we have any consistent schedule for pickups?

SA Michael Giles: Did we catch that when we viewed the manifest?

Chandu: *They've been delayed, as per Asil's notebook.*

SA Michael Giles: My guess is things pick back up the moment Inan fucks off permanently.

Chandu: *Seems to be connected to Whiteman's suicide-- the last trucks came three days before it happened.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: They probably sent Gilbert as his replacement.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: only for genis

SA Michael Giles: Whiteman couldn't hack it OR finalized his initiation.

SA Michael Giles: This site is definitely very important for A-M if they need to import heroin to make laborers in to historiographic zomboids.

SA Michael Giles: We're all in agreement that it's the user laborers that are the zombies, right?

SA Michael Giles: The ones we saw at the mound.

Chandu: *You could see them muttering and sleepwalking.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: They were dreaming. Didn't you say you had odd dreams?

Chandu: *Guess who was also muttering and not yet sleepwalking.*

SA Michael Giles: We haven't been exposed fully YET.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Oh Shit!

SA Michael Giles: The sleepwalking/historical dreams depends on exposure to depressants.

SA Michael Giles: It was just one night of drinking like a mofo.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I feel like the shit that was rising from the mud is involved somehow.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: At Pope's death site.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I wasn't one of the dreamers though so I have limited information.

SA Michael Giles: If we took a dose of Sodium Thiopental for example we'd most likely be not only sleepwalking but also be capable of full force punches unlike the laborers.

Chandu: *We're calling the session after an observation by Mac... Having gotten curious, you note that Gilbert is not in Whiteman's tent, which he took over. Looking around the camp, you realize that most of the workers are not in their tents. Gilbert and the workers, including every one of them which you saw sleepwalking at the mound, are working Trench #2.*

Chandu: *Vigorously.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We're not dumb enough to take on thirty people with revolvers so might as well let them have this little victory.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll send for someone to fetch me him for our appointment.

SA Michael Giles: It's not that little if what I (the player, not Giles) suspects is behind that collapse.

Chandu: *Well, it's slow work, despite how vigorously they work it. Selma did say it'd take at least a day to reach the point where Whiteman left it at-- no real way to tell how fast they're actually digging so far.*

Chandu: *Before we conclude...*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He walks over, slightly less clumsy than earlier today.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah... I had not forgotten, worry not..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I have brought schnapps... you will like it..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Slightly less clumsy? Looks like sunlight is his weakness.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He enters the tent and starts setting up the table.

Chandu: *Mac, roll HUMINT.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 21 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 50%)

Chandu: *He's so awkward that you can't really get a proper read at him. You can only note that he appears to pick up a rag from behind a crate without searching for it before he does.*

Chandu: *He cleans up the table.*

Chandu: *This is the end of Session II. Tune back in next week for the (possibly) finale.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: The human body is pretty good at telling when something is not human and only pretending to be one.

DE PROFUNDIS SESSION 3

July 17, 2026

August 12, 1968 - August 13, 1968

Chandu: *DE PROFUNDIS - III*

Chandu: *BOZUKTEPE, TR - 12 AUG 2200C*

Chandu: *Gilbert lowers the flap behind him and carries his case to the folding table that belonged to Charles Whiteman. The lanterns are on, but have been turned low. The canvas walls move softly with the evening wind, and through them comes the irregular knock of picks and shovels from Trench #2. Work is still going on.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: Gilbert opens his case. The clothes inside are tightly packed and oddly mismatched. He moves several pieces aside and produces a clear glass bottle with a German label.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Schnapps," he says through the rasp in his throat. "The genuine... article." He finds two cups. The first measure he pours is for Mac. His own is noticeably smaller. "To Charles... Whiteman. Whatever else might be... said of him... he deserved a better end."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Please... do take a seat."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm thrilled."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He slides the cup over your way.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "To Charles."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He nods and shoots the cup's contents down in short order.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "To Charles... Was there anything... specific you'd wish to speak... about?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Do you remember me saying something about your foreman?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Asil, yes... do remind me... my attentions have been taken up by the work at my trench..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ahem--" He coughs raspily. "Trench #2, that is..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "He's a drug dealer. Small time. We don't intend to take him in for a side hustle in Turkey. We're close to cracking the code, though."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll gauge his reaction as I drink...

Chandu: *Hit a HUMINT roll, blind.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He nods solemnly. "Charles had written about him in his letters... He had always appeared... to him a go-getter, as one would say..."

Chandu: *His reaction is, again, unreadable. He's fucking awkward, and the rasp in his voice isn't helping.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We're thinking that he had something to do with it. That's why he's... you know."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Something big is all around you."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "You mean to say... that Mr. Demir... was involved in Charles' suicide...?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He strokes his bushy beard.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Possibly. I'd prioritize the drug business over the foreman."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Small fish, but the wave behind him is huge. So to speak."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Another glass.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He pours both out. The servings are equal this time.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I had meant to ask... about Mr. Pope. Charles had written about him, you see... I was estranged not to meet him... upon my arrival."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Was he... of any use?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "No. He was a trainwreck when we came and was one by the time he decided to leave. I figured he was close to doing something to himself if we disagreed, so we just drove him far away."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Mmm... I see..." He drinks half the cup in a single go.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You drink like a fish."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He cackles.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Ah... I have-- taken a liking to these Schnapps..." He taps on the bottle.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "While we speak of Demir..." He leans in.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I was informed that you and your fellow agents had gone over... the stores... by him. Were there any... irregularities?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You took the words out my mouth, actually."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I guess it's about time we start trading our horses."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I need to know why the work you're doing here is big enough that it shouldn't be swept away by the upcoming operation to curb the trade in the region."

Chandu: *Let's see-- hit a Law roll. Maybe you'll get lucky.*

Chandu: *Hit it again, public.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: SA Cillian F. MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 54 (Rolling Law Target: 15%)

Chandu: *While the BNDD holds a considerably amount of influence over Turkish narcotics law enforcement, you realize that pursuing this matter would have to go through the Gendarmerie. You can't bluff your way into unilateral resolution of that specific topic as things stand.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Hmm... you would have to... get in touch with the Institute, of course, on the legal matter... But I can say this much..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "This site is of a very particular importance to us... and with the completion of the Keban project drawing near... time is running out."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Professor. I'm days ahead in terms of hearing boilerplate."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I am sure that arrangements... could be made... to prevent the closure of the site, yes..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I mean it. Pope told me some things."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He leans back and sips on the schnapps.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Something that Charles... did not document?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "The mound. The sleepwalkers on it. The impossible aquifer beneath #2."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He takes a sip.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's a personal interest for me now."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "... " He sits still for a moment, looking at the cup, as he weighs his thoughts.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Tell me, Mr... MacAllister, yes...?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "What precisely would satisfy your inquiry here...?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm convinced that whatever is happening here is the real thing and let's just say that I'd like in."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "In what capacity... would you be referring to...?"

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He looks at you, intensely.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Take a walk with me Professor. It's a cool night outside."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm going to take him to the foreman's tent first, and then to the cargo next.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Very well..." He sets down his cup and leads the way out.

Chandu: *The tent is up here. It doesn't take much to lift the fold to reveal its contents.*

Chandu: *You're out in front, what precisely are you doing?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm gonna show him that kicking the foreman in the base of the foot doesn't wake him up and that there's a particular needle streak somewhere on his body.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Exhibit A."

Chandu: *Indeed, it is still visible in his arm.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "What's... happened to him...?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I'm sure you have a couple ideas."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Never use your product and all."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I do... yes."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He lets go of him as he flops back on his cot.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Come."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "...Exhibit B. That one."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He nods at the heroin crate.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: Throughout this all, he's still walking awkwardly. Not enough to trip over like he did when he first arrived, but enough to be noticeable.

Chandu: *The crate is still here, its contents intact...*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "My word..." He takes a hand to his mouth.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He raises a hand. "You don't have to make excuses."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I don't want to hear it either. I'm aware that you have nothing to do with this, and any combination of the phrases that say that."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "It's not the only crate, you know."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "You remember the thing I said about the operation?"

Chandu: *Here, right next to him-- hit an Alertness check, blind.*

Chandu: *BLIND...!*

Chandu: *You're once again clocking that he still has his sunglasses on, right here in the middle of the night. And from this distance, looking over his clammy face, you take notice of something stranger.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Please don't make me kill this fucking guy... I'm praying.

Chandu: *His beard-- it looks too perfect. You can tell that it is a fake from this close and under this lighting.*

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He's oblivious. He's still looking over the crate as he considers his response.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "You said you wished to... participate..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Let me... make things clear... I am in no capacity involved with this matter... I am a humble archaeologist, a scholar..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I am here as a favor to my dear friend..." He pauses, looking away for a split second. "Charles..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "May he rest in peace, of course..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "This tragedy has taken a toll... on all of us... I am at a... loss here..."

Chandu: *Since you've surprised him-- make another HUMINT roll. This time it'll count.*

Chandu: *For once, you can tell that you're prying at something. The eyeglasses, the fake beard, the bulky clothing in the middle of summer, the white panama hat...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Why did I just realize that this guy is wearing the same model of sunglasses that Charles does in his 1968 photo with Pope?

Chandu: *He's nervous.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I get it. I'm not going to rip his head off. We need to see this shit through.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Enough beating around the bush."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Can I join or not? I want to be in on this. I know you're practicing dweomer."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: The same fucking hat too... This guy...

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "My friend..." He coughs out a weird chuckle. "I have utterly no... idea... of what you are talking about..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I can help... you bring this matter with the drugs to a... close..." He gingerly taps the crate. "But the excavation... it must continue..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He shrugs.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I said it's in my personal interest, now."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "If I were to go back, or worse, if I were to not go back, with my team members, and my officer, and the crates we took away..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He blows air from his mouth.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He sighs heavily, sliding his hand over his face.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I will... tell you the truth..." He hunches over.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "My name is not Austen Gilbert, my friend... I am... Thomas... Whiteman..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I am Charles' twin brother... I had been in a sanatorium for several decades, you... see..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "In my youth, I'd killed a woman... I did not mean to..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He sniffles.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: IT'S A BAD SNIFFLE.

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I was rightly committed to the asylum... but when I heard of my brother's death... I simply... had to make my escape..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I am pretty much using every ounce of my mental strength to not rip his eyes out but I must not...

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "Charles had warned me that someone here had been plotting against him... stalking him... at night..."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: "I've come... to find my brother's murderer."

Dr. Austen Gilbert: He swivels his head not so discreetly to gauge your reaction.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Question: is that photo with Pope taken in this same dig site?

Chandu: *Indeed. Both pictures were taken here at Bozuktepe.*

Chandu: *1967 and this year, respectively.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I think there is something crucial that we may have missed regarding that."

Thomas Whiteman: "Yes...?"

Thomas Whiteman: "I am not a well man, I know this... much..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Pope showed me this photo of him with Charles. I swear I can't find where it was actually taken. I think he took it with him."

Thomas Whiteman: He looks it over.

Thomas Whiteman: "Yes... that is him, though... I am not familiar with the still..."

Thomas Whiteman: "It must have been in his possession...?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Yeah I just, I can't tell and it must have been somewhere significant to Charles."

Thomas Whiteman: "He was fond of that boy... he would always... speak well of him in his letters."

Thomas Whiteman: "Which is why... I understand that the tragedy was too much... to bear for him..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Fucking asshole... like I didn't see his letters...

Thomas Whiteman: Through the weirdness, he sounds genuinely sympathetic towards Pope.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This is without a doubt Charles resurrected.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Now I need to defuse the situation somehow.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He scratches his head.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "I think I just committed a massive mistake and misunderstanding at once. I'm sorry Thomas."

Thomas Whiteman: He's looking at you expectantly, sporadically reaching for his eyes as if to wipe off tears that simply are not there.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He paces around twice looking stressed and sad.

Thomas Whiteman: "It is fine... I apologize... for such secretiveness..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Just, tell me what I can do to, you know."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Un-offend you."

Thomas Whiteman: "You must not tell... anyone."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Right. Your secrets are safe with me."

Thomas Whiteman: "And... the excavation... it must proceed... we will handle this..." He points at the drugs. "...Together..."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Don't worry about it. We'll just pretend it doesn't exist. We didn't check it in yet."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "My boys can incinerate it. This, though."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "All yours."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He facepalms.

Thomas Whiteman: He nods and straightens himself up.

Thomas Whiteman: "I need... some time alone now... if you would excuse me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "And, I'm sorry about prying in with the foreman."

Thomas Whiteman: "Again... I apologize for the manner in which I've handled this... but rest assured... Charles transmitted his knowledge of archaeology to me through his many letters..."

Thomas Whiteman: He reaches into his coat for a bundle of papers, then hands it to you.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I've never heard such a fucking egregious lie in my life before but I'll eat it. What do they say?

Chandu: *They're letters, of course. The handwriting matches Whiteman's hand-- they are dated and sent appropriately, but there are no return letters from Thomas in this stack.*

Chandu: *They more or less confirm the story he's told you.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Oh please. I've already embarrassed myself enough."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Any idiot can write a bunch of letters that were never sent.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Here, this is my number at BNDD Istanbul office. You can call my desk directly."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We'll stay in touch."

Thomas Whiteman: "I understand..." He sticks it in his coat. "And I must thank you... for your discretion..."

Thomas Whiteman: He awkwardly makes his way out.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Wait.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I reached him out for a handshake!

Thomas Whiteman: He reciprocates. You've got his gloved hand in yours.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Does it feel cold through?

Chandu: *You sense no warmth whatsoever on the glove's surface. It's room temperature-- which is pleasantly chilly.*

Chandu: *Typically, you would. They're not very thick.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Excellent party trick. Would have fooled an 8 year old.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'll see him on his way.

Thomas Whiteman: He nods and goes off.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We need to tag this heroin case like we discussed and get the fuck out of here and observe from a safe distance.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: At least for the night. Maybe we can crash the party when the dig yields something.

Chandu: *The tagging technology boils down to writing down the serial numbers on the crates, which could help track when they're loaded and unloaded from a freight ship. Otherwise, you can draw a distinct line on it with chalk that's lying around.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I need to call Carstairs. Maybe we should head back to the AFB for the night.

Chandu: *Remember, there's more than heroin here. There's also a mummy, one which Carlyle ripped through with his knife.*

Chandu: *And some other... archaeological things, as discussed during the last search.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: That's probably what shocked him when he saw the contents. Not the heroin, which I'm sure he's aware it's there.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: What matters is that we got away with it.

Chandu: *What's next? Giles is snoring in the tent, but you could wake him up if you wanted to head to the AB.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This place is not safe anymore. Let's do it.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Get up."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "We're leaving."

SA Michael Giles: Condition Changes Asleep Asleep

SA Michael Giles: "The fuck?"

Chandu: *Giles-- you were having the most interesting dream... you were a Persian caravan guard... nevermind.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Look I know you're from the hood but do you mind not saying a flavor of 'the fuck' or 'fuck you want' when I tell you to do something?"

Chandu: *You're up and about now.*

SA Michael Giles: "I'm up you fucking mick."

SA Michael Giles: "What's up?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Pack your shit nnnnnn-"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Let's just go."

SA Michael Giles: "Yes massa, right away massa. Fuckin' cracker." Giles grabs his shit and heads out.

Chandu: *Oh, also. Nolan is here. He's pretty much on autopilot and not contesting the strangeness of the situation.*

Chandu: *Looks like he was also deep in the dream.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Huh... Right..."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: He half-assedly packs his things and gets on the move with the two of you.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Where's canary?

Chandu: *At this time? He should already be on the plane to Adana with Fontaine.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Beats being here. Let's zap.

Chandu: *The three of you will spend the night at Diyarbakir AS.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm calling her.

Chandu: *It's late, but you've got two numbers: one for the office, one for the hotel line.*

Chandu: *Ringin...*

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Yyyyeaaaaahh...?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hey. Quick, tell me what you're wearing right now."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Nightgown." She snuffles, waking herself up. "What's happening now?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Feisty. Get a pen and paper."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "...Right." You hear some messing around in the background. "Go."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Alpha. Echo. Foxtrot. Whiskey. Alpha..." "I'm spelling out "NEW GUY DR AUSTEN GILBERT IS CHARLES WHITMAN REVIVED"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "What the fuck? That's some malarkey."

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Did you..." She spells out "KILL HIM?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He takes a deep breath through the receiver.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "NO WILL OBSERVE MOVEMENT DIG FINISHES SOON WILL FOLLOW TRAIL"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "ITS REAL"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Got it." "WILL CALL TOMORROW ON SECURE LINE."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "TO WHERE?"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "WORRY NOT ABOUT IT"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: "Anything else?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "GOODNIGHT SEXY"

Sp. Asst. Ruth C. Martí: She just hangs up.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He cackles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Time to get some rest.

Chandu: *You get checked into the barracks at the air station without issue. Campbell's nowhere to be seen, but the airmen have been informed.*

Chandu: *MERSIN, 13 AUG 68, 0100C*

Chandu: *Fontaine, Carlyle...*

Chandu: *First, Campbell is going to make a roll. He'll try to secure you a civilian ride instead of a USAF Jeep when you get to Incirlik, so you don't have to pull up to Mersin looking like the US Government.*

Capt. Kurt Campbell: Capt. Kurt Campbell rolls **Success** -> 32 (Rolling Bureaucracy Target: 65%)

Chandu: *A success. You get...*

Chandu: *A 1962 Peugeot 404. It reminds you of Louis' back in Saigon.*

Chandu: *LOADING...*

Chandu: *Mersin, on the southern coast of Turkey, is a major cargo hub. The population of the rapidly growing town is around 80,000, and is centered around the busy port.*

Chandu: *The city is still awake. The road comes down through the dark toward a scatter of port lights and low buildings along the coast. The air changes before the city properly begins; warmer, salty, and humid.*

Chandu: *On the final leg of your approach, you note the fact that the harbor is still active despite the hour. Yellow streetlights give the city streets a bit of a charming "je ne sais quoi". It is otherwise dark outside, and activity is minimal.*

Chandu: *The 404 obtained through the airmen at Incirlik does not carry a flashing sign announcing the presence of the USG as a Jeep would. You fit in perfectly. Eury International Shipping is somewhere in the sleeping commercial quarter ahead. You have an address: Istiklal Street.*

Chandu: *As for Carlyle: you've been up for the better part of two days. Your next sleeping session will require no Sleep Disorder roll.*

Chandu: *You may continue, but you'll stay exhausted.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: On the way here I told Mathieu that if we're looking for this guy's coffin, or a paper trail leading there or whatever the hell else, then we should just break in. The fact that he was in touch with someone here stinks and I have a feeling they'll push back as soon as they realize what we're looking for.

SA Bryan Carlyle: So I wanna know first of all what the security is looking like on the dock.

Chandu: *The docks are rather unassuming. Container-lifting equipment rumbles actively, things clearly don't stop at night for merchant ports just like this one.*

Chandu: *As for its security-- they're civilian security, of course. It's a decently large installation, with some checkpoints around critical areas, most of them staffed by a single guy.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Is there a foreman's office or something? Some place they'd keep the books?

Chandu: *Indeed. There's an administration building you can access without an issue.*

Chandu: *One moment...*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: We should get into Claude's office if it's here. He kept the correspondence with Whiteman.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Could've been his handler.

Chandu: *Claude's office is elsewhere, in the commercial sector. It's not a long drive, though, and you do have a few bills of lading from arch-cargo being shipped to England from here with Eury as a broker.*

A Man: Does this guy speak any English....?

A Man: 1

A Man: He does not. Mathieu, you'll have to bring up your fledgling Turkish abilities.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Mathieu casts a sidelong glance at Carlyle. What's the move?

Chandu: *This is clearly some admin office worker, for reference. He's alone here with a bulky radio, listening to some inconsequential broadcast.*

A Man: "Ne bok istiyorsun?"

Chandu: *Fontaine, you're pretty sure he just told you to go fuck yourself.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: What the fuck do we have to do with this guy? We'll just act like we're tourists or something.

Chandu: *Well, you have your BNDD credentials.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: What the fuck did he just say to me? I ball up my fists...

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Okay, calm. We want into the admin office, right?

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I'll show him my creds if needed.

Chandu: *You're in here! It's a stuffy office full of filing cabinets. He's alone at one desk out of many.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Good point, and Claude isn't here. I'm thinking we just up badge and tell him to let us do whatever we want.

Chandu: *Security let you through, no issue, seeing as you're two presentable White men.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I up ID. In broken Turkish, "We need to look." He upnods at the cabinets.

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'll just mean-mug this asshole while Matty lays down the law.

Chandu: *Let's have some fun and hit the contested CHA macro.*

Chandu: *You do it, Matt.*

A Man: "Ehh..." he waves his hand over the badge as he studies the two of you. You don't need to roll your foreign language for this encounter. It'll just be a little broken.

A Man: "What record? America-- no jurisdiction here."

A Man: "I am busy." He turns the radio's volume a bit up.

A Man: ...and picks up a pen and paper at random.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Just by being here there's a good chance Claude will know someone's rifling through his shit so I'm ready to cut the pretence and beat this guy's ass if we have to.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Tell him he'll get a jail sentence for aiding and abetting. If that doesn't do it we tell him to eat shit and look through the books anyway."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt slams his fist on the table. In broken Turkish, "We're here because the boss told us to be, on business. You want me to call him back and get your ass thrown in jail on top of that? Don't waste our time." We can go right to rifling through the papers after this, whatever his reaction is.

A Man, Turkish: A Man, Turkish rolls **Failure** -> 36 (Rolling POW Target: 35%)

A Man, Turkish: He pushes his wheeled chair back as you slam the table.

A Man, Turkish: "ALRIGHT... calm down..." He moves back closer to the desk.

A Man, Turkish: "What you need to see...?" He sighs.

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Just tell him we're tracking drug traffic and we need to see what's gone through this port over the week."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Shipment logs for the last two weeks."

Chandu: *Typically, in America, you'd need quite a bit of paperwork to request such a thing. Luckily, you're in Turkey. And this guy is all alone in his office with no one to back him up.*

A Man, Turkish: So, he stands up and leads you down a corridor to where the archives are. They're pretty well sorted, and he seems prideful of it as he shows you the way around the filing system.

Chandu: *You have the bills of lading. It won't take much work to figure it out. One moment...*

Chandu: *So, you find the records for the shipments on the specified timeline. From this, you can tell that cargo brokered by Eury Intl does consistently go through here and over to England. It's all normal.*

Chandu: *There's one little detail. All of the ships make a stop at Marseille.*

Chandu: *Those brokered by Eury, that is.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Ahhh. Mother's hometown. I take it the Unione's involved?

Chandu: *There's one more bit of information: each crate's serial number is logged in these forms. You can see that a few, maybe one fifth of the crates every other shipment from Bozukepe, simply disappear from the records at Marseille.*

Chandu: *Then the ship sails over to England to unload the rest of the cargo. That's all you know.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Of course if we figure the Corsicans are trafficking drugs through here then this is basically proof that Charles Whiteman was related to A-M, knowing what we know from Saigon. Any chance we can visit Charles's pen-pal while we're here?

Chandu: *You can swing by Eury's office on Istiklal St. and go from there. It's 0200C by the time you're done here.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Let's drive right over. Security might be tighter there, though.

Chandu: *Remains to be seen. Anything else by Carlyle?*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm guessing this all but confirms that Charles's coffin did, in fact, leave the country and we've got no chance of finding it here or something.

Chandu: *Well, the coffin itself was flown from the Adana airport to Istanbul before disappearing, as far as you know. Campbell did his homework and confirmed that before your arrival.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: It never did get to England, did it? They probably dropped his body off at Marseille.

Chandu: *Who knows... we're going to Istiklal.*

Chandu: *ISTIKLAL STREET, 0200C.*

Chandu: *Eury International occupies a narrow commercial frontage on Istiklal Street. The owner's name is painted neatly across the glass and posted up on a sign up top. Behind it, the reception area is dark.*

Chandu: *The businesses around are all closed for the night, of course. There's no activity out here that you can appreciate, other than the odd walker-by down further down the street.*

Chandu: *There's no reason for there to be any guards, of course. This is a legitimate brokerage office in a city where its owner knows how to move around, and how to move things around.*

Chandu: *What's the move from here?*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I have no idea how we'd approach this asshole directly without randomly blowing our cover, but at the same time I'm not sure we're equipped to break into this place. I'm

thinking we get one of the MAC-SOG guys here to help us burgle the office and see if Claude is keeping anything related to Charles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Surely we can backstep and try going into this later.

SA Bryan Carlyle: none of us have lockpicking 😊

Chandu: *That's an option. Before we go on the break, Fontaine, hit an INT roll.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Failure** -> 72
(Rolling INT Target: 65%)

SA Bryan Carlyle: we need cil here he's the b&e demon

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Ehhh... I don't know!

Chandu: *All you can think of right now is how Eury definitely has a contact at Bozukepe. Maybe you can piece out the rest.*

Chandu: *Alright. Have we decided?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I guess we just won't break in now. We could talk to Eury himself when the office opens in the morning, unless the MACV-SOG guys get here earlier for the B&E.

SA Bryan Carlyle: We're heading back and we'll return when everything in Bozukepe is settled. The only thing we'd get here is more evidence to build the case that Charles was A-M which we already know anyway.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Or that!

Chandu: *The trip back will be another 5 hours, up to you. You don't know about the guys leaving the digsite, but you can try calling Diyarbakir AS to check in as a routine action.*

Chandu: *Can easily be done from the hotel, if you intend to book one.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: We shouldn't even speak to Claude himself since he won't tell us anything and it'll just let him know that the feds are onto his drug trafficking.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Could be an intimidation angle there.

SA Bryan Carlyle: So yeah we're getting the fuck out of here for now.

Chandu: *Since you're here, you could try casing out the most active part of town this time of night and throw some of that operational budget around in hopes of catching some whispers about Eury.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: If he moves cargo to Marseille, he might be directly involved.

Chandu: *Is that something you'd want to do?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I would.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Sure!

Chandu: *Let's try Criminology rolls, one for each of you, hit it blind.*

Chandu: *Carlyle: you're quick enough to clock that the CIA has a minor presence here. That is... one guy. You did your homework before coming to Turkey and mapped out the rough sketches of the country's network.*

Chandu: *You pick rumors about the drug trade itself. There's been a delay in the throughline the BNDD knows exists. With the main Unione Corse channel blocked, local small-time dealers are taking advantage of the chaos. Raw product is available for cheap, but the local underboss has sent out enforcers to make sure no one gets too established.*

Chandu: *There is, indeed, Corsican presence here.*

Chandu: *Mathieu: You yourself make a late call and get referred to a BNDD informant in the city. When you bring up Eury, your new contact names him as being possibly involved with the drug trade. He runs an import-export brokerage office, that much you know. About the man himself: he's some socialité, always eager to flash his wealth, but he's been unusually subdued lately.*

Chandu: *Most people of any importance in Mersin know him by name, but he's not confirmed to be part of the Unione Corse proper, as far as BNDD channels go.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Subdued? That makes me a little more confident in the intimidation angle... It can't be a bad idea to talk to him.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He's probably walking on eggshells, maybe because of the coffin.

Chandu: *The informant tells you that he thinks of himself as somewhat of a gourmet and often hangs around a few handpicked restaurants on the off-hours.*

Chandu: *Let's flip a coin: maybe this informant knows where he might be this late.*

Chandu: 2

Chandu: *He does. You get an address for one he particularly likes, and these usually close at 3 or so in the morning for the wealthy patrons.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: We can get him on his way out, Carlyle.

SA Bryan Carlyle: I can't imagine anything other than black bagging him will get the info we want and the cat will be out of the bag as soon as we approach him about this stuff. But if Matthieu wants to talk to the guy I guess I have no choice but to help him.

Chandu: *Ten minutes later...*

Chandu: *So, Baylan. This is a nice place in the touristy part of Mersin. The streets are mostly empty, but there's still a few patrons inside.*

Chandu: *You don't have a face for Eury, but there's a waiter smoking outside, about ready for his boss to call it a night and kick the people inside out.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Let's approach him.

A Man: He nods at the two of you, nursing his cigarette.

A Man: Looks tired!

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt gives a polite tip of his hat. "Good morning, sir. We work with one of the guests in the restaurant, and there's some late-night urgent business we've been asked to inform him of. Would you point us to him?" He looks past the windows as he mentions the name. "...Mr. Eury."

A Man: Of course, a waiter working at a prestigious restaurant does speak English.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: I spoke to him in English, in the hopes of that.

A Man: "Ah, that idi-- I'm sorry, uh... Mr. Eury?"

A Man: He shrugs. "I can walk you inside, yes."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Claude Eury, yes." He falls in behind the waiter without further comment.

Chandu: *It's a nice place inside. There's three or four tables with couples or groups of three still drinking and chatting it up late. The kitchen's closed, but the bar's still up.*

Chandu: *Alone, sitting at a 4-seated table...*

Claude Eury: He looks up from his glass of wine as you approach.

A Man: "Mr. Eury, uh..."

A Man: "Yes." He turns around and leaves.

Claude Eury: "Service these days..." He rubs his face.

Claude Eury: "I apologize. Who are you, gentlemen?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt takes a seat beside Eury's, looking back to the waiter. "Aw, I hoped for a coffee-" He turns his attention to Claude. "We're very, very concerned people, Mr. Eury. And potential partners of yours."

SA Bryan Carlyle: All I can think of at this point is we act like bent cops so I'll just go along with Matty boy here.

Claude Eury: "Hmmm..." He sips from his wineglass as he studies the two of you.

Claude Eury: He leans back on the chair. "Please. Go on."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: On the other hand, Matt leans in, closer. He lowers his shoulders, trying to appear more relaxed than he really is. "You may not know us as well, we're something like small fish around these parts, but we share the same business. Do you understand?" He furrows his brows. "And there's been... some word on the street about yours. Leaky pipes."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Get to the fucking point man."

Claude Eury: "Ahhh... import-export..."

Claude Eury: "Yes, oblige your partner. You've got my attention."

Claude Eury: He smirks.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "My colleague doesn't like talking in circles, so alright, I'll get to the point." He pauses. "The Americans know of the product you're pushing, and we're here to help you sweep it under the rug."

Claude Eury: He frowns, places the glass on the table and leans in with his elbows on it.

Claude Eury: "Law enforcement?"

Claude Eury: "Are you certain?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: He nods, grim. "Federal. They're onto you, Mr. Eury."

Claude Eury: "...And may I have the pleasure of knowing who you represent, exactly...?"

Claude Eury: "It is not every night two strangers break such news to me."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "We know about the side hustle a certain dead archeologist working out of Bozukepe was running. We're the feds my friend here is talking about and we're more interested in picking up said archeologist's trail of goods than we are in prosecuting anyone. That's the long and short of it."

Claude Eury: "WHAT."

Claude Eury: Claude Eury rolls **Failure** -> 84 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

SA Bryan Carlyle: "We could extort you but we're not even doing that."

Claude Eury: "No... you have no jurisdiction here.... and how do I know you aren't impersonators..."

Claude Eury: He looks around, nervously, lowering his tone.

Claude Eury: "...Who sent you?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt has to switch up. "We're even going to go as far as to wipe your name off the BNDD's bucket list. It's as sweet a deal as it can get, but we want to know what happened to the coffin."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Really, we'll just walk out right now if you know nothing, but if you do know something- we can end the investigation our colleagues started."

Claude Eury: "No, but... you have nothing. You have no proof."

Claude Eury: "Unless you are recording... and that is illegal."

Claude Eury: "Hypothetically, if any of this were to be true-- what is it you want?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Whiteman's coffin. Where'd it go?"

Chandu: *Hit a Persuade at +20, public.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois rolls **Success** -> 64
(Rolling Persuade Target: 70% (50%+20%))

Claude Eury: "The coffin..." He scoffs. "Is that what you want to know about?"

Claude Eury: He lets his shoulder go loose then crosses his arms.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Nothing else, and the investigation targeting you will be over."

Claude Eury: "I will indulge you for a moment. And all of this is hypothetical, of course."

Claude Eury: He reaches into his jacket for a case and throws it open. There are three cigars inside-- he grabs one and slides the case across the table.

Claude Eury: "I have friends in Marseille. These friends have friends, I do not know them. My friends knew that the coffin was moving, and asked me to put them in contact with someone from Adana."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt nods along.

Claude Eury: "Uh... if it is Whiteman you want to know more about, hmm..."

Claude Eury: "How should I put this...?"

Claude Eury: "The man was a degenerate addict. The dig is one of my clients-- well, through the British Institute. I was told to stay in contact with him regarding shipping logistics."

Claude Eury: "I've no idea how the coffin went astray, not those particularities. I arranged for transport from Adana to Istanbul, and then Munich."

Claude Eury: "It was out of my hands by then." He puffs on the cigar.

Claude Eury: "Of course, I am not involved in this... drug trafficking operation. Whiteman was the mastermind in securing the drugs, and I am certain those I call friends..."

Claude Eury: He draws a thumb across his neck.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Of course. Your friends wanted to know where the coffin was headed. That's how I understand it."

Claude Eury: "That's right."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "That's it? None of the goods are left from this whole deal?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "What a fucking waste of time."

Claude Eury: "The coffin? It may as well be in Bombay, friend."

Claude Eury: "Although there is something..."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Matt casts a glance to Carlyle, but returns to Eury when he mentions another detail.

Claude Eury: He looks like he's hesitating to say it. "Eh..."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "In this hypothetical, I suppose you'd rather tell us as much you can to make your deal as sweet as possible, right?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm staring him dead in the face like I wanna rip his balls off.

Claude Eury: "Answer me this." He drags his chair back and crosses a leg over the other.

Claude Eury: "Will I ever hear from you again?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "Of course not, as long as we have the information we're asking for."

Claude Eury: "I would categorically be appalled if any this-- whatever it results in, were to find its way back to me. If not through you, through my 'friends'."

Claude Eury: "Knowing what they did to Whiteman, I do not want to rustle any feathers."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "You have our assurance that it won't."

Claude Eury: "Come with me to my office. Stay four cars' width behind me."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "I'm doing a very nice thing here by laying this all out on the table for you and I wouldn't have been so frank if we were fucking around."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Whatever you have to say you can say right here."

Claude Eury: "No, you don't understand. It's in my office."

Claude Eury: "Whiteman left something with me. Two pages."

Claude Eury: "I think you'd rather see it with your own eyes. Trust goes both ways, no?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "We'll come with. And once we have the pages? You won't hear from us again."

SA Bryan Carlyle: I look at Mathieu.

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: This guy seems to be genuinely extending his trust to us. He, at least, should also understand the consequences of betraying our confidence. Can't run from a bullet.

Claude Eury: "Very well. Once we arrive, be sure to park discreetly..." He leaves a bundle of liras on the table and chugs the last of his wine as he stands up.

Chandu: *TWENTY MINUTES LATER, AFTER A CAREFUL DRIVE...*

Claude Eury: "Right." He punches a hidden compartment on the desk open.

Chandu: *Out jumps a concealed drawer on the side.*

Chandu: *He hands you the two pages.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "We'll be keeping them."

Claude Eury: "So? What do you think?"

Claude Eury: "He writes like a doctor, does he?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "...Sure does."

SA Bryan Carlyle: I want to get the fuck out of dodge ASAP so I'm sparing the small talk.

Claude Eury: "Very well. Before you go, may I see your badges again?"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Why the hell'd he kill himself?" I say ignoring him entirely.

Claude Eury: "Oh... suicide...?"

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: What day did Whiteman die again?

Claude Eury: "What a rotten way to die."

Chandu: *We haven't gone over the dates, but from the information you've gathered, you know that he was found hung in trench #2 on a Monday morning.*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: Two days after the last entry, I'm guessing.

Chandu: *Sounds right.*

Chandu: *Anything else to say to Claude?*

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: No, and he won't need our badges either. "We'll excuse ourselves now. You are a good man, Mr. Eury."

SA Bryan Carlyle: "You ought to cut your losses before someone who isn't in it for the money shows up."

Claude Eury: "I will take that under advisement." He interlaces his fingers.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Let's get the fuck out of here before we get killed.

Claude Eury: "A pleasure doing business with American federal enforcement-- but again, this must not happen again."

SSA Mathieu de la Fontaine-Bois: "You have our assurance." Let's GO! Let's leave.

Claude Eury: "Close the door on your way out!" He waves you off as he shuts the hidden compartment.

Chandu: *SESSION III - END*

DE PROFUNDIS SESSION 4

July 31, 2026

August 13, 1968

Chandu: *DE PROFUNDIS - IV*

Chandu: *DIYARBAKIR, TR - 13 AUG 2300C*

Chandu: *This is the address. Borderline abandoned, looks right.*

Chandu: *The gate is shut, for reference.*

Dimitrios Vardas: "So?" He looks at Mavridis, holding his cigarette up on his lips.

Nikolaos Mavridis: "This is the place."

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Let us meet our new friends."

Chandu: *They both reach for their waistlines and grip their handguns. Just in case.*

Chandu: *As for the guns— they're in the car. They're all here.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis remains relaxed. He lights an unfiltered cigarette with a match and puts his hands in his pockets, calmly walking over to the garage.

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Easy."

Chandu: *is there an entrance of some kind, a door*

Georgios Laskaris: "You never know, chief." He mutters.

Chandu: *You can just knock on it.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis saunters over and knocks on the cheap metal, three distinct and loud knocks.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Hummingbird."

Nikolaos Mavridis: "A bat, a plane or maybe...a Sparrow."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Get in."

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis motions his mean over and steps inside.

Chandu: *Tokens may move. Looks like everyone's here.*

Chandu: *The two others relax and follow you inside.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis stands in the middle of the room and surveys the crowd around him.

Dimitrios Vardas: This guy's just looking everyone over as well.

Georgios Laskaris: This one, he's looking at the weapon truck.

Chandu: *The rest of this exchange is in English, of course. Feel free to talk and act.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Well...how are you liking Turkey?"

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Never do like being here too long. Gives me a bad taste in my mouth."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He takes the spliff out his mouth and blows smoke upwards. He's perched over a folding table with a huge drawing of the camp on it. "I can imagine why."

SA Michael Giles: Giles is ignoring these schmucks and cleaning his RPK.

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis takes a long drag out of his cigarette and starts swinging on his heels.

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Guess you guys are serious."

Nikolaos Mavridis: "We brought our own party supplies. In the car."

Dimitrios Vardas: "I just happy to be here." He thumbs up at Mac and taps Laskaris' shoulder. Both of them head over to the back and start getting their gear together.

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Alright, what is the score as you Americans like to say?"

Nikolaos Mavridis: "I am guessing you are in charge."

Nikolaos Mavridis: Nikolaos Mavridis he points at Giles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He's taking it easy.

SA Michael Giles: Giles looks at the Greek like he's a retard.

Georgios Laskaris: He chuckles. "Americans don't like black, chief." (IN GREEK).

SA Michael Giles: Then goes back to cleaning his gun.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Good. We're all set for the game too.""We're going to hit up an archeological dig site. Eliminate the VIP, trash up the place, collapse it and get the fuck out."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He begins tying the shemagh around his head.

Unknown (Mavridis): "Where do you need us?"

Unknown (Mac): "Over here for the moment, so you can read the plan."

Unknown (Mac): "You three have this side of the grid. You're going to start shooting only after us, get rid of whatever vehicle that may be parked..."

Unknown (Mac): He goes over the usual planning.

Unknown (Mavridis): Leans over the plan and listens along, fiddling with his shemagh. He motions to the other two Greeks.

Unknown (Mac): "Any last minute questions?"

Unknown (Mavridis): "If we do not hear any fire, the signal is the flashlight?"

Unknown (Mac): "Right on."

Unknown (Laskaris): "Civilians?"

Unknown (Mac): He gets up from the table and walks towards him.

Unknown (Mac): "No fucking killing, ese."

Unknown (Mac): "Don't shoot anyone who escapes or hides."

Unknown (Mac): "Only resistance."

Unknown (Mavridis): Clicks his tongue, before turning back and talking in Greek about the finer points of the plan.

Unknown (Laskaris): "No problem." He waves a hand at Mac and grips his LMG.

Unknown (Mac): "I mean it. This is not going to be a slaughter."

Unknown (Mac): "Only kill people who you deem a threat."

Unknown (Mavridis): "Anything you say boss."

Unknown (Mavridis): "We follow orders."

Unknown (Mac): "Good. Now that we got it out the way."

Unknown (Mac): "That's more or less everything."

Chandu: *Then we're about ready to get this show on the road. Unless there's any clarifications left to be made, the party will begin moving towards Bozukepe.*

Unknown (Mac): "Try not to engage Charles alone. He's a sorcerer. We've dealt with two of them before."

Unknown (Mavridis): "He is a what now?"

Chandu: *Vardas and Laskaris just look at each other.*

Unknown (Mac): "He's most likely going to be holding onto an object that makes him immune to physical harm. You need to wrestle it out his hand and destroy his brain."

Unknown (Mac): "I've done it twice."

Unknown (Mac): "You can do it too."

Unknown (Mavridis): Behind the shamagh his eyes narrow. He simply looks back at his two team members and shrugs.

Unknown (Nolan): "He's not fucking with you. Don't forget about it."

Unknown (Vardas): "...Not even Americans are safe from drug abuse. Malaka." (IN GREEK).

Unknown (Laskaris): He shrugs.

Chandu: *I just stare at the guys to emphasize that Cillian isn't joking.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "Yeah...wizards...sure."

Unknown (Mavridis): "We will be fine."

Unknown (Mac): "If you can help it, decapitate him. It will make sure he won't rise again." He slides his combat knife hidden in his wrist to put it back in its sheathe. It was waiting there in case someone else came.

Unknown (Giles): Giles says "These guys are going to shit their pants," in French to Fontaine.

Unknown (Nolan): Nolan gives a sour look before going back to fiddling with his scope.

Unknown (Fontaine): Matt shakes his head. "Can't fault them for it."

Chandu: *So, arrival will be at 1 AM. That gives you plenty of time to perform reconnaissance and adopt your positions before the engagement time at 3:30.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Of course.

Chandu: *14 AUG 86 - 0100C*

Chandu: *Initial reconnaissance of Bozuktepe...*

Chandu: *You're going to be observing from the Eastern hill before splitting up.*

Chandu: *Everyone hit a blind SEARCH check.*

Chandu: *blind to Gamemaster or?*

Chandu: *Yes, the eye icon.*

Chandu: *Two hours' worth of initial observations. Here's the scoop: the site is active.*

Chandu: *Firstly, the most obvious. The civilian truck the MARTEL crew is familiar with is gone. Instead, two cargo trucks and a Jeep are parked at the vehicle area, lights on.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Holy shit. I'm going to see if that's a military license plate on that Jeep with the SVD's scope.

Chandu: *Men are moving back and forth between the stores and the vehicles. Most of them workers, obviously— but there seems to be three individuals dressed in a business casual get-up watching over the loading process.*

Chandu: *The trucks do not have military plates, and these men do not look like soldiers.*

SA Michael Giles: Probably the logistics company slash Unione Corse guys.

Chandu: *Out front, right by the bridge over the stream: a single sentry is posted. He's armed with an SMG, and seems to be bored out of his mind.*

Chandu: *There's assorted worker activity in these areas...*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm not at all displeased. We're waiting for the trucks to depart.

Chandu: *And they're most obviously watched over by two men. These don't appear French. They look like Arabs.*

Chandu: *These two, they're wielding FN FALs.*

Chandu: *You see a silhouette by the short walk to the staff tents, though it's difficult to pinpoint their gear.*

Chandu: *Overall, it looks like activity is spread out around the camp. Here's the perimeter.*

Chandu: *You can discuss the situation before splitting up and getting in position, then waiting or etc.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Obviously this is the heroin being moved. I have no intention of interfering.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: If we stayed the night they would have most definitely cut our throats.

Nikolaos Mavridis: Does Cillian have anything to add in terms of changing plans or

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: No changes.

Chandu: *You can tell that they're moving crates other than the ones you remember marked "A-M". They were only 3 crates. Looks like they're moving the whole of the storeroom into the trucks.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We need to make a note of the license plates however.

Chandu: *And, from what you can see here— this is a full house. You'd expect there to be way fewer workers if they still were working trench #2.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Can I see the license plates?

Chandu: *You can note their plates down without issue.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: If they do not move, do we go for their engine blocks/armed men?

Chandu: *They're standard Turkish plates... Carlyle & Fontaine get an INT roll.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 26 (Rolling INT Target: 65%)

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Success** -> 41 (Rolling INT Target: 70%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'm setting up overwatch from my position towards the bridge and into the camp.

Chandu: *You can both tell that these vehicles came from Mersin from the regional distinction on their plates.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Ok, let's wait until the op time. This is a piece of cake.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Scope cover still on.

Chandu: *TWO HOURS LATER - 0320C...*

Chandu: *We're assuming everyone's in position by now. The forward element can be up ahead already, unless they're staying in the overwatch position.*

Chandu: *What's the call on that?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Are they gone?

Chandu: *Nope. They're nearly done loading shit up from the storeroom, now they're lugging stuff from the staff tents.*

Chandu: *None of them are near the road to trench #2.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: This is dire. Charles may be going with them. Entry is go.

Chandu: *Alright. The initial phase of the engagement is going to be abstracted for the overwatch teams at the east hill and on the mound itself— you won't be on the scene, but you'll each get turns to act as the ones in the camp advance.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: Positioning my guys to stick together, one is MG one is assistant. Assistant can fire when his hands are free. Keeping watch on the two armed men in the middle of the camp plus road to trench 2. MG focus is on engine blocks, tires then armed men.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: We'll sneak past and stay hidden, I just want to see if Charles is in there packing up to head out with them.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: If he is then we quite literally have no option but to kill everyone right here, and let the truck "escape" without Charles.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: So greeks target men first.

Nikolaos Mavridis: Wilco.

Chandu: *toggle weapon states and we're good*

Unknown (Mac): I want Giles with his knife out here.

Unknown (Mac): Let's just sneak directly into the back of the tents.

Chandu: *Alright, you can act. We're using turns.*

Chandu: *Mac can move.*

Chandu: *YOU CAN MOVE 20 METERS IN "SNEAK" MODE DURING THIS STAGE*

Unknown (Giles): I follow.

Unknown (Carlyle): I'll move over to those pebbles on the way to the rear of the camp.

Unknown (Mac): We'll go two by two. Giles, we're crossing first.

Unknown (Mac): The other two takes cover behind the cacti.

Unknown (Carlyle): Is it looking like we'll be able to ford it with our guns out? Or is it gonna be a swimming check.

Chandu: *It's ankle-deep, you'll be good.*

Unknown (Mac): Forward?

Unknown (Mac): That was just 15

Unknown (Mac): They hold.

Unknown (Fontaine): OK.

Unknown (Carlyle): I'm aiming with my turn in that case.

Unknown (Fontaine): Yeah same.

Chandu: *Apply "aiming" and we proceed!*

Unknown (Mac): I'm gonna go ahead and scale the wall, Giles stays here and assists their pass.

Unknown (Giles): I'm aiming.

Unknown (Giles): While the other two guys cross.

Unknown (Fontaine): Moving up...

Chandu: *Continue!*

Unknown (Mac): Get me thru.

Chandu: *You can hop over the palisade within your turn. Ongoing...*

Chandu: *You note the tent right ahead, it's unoccupied. You can adjust to end up... here.*

Unknown (Giles): I'm moving now.

Unknown (Mac): I'm approaching from the back.

Chandu: *5 meters left, Giles.*

Chandu: *Of movement that is.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Are we able to climb the walls on our turn?

Chandu: *Yup. You're just spending the rest of your move.*

Unknown (Mac): Ok. Sounds from this one?

Chandu: *It's pretty quiet here without machinery around. You can hear papers rifling in the main tent.*

Chandu: *None from Pope's.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm gonna check the tent the other way just to be safe.

Unknown (Mac): I'm signalling Giles to switch to his main.

Unknown (Fontaine): Nah I'll stay here for now.

Unknown (Carlyle): I'll hang back too.

Unknown (Mac): I'm waving Fontaine to go check the outhouse on that side.

Chandu: *Alright. Starting this round, walking (stealth move) is 5 meters. Further will require a **SEALTH** check.*

Unknown (Fontaine): On THIS side... right.

Unknown (Carlyle): I'm gonna overwatch from here while Fontaine opens that door.

Chandu: *Which direction are you overwatching?*

Unknown (Carlyle): The right.

Chandu: *Apply a rectangle marker.*

Chandu: *You can have a cone, actually.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Would I need to move a bit?

Unknown (Carlyle): I can't really tell this map dark asf

Unknown (Carlyle): Got it.

Chandu: *For example....*

Unknown (Carlyle): Here?

Chandu: *Yep. Use the line marker, not the rectangle.*

Chandu: *Works.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm gonna signal Giles to listen carefully. I'll clear this outhouse.

Unknown (Mac): ...Wherever that dude is aiming right now...

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 76 (Rolling Stealth Target: 70%)

Unknown (Mac): No bonuses to that?

Chandu: *You pass it. The papers keep rifling.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm opening the door with my PB in my hand.

Unknown (Mac): Next.

Unknown (Giles): I'm listening. Do I hear anything from the tent?

Chandu: *Sure. You hear...*

Chandu: 2

Chandu: *A raspy cough amid the papers being rearranged.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm going to make a cutting throat motion to Giles.

Unknown (Giles): Giles motions to the tent.

Unknown (Giles): Sure, I'll switch to my knife. Can I peer into the tent somehow?

Chandu: *You CAN crawl under the canvas to get in the tent— you can even take a peek before you enter.*

Unknown (Mac): Hold.

Unknown (Mac): Don't enter.

Chandu: *For convenience's sake, I'm moving your token over— but you're getting a look in.*

Charles Whiteman: He's busy getting his shit together on the table.

Asil Demir: As for him, he's putting documents in a bag.

Asil Demir: "About ready, professor."

Charles Whiteman: "MMmmmmyes... just..."

Charles Whiteman: 1

Chandu: *Giles, roll Alertness.*

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Success** -> 43 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

Chandu: *You catch the glint of a silvery reflection being stuffed in his go-bag.*

Chandu: *Anything else, or are you holding?*

Unknown (Giles): I'm waiting for Cilian.

Unknown (Giles): It takes two to behead.

Unknown (Mac): Switch to main.

Unknown (Mac): Let's get this started.

Chandu: *Fontaine, let's expedite this. You can walk freely over to the outhouse since nobody's here.*

Chandu: *Knock knock, nobody's here.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Oh. OK.

Unknown (Mac): He is holding and aiming at the main tent. I just signalled him.

Unknown (Mac): We're gonna light it up soon.

Unknown (Carlyle): i crashed

Chandu: *Aiming loosely at the tent, then?*

Chandu: *Canvas can be shot through, of course.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Okay so Fontaine checked the outhouse right

Unknown (Fontaine): It's clear.

Unknown (Carlyle): In that case yeah I'll hold the tent from here so I can see if any of the guards are coming as well.

Chandu: *For this turn, you get to keep your aiming action. Just specify the direction you're aiming at with a "LINE" marker at Region Controls.*

Chandu: *It starts from your character's position.*

Unknown (Mac): Good, let's get this party started. I'm going to roll a WP grenade at this guys foot at the entrance of the tent and we are going to mag dump the main tent all 3 at once.

Chandu: *Hit an Athletics check at +20%, specify where you're aiming the WP.*

Unknown (Mac): North of reckless beau voyou where it should cover the entrance.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Unknown (Mac): "Free Kurdistan or something."

Chandu: Chandu rolls 2d8 -> 8 (Draws a result from the Slow Projectile Deviation d8 table)

Chandu: *That's physically impossible, so it's landing here.*

Chandu: *Alright, hit the lethality roll for the grenade as it's flung over that way.*

Unknown (Nolan): I have my sights trained on the Brutal Mercenary and will take the shot when I hear shit go down.

Chandu: *Can you see it now?*

Chandu: *It's landing right where you specified, hit the lethality.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 34 (7 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For M34 WP GRENADE Target: 10)

Chandu: *These two are within the killzone, so they are 100% affected.*

Chandu: *One moment..*

Unknown (Mac): Mac raises his AKM...

Chandu: *This is enough for now. As the grenade pops and the smoke swishes around, the two outside scream and will be running SOUTH. The two in the tent will be unaffected by the splash.*

Unknown (Mac): They are running into a fucking cloud of WP?

Unknown (Mac): Come on...

Unknown (Giles): Amateur hour.

Chandu: *What? They're running OUT of it.*

Unknown (Nolan): When can I take my shot?

Asil Demir: Condition Changes Partial Cover

Chandu: *When an individual you have overwatch over's turn rolls in, the support teams will get their shots.*

Unknown (Giles): Giles unloads into the tent, long ass burst.

Unknown (Giles): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 22 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Failure** -> 69 (15 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For RPK (4/4) / +BPD Target: 10)

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls 1d10 -> 7 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Chandu: *THIRTY damage altogether.*

Charles Whiteman: Charles Whiteman rolls 1d10 -> 6 (Draws a result from the Catastrophic Wounds Table table)

Charles Whiteman: "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA-" He doesn't get to wrap his scream up before being completely perforated.

Charles Whiteman: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *Demir is within the firing zone. He's getting hit with the leftovers: 20 damage.*

Asil Demir: Asil Demir rolls 1d10 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Catastrophic Wounds Table table)

Asil Demir: He makes no sounds as he's killed from a treacherous attack in the back.

Asil Demir: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *This man prepares to run to cover— Nolan has a visual.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, head. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Success** -> 5 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Unknown (Nolan): 9

Brutal Mercenary: Brutal Mercenary rolls 1d6 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Head Serious Wounds (5, 6, 7 Dmg) table)

4 Brutal Mercenary: 4 Brutal Mercenary rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 77 (Rolling CON Target: 60%)

Chandu: *He goes down immediately, shot in the head.*

4 Brutal Mercenary: Condition Changes Unconscious

Bleeding Tracker: Reckless Beau Voyou: On Fire, (HP 5 → HP 1), △ Unconscious!

Chandu: *He doesn't get to leave the white cloud before he collapses— he's dead.*

1 Abrasive Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *This man is prepared to make a move. However, the Greek LMG has got overwatch.*

Unknown (Nolan): Nolan calmly shifts his sights towards the Large Mercenary.

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: Short-range attachment(s) w/ bipod. Fire rate & range: Medium range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Shooter: **Failure** - Target: **Failure** Miss. Huge targets: Miss. Braced: Miss.

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Success** -> 27 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Mac): Yeah he missed but its a suppression

5 Large Mercenary: 5 Large Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 19 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mac): It's fine someone needs to get out of this alive, in the truck

Unknown (Mac): Truck(s)

Chandu: *Though this is a missed long burst and a success, he won't get to do much besides run around the crate for cover.*

5 Large Mercenary: Condition Changes Suppressed

Unknown (Fontaine): I'll move here...

Chandu: *Ten meters without running roll. Parsed.*

Unknown (Carlyle): I can't really tell who's where on the battlemat but I just wanna move somewhere I can see the last 2 mercs.

Unknown (Carlyle): Can I toggle the lighting shit on my end

Chandu: *They're to the south. There's a cloud of white phosphorous between you and the exit, though.*

Chandu: *Go ahead and do whatever.*

Chandu: *The WP will dissipate in...*

Chandu: 3

Unknown (Carlyle): Is this palisade just half-cover or

Chandu: *3 rounds.*

Chandu: *It's taller than you are, it's full cover and concealment.*

Unknown (Mac): Before this round ends can Kid act on that sentry

Unknown (Carlyle): Okay I'll move up there.

Unknown (Carlyle): Condition Changes Aiming

Chandu: *Mavridis has got a visual on the outside sentry at LONG RANGE. Use the combat helper macro.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Aim & bodypart: Aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Long range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 93 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *That's still going to be a suppression roll on his part on this instance.*

3 Calm Beau Voyou: 3 Calm Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 8 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mavridis): single shot was a dumb idea

Unknown (Mac): I want to hit an alertness to guess if someone's inside this tent.

Chandu: *The small one?*

Chandu: *Go ahead.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 97 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

Chandu: *No result.*

Unknown (Mac): Ah well here I go blasting. Before I do so I'm gonna signal Giles to tear into that tent and shoot the fuck up Charles in the face.

Unknown (Mac): Mac shoulders his AKM and rips.

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls 1d10 -> 10 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 90 (19 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (7/7) / +PSO-1 Target: 10)

Unknown (Mac): Someone's melon just blew up.

Chandu: *Good effect. The tent is full of holes. And through them you see...*

Chandu: *No one was in here!*

Chandu: *We proceed.*

Unknown (Giles): It has been done.

Chandu: *Vardas has got a visual on many of the workers that're running around. Some of them are armed, so he's not thinking twice about it.*

Unknown (Vardas): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, torso. Attachments: Short-range attachment(s) w/ bipod. Fire rate & range: Medium range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Vardas): Shooter: **Failure** - Target: **Failure** Miss. Huge targets: Lethality.Braced: Miss.

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Vardas): 7

Mehmet Sari: Mehmet Sari rolls 1d6 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Torso Serious Wounds (5, 6, 7 Dmg) table)

02 Mehmet Sari: 02 Mehmet Sari rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 1 (Rolling CON Target: 40%)

Chandu: *This guy's something else— but he just got perforated all the same. He's slumping on the floor and bleeding.*

02 Mehmet Sari: Condition Changes Prone Heavy Bleeding

Chandu: *Mavridis, you have a visual on ONE armed worker yourself. It's this one.*

Chandu: *He's borderline feral— he's trying to run over to the large tent.*

Unknown (Mavridis): What is the range

Chandu: *Short range.*

Chandu: *You have a height advantage and he's just down the slope, hit it.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Success** -> 38 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Unknown (Mavridis): still makes it

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 72 (9 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) / +SUP +PSO-1 Target: 10)

Doruk Bele: Doruk Bele rolls 1d6 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Head Serious Wounds (5, 6, 7 Dmg) table)

01 Doruk Bele: 01 Doruk Bele rolls **Failure** -> 67 (Rolling CON Target: 40%)

01 Doruk Bele: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *So, this guy was just shot at from behind, and saw a flash earlier from the hill in front.*

3 Calm Beau Voyou: 3 Calm Beau Voyou rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

Chandu: *Holy shit. He trips, not making it over the bridge.*

3 Calm Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Prone

Unknown (Giles): I crawl into the tent and am gonna canoe the fuck out of Charles.

Unknown (Giles): How's old boy looking?

Chandu: *He's looking dead, riddled with bullets. Roll Alertness.*

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Success** -> 2 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

Chandu: *The ground underfoot is getting darker. Muddy.*

Chandu: *Otherwise, nothing comes to mind. What's next?*

Unknown (Mac): "BURN HIM!"

Unknown (Giles): Blast his head into gore then check what he was packing.

Unknown (Mac): "NOW!"

Unknown (Giles): Oh-

Unknown (Giles): I'll break a lamp over him.

Unknown (Giles): Well, damn. What was the silvery item he was packing?

Chandu: *Good of you to remember. You can check in his bag for this.*

Chandu: *Inside, you see a few things. A SIG P210, a bottle of schnapps, filled with schnapps, and a bottle of schnapps, filled with...*

Chandu: *Dark, gooey fluid. It's viscous.*

Unknown (Giles): I'm grabbing that shit. How flammable is this tent looking? I don't want to drop a WP grenade on my feet then stumble on something and burn to death so breaking an oil lamp seems like the safer option.

Unknown (Giles): Unless they're running on generator power or something.

Chandu: *The canvas itself will burn if set alight.*

Chandu: *What now?*

Unknown (Giles): I'll just crawl out and then roll a WP under the canvas.

Chandu: *No Athletics roll necessary.*

Unknown (Giles): Yep.

Unknown (Giles): "Burn, sucka!"

Chandu: *The smoke cloud engulfs Whiteman's and Demir's corpses. Nothing else happens as the particles sizzle intensely.*

Chandu: *Before we do this man's turn, Nolan— we skipped you over before.*

Chandu: *You get to act now. There's a man prone by the bridge.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, head. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Success** -> 36 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Unknown (Nolan): 7

Calm Beau Voyou: Calm Beau Voyou rolls 1d6 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Head Serious Wounds (5, 6, 7 Dmg) table)

3 Calm Beau Voyou: 3 Calm Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 87 (Rolling CON Target: 60%)

3 Calm Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Unconscious

Chandu: *Alright, that's it for you. Now it's this man's turn, who's going to pinpoint your muzzle flash.*

4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: 4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 65 (Rolling Alertness Target: 55%)

Chandu: *He fails. He's sticking to cover— he was in partial.*

4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Partial Cover

Chandu: *This dude— it's not even a question. He's dead by now.*

2 Reckless Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *Laskaris: no visual on targets other than civilians— but he remembers where that fat guy dove.*

Unknown (Mac): Does he remember the thing about letting one escape?

Chandu: *Maybe he does...!*

Chandu: 1

Chandu: *He does not...!*

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: Short-range attachment(s) w/ bipod. Fire rate & range: Medium range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Shooter: **Success** - Target: **Failure** Lethality. Huge targets: Lethality. Braced: Lethality.

Chandu: *Mavridis, you can order him to hold fire if you wish.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "CHANGE FIRE; ABOVE THE TENTS. SCATTER THEM!"

Chandu: *Redirected. Rounds go above the tents.*

Chandu: *By now, most civilians are running off in random directions.*

5 Large Mercenary: Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *The WP by the staff tent is dissipating...*

5 Large Mercenary: 5 Large Mercenary rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 11 (Rolling Athletics Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Both Nolan and the Greeks see him running across the field towards the vehicles.*

Chandu: *Fontaine, it's finally your turn.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Okay let me jump over this shit and enter partial cover

Unknown (Carlyle): Condition Changes Partial Cover

Chandu: *This man is bleeding out and... dying.*

02 Mehmet Sari: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *We're rolling the three other dudes' initiatives.*

Unknown (Nolan): Who do I have eyes on?

Chandu: *On no one other than laborers who're scattering, and the dude who just tried to pinpoint your muzzle flash location.*

Unknown (Nolan): Yeah I'll shoot that guy.

Chandu: *You have bracing, hit the combat helper.*

Chandu: *His HEAD AND ARMS are exposed at this moment.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Do I consider him prone?

Chandu: *No, regular.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, head. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Failure** -> 75 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Success at +20.

Unknown (Nolan): 7

Chandu: *True, the headshot doubles damage. Amazing.*

Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou rolls 1d6 -> 2 (Draws a result from the Head Critical Wounds (8+ Dmg) table)

4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: 4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 41 (Rolling CON Target: 60%)

Chandu: *He's badly hurt and bleeding.*

4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Serious Bleeding

Unknown (Mac): I'm getting into partial to see who is towards trench #2, I think it's the only place we don't have awareness of.

Unknown (Mac): Can I see the other side?

Chandu: *Hopping over those crates, you can. There's fuck all! Every civilian is running the other way, except for... you'll see.*

Chandu: *Nobody's here.*

Unknown (Mac): "ALELELELE!!!"

Unknown (Mac): I'll just shoot a long burst towards the air.

Chandu: *Scattered screaming from frightened workers...*

Chandu: *This guy doesn't have a target, he's hollering.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Have him aim at where the three suits are coming from possibly.

Unknown (Vardas): "HEYA HOOOYAAAAAAAAA HEYA HOYAAAAA"

Unknown (Vardas): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): From my visual I cannot see civvies running towards trench 2 either right

Chandu: *That's a negative so far. They're clumped up on the run to the trucks.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "KURDISATANA AZADDDDD!!!" and a burst of random fire towards the tents.

Chandu: *Which one...?*

Unknown (Mavridis): just spraying and praying, no real target.

Chandu: *This guy is still knocked out. Out of the carousel for now.*

Unknown (Giles): I'm going to Mac.

Unknown (Mac): "No one here, light the flare to Nolan."

Unknown (Mac): "He'll flashlight to the other side."

Unknown (Mac): "Stage two."

Unknown (Giles): "Yo! I think that shit is seeping up! We gotta shut down that trench quick!"

Unknown (Giles): Giles lights a flare.

Unknown (Mac): "That's why it's stage two!!"

Chandu: *This poor man... you've made him bleed out from that headshot.*

4 Sharp-Eyed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *Alright. These gentlemen are going to move all at once for expedience's sake.*

2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou: 2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 31 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

Chandu: *Vardas HAS got a shot on one of them.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Do as thou willth.

Unknown (Vardas): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, torso.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Failure** -> 93 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Chandu: *No effect— but one of them's rolling for suppression.*

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Laskaris is shooting over that way as well.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Let it rip.

Chandu: *Sorry, what score?*

Chandu: *He was told to shoot over the tents...!*

Unknown (Mavridis): I told the other guy to aim at them.

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: Short-range attachment(s) w/ bipod.Fire rate & range: Medium range, long burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Shooter: **Failure** - Target: **Failure**Miss. Huge targets: Miss.Braced: Miss.

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Failure** -> 86 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou: 2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 21 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: 1 Stressed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 90 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 43 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *He says something in French that none of you can hear, and... moves.*

5 Large Mercenary: 5 Large Mercenary rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 99 (Rolling Athletics Target: 50%)

Large Mercenary: 2

Chandu: *Normal move, no sprint.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Hm... I'll move to cover Carlyle. Can I take cover behind these logs?

Chandu: *Let's say you can. Weird spot with the terrain slump, but sure.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Condition Changes Partial Cover

Unknown (Carlyle): I'm guessing I can't throw a grenade at the reinforcements from here?

Chandu: *That would be a forty meter throw— let's say that on an Athletics **critical success** you manage to do so.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Okay yeah fuck that I'm just blasting them

Unknown (Carlyle): ARE THE CIVVIES STILL IN MY WAY

Chandu: *You tell me.*

Chandu: *Where are their tokens?*

Unknown (Carlyle): well they haven't fucking moved at all are they just standing there like retards

Chandu: *They moved here in their turn, they're actively running. You can still SHOOT an aimed shot at -20% directed at one of the ones behind them.*

Unknown (Carlyle): I'll just aim for this turn then.

Chandu: *We Go Forth.*

Unknown (Nolan): Any targets in my sights?

Chandu: *Nolan, no visual over the three suited guys. You've got no one in sight, even.*

Unknown (Mac): Isn't he relaying the message?

Chandu: *That's a free action— it's your plan and your action, you tell me.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unless I'm misunderstanding I'll fire the flare.

Chandu: *Flashlight at the mound, I think?*

Unknown (Mavridis): Indeed.

Chandu: *You can do that, a couple of taps is enough. You still have your action.*

Chandu: *What now? You can set up a pre-emptive aim, but it's your choice.*

Unknown (Nolan): I'll flash the mound and move south from my position to see where the trucks were initially.

Chandu: *Move up to 20 meters, you're not in any danger. Do as you will.*

Unknown (Nolan): Over.

Chandu: *Before we sort out your turn, let's reveal a couple of stragglers from the civilians that're running around.*

Chandu: *Carlyle, to be clear: you recognized these two from having seen them at the mound. That one night...*

Unknown (Mac): Do I have a minor elevation advantage here can I turn around and shoot above the tent.

Chandu: *You intend to shoot over four tents at these guys?*

Chandu: *No visual.*

Unknown (Mac): Ok. Me, Giles and the Greeks are moving ass to #2 after killing those suckers.

Unknown (Mac): Me and Giles immediately.

Chandu: *Go Ahead.*

Unknown (Mac): I'll hop the palisade and start sprinting.

Unknown (Mac): We're out of combat now I guess.

Chandu: *You're heading straight to #2?*

Unknown (Mac): I didn't see anyone posing a threat on the way there though no?

Unknown (Mac): Actually I'll just dive to full cover for a second and wait for Giles to turn up.

Unknown (Mac): Change mags.

Chandu: *There's no one on the way to the trench, that's right. Parsed...*

Unknown (Mavridis): "CONSERVE AMMO. AIM AND WAIT FOR THE FUCKERS."

Unknown (Mavridis): Put lil bro on aimed/overwatch in their general direction

Unknown (Mavridis): Flashes a message back to the opposite hill with his flashlight - NEG - IN CONTACT before aiming towards the general direction.

Chandu: *Apply the Aiming status effect.*

Unknown (Giles): I'm dropping the flare and running to hop the palisade.

Chandu: *You can do it this same turn. Popping you over.*

Unknown (Mac): I'll wave him to get down and reload too.

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 71 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

Unknown (Mavridis): Same deal as the other guy.

Chandu: *Laskaris is aiming, yes.*

Unknown (Laskaris): Condition Changes Aiming

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Suppressed

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: 1 Stressed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 47 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou: 2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 93 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

Chandu: *He's actually grabbing one of these guys in a chokehold and using him as a human shield.*

A Man: Condition Changes Restrained

Chandu: *This guy is short of options... he's thinking...*

Chandu: *Right. He's got a smoke grenade of his own, an RGD-2.*

Unknown (Mac): What the fuck is he doing? Do all 3 of them want to fucking die?

Chandu: *You can't read minds yet!*

Unknown (Fontaine): This guy here, he's armed and violent, right? Haven't seen him enter carousel yet.

Chandu: *That's right, he is. He'll enter the carousel on the next turn.*

Chandu: *Same with the others.*

Unknown (Fontaine): He's directly in my firing lane, so I'll shoot at him!

Unknown (Fontaine): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Failure** -> 85 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Chandu: *This guy's no soldier— he's suppressed.*

04 Hasan Demirci: Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *You only have a clear shot at the dude with the human shield.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Do I have a clean hit on any of those guys down the middle or— right

Unknown (Carlyle): Would it be -20%?

Chandu: *If you wanted to target him specifically in this complicated position, you'd have to treat it as if he were in partial cover.*

Chandu: *That means head and arms exposed.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Okay fuck it I'm going for him.

Unknown (Carlyle): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, head. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Carlyle): Aim & bodypart: Shot hits head. Weapon skill at -20%. Attachments: N/A. Fire rate & range: Consume 1 ammo if weapon magazine is not abstracted. Weapon skill, weapon damage. Speed & size: N/A.

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Failure** -> 80 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Chandu: *That's going to swish past both their heads. No civilians killed this round.*

Chandu: *Now we're going to roll initiative for the new guys.*

Chandu: *Surely you didn't think those two mercs were alone.*

Chandu: *Nolan, what was your action?*

Chandu: 1

Unknown (Nolan): Thoughtful Beyau Voyo seems to be in my direct line of sight. Would the proposed shot work?

Chandu: *Sure, hit it. You had time to prepare this one.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, head. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Success** -> 61 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Unknown (Nolan): 11

Thoughtful Beau Voyou: Thoughtful Beau Voyou rolls 1d10 -> 9 (Draws a result from the Catastrophic Wounds Table table)

Chandu: *His head is fucking pulverized.*

Chandu: *In a fantastic shower of gore and brains, Carlyle, you see his blood splatter all over the innocent civilian.*

2 Thoughtful Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Dead

Pensive Beau Voyou: "PUTAINE!!!! PHILIPPE!!!!"

Unknown (Giles): Deja vu...

1 Eager Mercenary: This man's had enough of waiting games. He's turning the corner and flinging a grenade at Carlyle's position.

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls **Failure** -> 79 (Rolling Athletics Target: 50%)

Chandu: Chandu rolls 2d8 -> 13 (Draws a result from the Downgraded Slow Projectile Deviation d8 table)

Chandu: *Grenade's position is marked. Carlyle, you're within suppression+minor shrapnel range.*

Unknown (Mac): "That didn't sound good."

Unknown (Mac): "We're going back."

Unknown (Mac): "Come on, let's go."

Unknown (Mac): How far can I sprint?

Chandu: *Hit 20 meters, no roll this once.*

Unknown (Mac): That won't be enough

Unknown (Mac): I need to flank them.

Chandu: *Hit the roll and let's see what you get.*

Unknown (Mac): I hope I don't trip and fall especially after you said that.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 6 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Hit 40 meters.*

Unknown (Mac): Can I shoot?

Chandu: *Sure, apply the sprinting debuff.*

Unknown (Mac): It's the highest possible at -40% but I don't give a shit anymore, I just want to apply suppression to whoever is behind that fog.

Chandu: *Which does not appear to be factored in the combat helper, but it is a -40— yea.*

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 58 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 38 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mac): That would terrify.

Chandu: *On a success, he only gets suppressed, correct?*

Unknown (Mac): Yes.

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Suppressed

Unknown (Mavridis): Am i allowed to talk to severe about tactics OOC

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Suppression, long burst.Speed & size: $\leq$ Normal, regular.

Chandu: *Not unless you're shouting, which he's in range for.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "BROTHER ARE WE MOVING OR STAYING!"

Unknown (Mac): He should more or less realize from me firing into the fucking smoke what's happening, and I won't speak back in English to him near people.

Chandu: *You call, Mavridis— Vardas does not have a shot, you can direct him as you will.*

Chandu: *He sees the tent Mac is moving for and can slide down the mound to get closer this turn.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Have him reload and move up to Mac.

Chandu: *He's good on ammo.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Then just have him move to Mac

Chandu: *He slides down the hill like a Ranger and sprints over.*

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Success** -> 16 (Rolling Athletics Target: 50%)

Unknown (Vardas): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): Doing the same, just with a reload if that is cool

Chandu: *Hit a DEX roll for a quick reload.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 44 (Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Sprint automatically applied. Move 30 meters.*

Unknown (Giles): I'm running after Mac.

Chandu: *Hit an Athletics.*

Unknown (Giles): Sprintin'.

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Success** -> 46 (Rolling Athletics Target: 50%)

Chandu: *30 meters.*

Unknown (Mac): Giles and Mavridis will flank further south, I want me and the machinegunner here.

Chandu: *This guy is shooting through the canvas over the diseased guys.*

Veteran Mercenary: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

3 Veteran Mercenary: 3 Veteran Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 37 (Rolling Firearms Target: 45%)

Chandu: *Mac, Vardas and Mavridis will roll for suppression.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 55 (Rolling POW Target: 65%)

Unknown (Mac): Shoot back?

Chandu: *Yes.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Success** -> 8 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Suppression, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Failure** -> 92 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 46 (Rolling Firearms Target: 40% (60%-20%))

Unknown (Vardas): Condition Changes Suppressed

3 Veteran Mercenary: 3 Veteran Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 42 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

3 Veteran Mercenary: Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *Mavridis, hit a POW roll.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Already did.

Unknown (Mavridis): Another?

Chandu: *This section of canvas is nearly shot through. My bad, didn't see the result.*

Unknown (Mac): Didn't this guy automatically jump for cover after getting a sup?

Chandu: *Is that a thing besides going prone on the spot?*

Unknown (Mac): If there is cover within reach, which there seems to be.

Chandu: *Alright, this dude is advancing and moving on Carlyle with his SMG.*

Pensive Beau Voyou: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Pensive Beau Voyou: Shooter: **Failure** - Target: **Failure** Miss. Huge targets: Lethality. Braced: Miss.

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 76 (Rolling Firearms Target: 40%)

Chandu: *Bad effect, no suppression roll.*

Chandu: *Laskaris is advancing...*

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Failure** -> 86 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Unknown (Laskaris): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): Fucking christ

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: 1 Stressed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 70 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

5 Large Mercenary: Condition Changes Aiming

Chandu: *You shot over this way...!*

Unknown (Fontaine): I'll take aim down this line.

Chandu: *Works. Apply Aiming.*

Chandu: *Carlyle, you're still within suppression and shrapnel range. Next turn, that F1 blows.*

Unknown (Carlyle): ok bro

Unknown (Carlyle): If I move here is there anyone I can do a move + shoot on?

Chandu: *Yep, that's a -20% penalty from jogging additional to your roll.*

Chandu: *You can shoot as you jog that is, your move.*

Chandu: *The grenade thrower is currently suppressed.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Ok I'm taking a shot at the laborer on the left.

Unknown (Carlyle): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Success** -> 39 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Chandu: *Bodypart & damage as per instructions, Go Forth.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls 1d10 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Unknown (Carlyle): 9

Cemal Öztürk: Cemal Öztürk rolls 1d6 -> 4 (Draws a result from the Leg Critical Wounds (8+ Dmg) table)

03 Cemal Öztürk: 03 Cemal Öztürk rolls **Success** -> 32 (Rolling CON Target: 40%)

03 Cemal Öztürk: Condition Changes Prone

03 Cemal Öztürk: Condition Changes Stunned

04 Hasan Demirci: Condition Changes Suppressed

03 Cemal Öztürk: Condition Changes Stunned

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, head. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Shooting the guy aiming at them

Chandu: *You DO have a visual, his back is facing you. Go ahead.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Success** -> 35 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Unknown (Nolan): 8

Large Mercenary: Large Mercenary rolls 1d6 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Head Critical Wounds (8+ Dmg) table)

5 Large Mercenary: 5 Large Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 3 (Rolling CON Target: 70%)

5 Large Mercenary: Condition Changes Aiming Stunned

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *His suppression is off, but his turn's still skipped.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm shooting veteran mercenary.

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 83 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 12 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mac): Still a suppress, not a terrify right.

Chandu: *He's smarter this time, and will be diving for cover instead of sitting here.*

Chandu: *Also, the smoke has dissipated.*

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Prone Suppressed

Unknown (Mac): I'm coldly nodding to the boy next to me to hop up and finish this fucking guy.

Unknown (Vardas): Condition Changes Suppressed

Chandu: *Clears suppression on his turn.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Eager mercenary, short range?

Chandu: *Yup, prone target*

Unknown (Mavridis): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, prone.

Chandu: *You could say he's in light cover, but that's bulletted canvas and a cot. His only cover is the sick guy on the cot.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 85 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *No effect other than...*

Chandu: *Roll damage.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Where do you roll damage, same as lethality?

Chandu: *Yup, keep lethality on.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 45 (9 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) / +SUP +PSO-1 Target: 10)

Chandu: *This guy is OUT. As such, we're doubling the damage.*

Chandu: *That's 16 damage, unaimed.*

Yusuf Kaya: Yusuf Kaya rolls 1d10 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Yusuf Kaya: Yusuf Kaya rolls 1d6 -> 2 (Draws a result from the Torso Critical Wounds (8+ Dmg) table)

07 Yusuf Kaya: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Mac): Giles will machine gun that goddamn tent no matter who is in it.

Selma Aydın: "KYAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA"

Selma Aydın: Condition Changes Prone

Unknown (Mac): Good thing you just did that my love...

Chandu: *Giles, go.*

Unknown (Giles): Should I approach from here.....

Unknown (Mac): SHOOT THE TENT NOW

Unknown (Giles): There's another tent between us, but fuck it.

Unknown (Giles): I'm shooting at the tent, good luck everyone!

Chandu: *Go Ahead Lad*

Unknown (Giles): Short range?

Chandu: *That's right.*

Unknown (Giles): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Success** -> 35 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Failure** -> 80 (18 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For RPK (3/4) / +BPD Target: 10)

Chandu: *As for who you're hitting, let's see. You're shooting without knowing what specifically you're shooting at. On a 5, the guy that's standing up is going to be hit. Otherwise he's going to roll POW for terrified.*

Chandu: 3

3 Veteran Mercenary: 3 Veteran Mercenary rolls **Failure** -> 53 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

3 Veteran Mercenary: Condition Changes Terrified Suppressed

Selma Aydın: Condition Changes Terrified

3 Veteran Mercenary: 3 Veteran Mercenary rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *He's staying put on the ground.*

3 Veteran Mercenary: Condition Changes Prone

Pensive Beau Voyou: This guy is... not risking it.

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Prone

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 11 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Unknown (Laskaris): Prone penalty will not apply at this distance.

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Failure** -> 64 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

1 Eager Mercenary: He's TERRIFIED.

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Terrified Suppressed

Stressed Beau Voyou: And this boy is a hero.

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: 1 Stressed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 58 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

Stressed Beau Voyou: Let's see who he's targetting: 1-2: Laskaris3: Mac

Stressed Beau Voyou: 1

Stressed Beau Voyou: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, single shot.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Chandu: *No effect, not even suppression from that.*

5 Large Mercenary: 5 Large Mercenary rolls **Failure** -> 90 (Rolling CON Target: 70%)

Chandu: *Sadly for this man, he's choked to death.*

5 Large Mercenary: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Fontaine): OK... Attempt two on Hasan.

Unknown (Fontaine): At +20% this time w/ aiming.

Chandu: *Hit it.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Aim & bodypart: Aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 60 (Rolling Firearms Target: 70% (50%+20%))

Unknown (Fontaine): Juuust double-checking. Burst = lethality.

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Failure** -> 73 (10 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) Target: 10)

Chandu: *Yup, roll the regular random hit on the injury macro too.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls 1d10 -> 10 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Hasan Demirci: Hasan Demirci rolls 1d10 -> 9 (Draws a result from the Catastrophic Wounds Table table)

Chandu: *His head turns into unrecognizable mush as it is pierced by several 7.62x39mm rounds on his way down.*

04 Hasan Demirci: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Carlyle): Single shot on the other laborer to try and finish him.

Chandu: *Go ahead.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Success** -> 2 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls 1d10 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Unknown (Carlyle): 5

Cemal Öztürk: Cemal Öztürk rolls 1d6 -> 6 (Draws a result from the Torso Serious Wounds (5, 6, 7 Dmg) table)

Cemal Öztürk: He falls limp, breathing his useless last.

03 Cemal Öztürk: Condition Changes Dead

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Can I see the stressed one?

Chandu: *He's behind a floodlight, Nolan. This is one shot you will not be able to take.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: What about pensive?

Chandu: *He's in "a" tent.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I guess I'll have to stay put for this turn.

Unknown (Mac): Ok now that those two guys are terrified and are standing in a suspiciously recoil pattern shaped line can Laskaris be fucking useful for once and end them without a roll?

Chandu: *Parsed.*

Chandu: *We'll see on his turn... hehe. Before we complete Nolan's, I'd forgotten...*

Chandu: *The canvas covers for the stores tent are flung open, and a mechanical sound can be hear simultaneously.*

Chandu: *Since he's attacking from an unexpected location, he's hitting his shot now. He's choosing a target.*

Chandu: *There's only one.*

Beau Voyou: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

5 Evil Beau Voyou: 5 Evil Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 93 (Rolling Firearms Target: 40%)

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Success** -> 12 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Laskaris is UNAFFECTED.*

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 34 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Terrified

Chandu: *Clears terrified, remains spent and prone.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm going to long burst Stressed running out of ammo in the process... let's hope Vardas next to me can execute those.

Unknown (Mac): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 85 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: 1 Stressed Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 83 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

1 Stressed Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Prone Terrified Terrified Suppressed

Unknown (Mac): "Now!"

Chandu: *Vardas is stepping over to support Laskaris with the shotgun man.*

Unknown (Vardas): Shooter: **Failure** - Target: **Failure** Miss. Huge targets: Lethality. Braced: Miss.

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Failure** -> 85 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Vardas): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

5 Evil Beau Voyou: 5 Evil Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 26 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *He sits unsuppressed, but steps back reflexively.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Im debating on running into the sick tent and shooting the prone guys or running into the shotguns guy tent

Unknown (Mavridis): No patience anymore

Unknown (Mac): Sick tent, now.

Unknown (Mavridis): "TAKBIR!"

1 Eager Mercenary: "ALLLLLLLAHHHHHHH!!!!"

Unknown (Mavridis): Eager mercenary at the shortest possible range imaginable

Chandu: *This functions as an execution unless he gets a **critical success** on dexterity.*

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls **Failure** -> 78 (Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

1 Eager Mercenary: 1 Eager Mercenary rolls 1d6 -> 4 (Draws a result from the Head Critical Wounds (8+ Dmg) table)

1 Eager Mercenary: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Mac): "One more."

Unknown (Mac): "Send it."

Unknown (Giles): "I'll be out!"

Unknown (Mac): "SEND IT!"

Unknown (Giles): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Giles): Sending it into the tent.

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Failure** -> 53 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Chandu: *wrong sfx*

Chandu: *No roll necessary— but the guy cowering behind him?*

A Man: A Man rolls 1d10 -> 7 (Draws a result from the Catastrophic Wounds Table table)

A Man: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Giles): Giles tosses the spent RPK and pulls out his pistol.

Chandu: *This guy is targeting MAVRIDIS AND LASKARIS.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Kiss me baby

Beau Voyou: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Chandu: *That was a failed short burst— you guys roll POW.*

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 1 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Success** -> 5 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 99 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Chandu: *WHAT? HIS GUN JAMMED AFTER ALL?*

Chandu: *Since that was an EPIC success, he's letting it drop and quickdrawing his pistol.*

Unknown (Laskaris): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Failure** -> 56 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Mavridis): THESE DUDES SUCK SO FUCKING MUCH

5 Evil Beau Voyou: 5 Evil Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 71 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

5 Evil Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Suppressed

3 Veteran Mercenary: 3 Veteran Mercenary rolls **Success** -> 23 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

3 Veteran Mercenary: Condition Changes Terrified

Chandu: *Clears, remains spent.*

Chandu: *THIS GUY IS RUNNING FOR THE TRUCKS.*

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Failure** -> 96 (Rolling Athletics Target: 40%)

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Prone

Chandu: *He's completely exposed to Nolan, who's got overwatch at the area. And he's not obscured by the floodlight.*

Chandu: *Nolan, you get a free shot.*

Unknown (Mac): Hope he holds...

Unknown (Nolan): Rolling.

Unknown (Mavridis): FUCK THAT KILL EVERYONE

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, legs. Attachments: Long-range attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Medium range, single shot. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Failure** -> 98 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Unknown (Mac): IT'S FINE ONE OF THEM NEEDS TO ESCAPE

3 Pensive Beau Voyou: 3 Pensive Beau Voyou rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *He's more worried about getting the fuck out of dodge than taking cover at the moment. He's going for the Jeep.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Laskaris is jihad maxxng

Chandu: *Laskaris is finishing this.*

Unknown (Mavridis): run up on them

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Success** -> 8 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Chandu: *That's gonna count as double damage from how close it is— he's also in melee range.*

Beau Voyou: Beau Voyou rolls 1d6 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Torso Minor Wounds (3, 4 Dmg) table)

5 Evil Beau Voyou: 5 Evil Beau Voyou rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling CON Target: 60%)

5 Evil Beau Voyou: Condition Changes Unconscious

Unknown (Mac): I think the combat is over can I switch to my PB and execute that last merc?

Chandu: *That can be done. Proceed.*

Unknown (Mac): No roll?

Chandu: *You're out of turn, but no biggie. We can sort it out, because there's something else that's happening.*

Unknown (Mac): Mac drops his AKMN on its sling and pulls out his PB, splattering the mans skull all over the floor.

3 Veteran Mercenary: Condition Changes Dead

Unknown (Mac): He turns around and aims at Selma.

Selma Aydın: She yells "DON'T SHOOT!" in Turkish and shoves herself against the corner.

Unknown (Mac): I'm gonna wave her off, try to get her to run with my pistol.

Chandu: *The other two guys are running for the hills— but she's not getting in the truck with murderer criminals, as it seems. She's staying put, terrified.*

Chandu: *For now.*

Unknown (Mac): He exhales and puts the PB back in its holster.

Unknown (Mac): I'm going back to Giles, we need to reload our shit. I'll take the magazines out my backpack and place them in the rig.

Unknown (Mavridis): Mavridis breathes in and out quickly before swapping into a fresh mag.

Chandu: *The Jeep rushes off, leaving dirt tracks as Nolan takes pot shots at it.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "BIJI BIJI BIJI!"

Unknown (Giles): Giles backtracks and picks up his RPK.

Unknown (Nolan): Nolan holds his position as planned.

Chandu: *Before we continue, you guys are free to position yourselves and take stock of your ammo and reload if necessary. We're not proceeding to trench #2 JUST YET.*

Chandu: *Have a 10 minute break before we enter the last stretch of DE PROFUNDIS.*

Unknown (Mac): Once I restock my pouch with the fresh magazines I want to start clearing out the tents we didn't go in. We do not have any spare time left.

Unknown (Mac): I still have one drum with half remaining inserted.

Unknown (Mac): Tag along Giles.

Unknown (Mavridis): The Greeks are tagging along with Mac and doing likewise, resupplying.

Chandu: *The entire fight lasted about a half hour.*

Chandu: *What're we thinking right now, everyone?*

Unknown (Mavridis): Tougher than expected. Close calls, too much heat. Still alive. Wanna finish this.

Unknown (Nolan): They had it coming. I've slung my SVD on my back and am approaching the bridge with my AKM at hand.

Unknown (Giles): Let's get to the meat and potatoes then get the FUCK outta here.

Unknown (Mac): Is the tent fire over?

Chandu: *Sure it is.*

Unknown (Mac): I need to check in on it. I'm prepared for a sweet surprise.

Chandu: *Go ahead.*

Unknown (Fontaine): It's been a while since I blew a guy's head off. The old guard here probably doesn't even register when they do it. I'm more concerned about the trench, though.

Chandu: *As you enter, Mac...*

Chandu: *Most of the tent is burnt to a crisp (despite the graphics...)*

Chandu: *There's someone kneeling over Whiteman's corpse, though. 1 minutes.*

Unknown (Mac): Why does it never end the easy way with these types? Mac aims at the person.

Chandu: *Right. There it is.*

Chandu: *This is happening to you and yourself only.*

Ariadne Mekonakis: She's just eyeing him over, examining the charred remains.

Unknown (Mac): "Of course. We set a bunch of heroin on fire."

Unknown (Mac): "I wasn't expecting to meet you like this."

Unknown (Mac): He lowers his weapon.

Ariadne Mekonakis: "I cannot say the same!"

Ariadne Mekonakis: "It was, eh— smart, to avoid sleeping here more than necessary."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "You did not make me have to repeat myself, at least."

Unknown (Mac): "It's not at all unpleasant to see you at a time like this. We'd go good together if you were real, I guess."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "Reality is subjective. Excuse my verbose."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "But there's something more important to note..."

Ariadne Mekonakis: She points at the floor.

Unknown (Mac): "Of course."

Unknown (Mac): He takes out his knife.

Chandu: *Whiteman isn't moving, of course. But you haven't realized until now...*

Chandu: *It isn't only the ground around Whiteman, but the ground around every single corpse.*

Unknown (Mac): "You should probably close your eyes."

Chandu: *It's muddy. Filled with black, gooey puddles.*

Chandu: *Everyone outside— while you're not sure where Mac is at the moment as you gather your bearings... you can see that the goo itself is crawling out of the ground and into the dead.*

Chandu: *Into the corpses of those that haven't been mangled.*

Unknown (Fontaine): "Jesus fucking Christ..."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "Oh, no, feel free. This one will not get up, anyway."

Chandu: *Everyone outside hit a SANLOSS roll.*

Unknown (Mac): "Really? Thanks for saving me some time then."

Unknown (Mac): "My friends are well armed enough to deal with the rest."

Unknown (Mavridis): He opens his shemmagh up to light a cigarette before noticing it. The cigarette remains dangling from his lips, the match burning into nothing.

Chandu: *That's MACROS -> SANLOSS*

Unknown (Mac): "Though, this has been too often to keep being a game of cat and mouse. Who are you, really? And I mean it."

Chandu: *1 seconds, parsing rolls...*

Chandu: *While the rest of you are more or less acquainted with fuckery to this degree, the Greeks are not.*

Chandu: *Mavridis, you cannot believe your eyes. Nor can Laskaris and Vardas.*

Unknown (Vardas): Unknown (Vardas) rolls **Failure** -> 65 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Laskaris): Unknown (Laskaris) rolls **Failure** -> 73 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 53 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Laskaris and Vardas REFUSE to stay here. They're going to wait it out at the truck over the hill.*

Unknown (Mac): Didn't we kill most of these people to headshots anyway? Strange...

Chandu: *Mavridis— you're not like them. What drives you to go on?*

Unknown (Mavridis): I have a mission to complete.

Unknown (Mavridis): I follow orders.

Unknown (Mavridis): "WHERE THE FUCK ARE YOU TWO GOING?"

Unknown (Mavridis): "GET THE FUCK BACK HERE THAT IS AN ORDER!"

Unknown (Laskaris): "I DON'T KNOW!!!!"

Unknown (Mavridis): "NOW!"

Chandu: *Hit Psychotherapy twice, Mavridis. 20% bonus.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 38 (Rolling Psychotherapy Target: 10%)

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 25 (Rolling Psychotherapy Target: 10%)

Chandu: *Fail on Laskaris.*

Chandu: *Success on Vardas.*

Chandu: *Laskaris is shaking. He's not, for any fucking reason, going back in there. He'll take the chew-out later, but he's not going in.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Fontaine's right there, turning his head when he sees Mavridis' panic. "Not everyone's cut for it, son. Just stick with us."

Unknown (Mavridis): "FUCKING COWARDS!"

Unknown (Nolan): Has Selma been pistol whipped into sleep?

Unknown (Mavridis): "COURT MARTIAL FOR YOU LASKARIS THE COLONEL WILL HEAR ABOUT THIS YOU PIG FUCK!"

Unknown (Mavridis): He spits on the ground and shakily attempts to light another cigarette, his eyes bulging at the black goo.

Chandu: *Vardas is back with you. He's shaking. He's more than familiar with violence and the killing of both guilty and innocent, even countrymen— but not this.*

Chandu: *Moving on, back in the tent.*

Ariadne Mekonakis: "I'd rather you tried to find out on your own. I've noticed that you're not much one for reading, much less the ancients..."

Unknown (Mac): "Come on..."

Unknown (Mac): "Fuck. Keep your secrets I guess."

Unknown (Mac): "Since we won't ever get to that, can you at least tell me what's underneath the mound?"

Ariadne Mekonakis: "Divinity. A shape of it, at least," she says, with disgust on her face.

Ariadne Mekonakis: "It'd be best to make haste. It works quickly." She glances outside.

Unknown (Mac): "One more question."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "Yes?"

Unknown (Mac): "What do we do now? You were pretty useful the last time."

Unknown (Giles): Giles shouts: "THE MOTHAFUCKIN' TRENCH! WE GOTTA GET TO IT!"

Ariadne Mekonakis: She strokes her jaw in a gesture you recognize from elsewhere. "Seal what was sealed thousands of years ago. There were others like you, thousands of years ago."

Unknown (Mac): From where?

Unknown (Fontaine): "Nolan, go check on Mac." Fontaine's pulling up to Giles.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan looks inside from the tent flaps.

Ariadne Mekonakis: "Here." She gestures over her Seljuk noble clothing. "And much earlier, too. The ones who worshiped were killed, the pit sealed."

Unknown (Mavridis): The two Greeks follow the others. Mavridis is trying to hype up Vardas.

Ariadne Mekonakis: "And now it is not worship, but weaponization."

Unknown (Mavridis): "W-we thought you guys were high."

Unknown (Mac): I noticed Nolan from his footsteps. I'm not gonna look like a lunatic to him. I'll just wait for her to disappear.

Unknown (Giles): "I got the TNT. We gotta blow this fuckin' joint."

Unknown (Mavridis): "Americans on dope from Vietnam."

Chandu: *Nolan—Mac is, at the moment, looking at an empty spot over Whiteman.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "What the fuck is going on?"

Unknown (Fontaine): "We planning to seal it back up, yeah?"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan does not speak, keeping a steady gaze on Mac.

Unknown (Giles): "Tying up loose ends is what," Giles pulls out the bottle of black liquid.

Unknown (Giles): "It all comes back to this shit."

Ariadne Mekonakis: "They struck the seal open. You came here with the right intention."

Ariadne Mekonakis: She points at Nolan.

Unknown (Mavridis): "My boy over there got four pounds of demo, he can help."

Unknown (Mac): I'll smile and turn around.

Unknown (Mac): "Fuck the walking dead. We're all going to the trench, now. The Gendermarie can deal with it."

Unknown (Mac): "No one's gonna believe them anyways. Call everyone, we're going NOW."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan nods.

Unknown (Mac): That being said, we are all sprinting towards the trench. We are genuinely not dealing with the reanimated corpses.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "FORM UP!"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "WE'RE MOVING!"

Chandu: *We're loading trench #2 as the dead (those who're not destroyed) start twitching at the limbs.*

Chandu: *Are we doing anything with Selma? Carlyle is staying up here for now.*

Chandu: *At this point, she's losing it.*

Selma Aydın: Condition Changes Insane

Unknown (Mac): Let's drag her the fuck along.

Unknown (Mac): She can no longer hide from the zombies.

Selma Aydın: Condition Changes Prone

Unknown (Giles): Yeah let's shatter the mind of this young girl.

Unknown (Mavridis): She already shattered bro.

Chandu: *She's nonverbal and looking down at the mud as everyone treads along the wet soil.*

Chandu: *LOADING TRENCH #2.*

Unknown (Mac): On our way out can we grab the good guns though?

Unknown (Mac): They have been hovering over the corpses for a while.

Unknown (Mavridis): folk.

Unknown (Mac): Not the crap I mean automatics.

Chandu: *There's FN FALs to be picked up, but you can't swear by their condition or that of their ammo.*

Unknown (Mac): Perfect.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'm happy with my AKM.

Unknown (Mac): Someone's gonna carry it not-combat-ready.

Chandu: *Let's skip over the inventory rearrangement for now, we'll sort it when it's time. There are 3 FN FALs.*

Chandu: *Who's taking them?*

Unknown (Mavridis): Carlyle he aint doing shit

Unknown (Giles): Giles grabs one.

Unknown (Mac): I think Fontaine and Carlyle have spare inventory.

Unknown (Mac): Let's skip.

Unknown (Mavridis): Yeah fuck this bigger fish to fry

Chandu: *Fontaine, Carlyle and Giles have FN FALs slung over their shoulders now.*

Chandu: *The trench. The floor here is muddy and wet, covered in black slog.*

Chandu: *It smells like death, corruption.*

Unknown (Mac): "We're too many people here. We're gonna trip over each other like what happened the last time."

Unknown (Mac): "Keep your distance. I want Bravo to rig the explosives now."

Unknown (Giles): Should I start lining sticks and wire already?

Unknown (Mac): "Not you, leave it to them, you're coming with me."

Unknown (Mavridis): "My boy is a sapper he got 4 pounds of that good shit."

Unknown (Giles): "Aight."

Unknown (Mac): "Check your weapons and ammo."

Unknown (Mac): "That's 12 pounds of TNT in total, I think."

Unknown (Giles): Giles pushes up behind pointman.

Chandu: *Identifying where to place the explosives will take a confident sapper a moment to determine. Giles and Vardas are capable of doing this.*

Unknown (Giles): "I got eight on me. I can pass it."

Chandu: *The entrance, however, is not the only spot to plant them.*

Unknown (Mac): If anything the entrance should be sealed at the very least and I don't wanna conga line in here so they get to it.

Unknown (Mavridis): Barks orders at Vardas to prepare to seal this place then move on up.

Chandu: *Parsed. Everyone has flashlights, RMB your token then RMB the little flame icon to select it.*

Chandu: *We move in the turn order unless you want to keep a specific formation.*

Unknown (Mac): Am I not up front?

Chandu: *Yes— let's skip turns until it coincides. Hold on.*

Chandu: *Go ahead.*

Unknown (Mac): Distance?

Unknown (Mac): I wanna slowwalk my way in so I don't get any maluses.

Chandu: *This isn't really stable. You can walk up to 16 feet, jog up to 32. Sprinting is not a poss*

Chandu: *-ibility.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'm trailing behind until something happens that necessitates the use of my superior agility.

Unknown (Mavridis): Skip me no point in moving. Congestion.

Unknown (Mavridis): He rigging shit.

Chandu: *Vardas is lining up the entrance, his hands shaking.*

Chandu: *Selma's just staying close to the rear man.*

Unknown (Mac): Isn't Caryle waiting outside with her?

Chandu: *Oh, you wanted them both up at the entrance?*

Chandu: *That's okay.*

Unknown (Mac): I mean nearby, not directly at the entrance. I don't think she can help us in any way down here, worse if she goes crazy.

Unknown (Mac): I'm signalling "two down" as I turn north.

Unknown (Fontaine): "Fucking labyrinth in here..." Matt murmurs.

Unknown (Mac): "Nolan, the second corridor."

Unknown (Mavridis): Did he put the charges up

Unknown (Mac): Awesome dead end.

Chandu: *He's pulling on the line and setting it up as he goes, ye.*

Chandu: *As you slide down the little drop, Giles, the soggy ground in front of you starts pooling up into distinct spots.*

Chandu: *The entirety of the ground is covered in a thin film of slime, but these seem... intentional.*

Chandu: *One by one, "things" come up.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 77 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Unknown (Giles): "Oh shi-!"

Slime of a-Abhi: Condition Changes Stunned

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 55 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Unknown (Mac): "FUCK!"

Slime of a-Abhi: 3

Chandu: *This isn't a targeted attack— it's trying to pin you down.*

Unknown (Giles): Condition Changes Restrained

Chandu: *You can resist this one with a STR roll... but only on a crit **success**, given its own crit success.*

Unknown (Giles): "Fuck!" Giles struggles with the slime.

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **Success** -> 17 (Rolling STR Target: 75%)

Chandu: *Ineffective, but you're not drawn to your feet.*

Unknown (Mac): "OUT! OUT NOW!"

Unknown (Giles): "Don't fucking leave me here!"

Unknown (Fontaine): "Motherfucker!" Is it an actual tentacle? Can I shoot at the point its sprouting from to sever it?

Chandu: *It's up to you to try.*

Chandu: *It certainly looks like a tendril.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Bro that's ominous. What do I roll for it?

Unknown (Fontaine): Just firearms as usual?

Chandu: *Skip the combat helper, hit your weapon roll.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Single shot at the base of the tendril.

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 12 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Chandu: *Hit DMG.*

Unknown (Fontaine): 7

Chandu: *It's dispersed! Giles can move now.*

Unknown (Giles): Condition Changes Restrained

Unknown (Fontaine): "Get back!"

Chandu: *It'll take a few moments to pool up again into another tendril.*

Chandu: *This one missed its lash this turn. Stays stunned.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: How many meters can I move while still shooting here?

Chandu: *Carlyle, you can rush in.*

Chandu: *You can move up to 20 ft while shooting with the -20% debuff from jogging.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 99 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Fuck. It was aimed at the one furthest right.

Chandu: *Your shot goes wide, hitting the rocks behind.*

Chandu: *One moment, parsing Carlyle's loss...*

Chandu: *Carlyle, you observed this fluid pooling up and crawling into the corpses up above. Not daring to leave Selma to her own devices, you've brought her along. She's still unresponsive other than following simple commands.*

Chandu: *This one already acted.*

Unknown (Mac): "OUTT!!"

Unknown (Mavridis): "VARGAS GET THIS SHIT READY TO BLOW! EVERY FUCKING MILIGRAM!"

Unknown (Mavridis): Shooting at the one closest to the group

Unknown (Vardas): "WE HAVE TO GO DEEPER TO COLLAPSE IT PROPER!!!"

Chandu: *Which one, point at it.*

Unknown (Mac): "Shit..."

Unknown (Mavridis): "THIS IS NOT A FUCKING DEBATE WE ARE NOT GOING DEEPER!"

Unknown (Mac): "He's right you know!"

Chandu: *Alright, hit your Firearms roll. For further reference: the ones illuminated by a flashlight get a normal roll, the others get -20% from obscured.*

Chandu: *The one you're targeting is illuminated.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Success** -> 48 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Damage, normal roll.*

Chandu: *Tick off lethality.*

Unknown (Mavridis): 5

Chandu: *It's dispersed. It'll take a bit to form back up.*

Chandu: *Vardas continues lining...*

Unknown (Mac): Can I do something cool?

Unknown (Mac): I wanna slide down to Giles and cut down the two next to him in one long burst at point blank.

Unknown (Giles): "Get in here! Help get these shits away from me, we still got TNT!"

Chandu: *You feel a gentle hand pushing you forward. No athletics roll necessary, move.*

Unknown (Giles): To what point do we need to get for the detonation to be viable?

Chandu: *Hit your shot.*

Unknown (Mac): Mac slides down like a pro and starts blasting at the roots of the two fuckers.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 60 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *You'll know when you reach a vulnerable spot—for now, what Vardas is doing will only collapse the entrance, not the entire cavern.*

Chandu: *These both are dispersed.*

Unknown (Mac): "Nobody's leaving you behind."

Unknown (Mac): "Get up."

Unknown (Giles): Giles is still standing. He pushes Mac to the side a little as he unloads on the one standing there.

Chandu: *Hit your roll, that's illuminated.*

Unknown (Giles): Unknown (Giles) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 44 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Chandu: *It's dispersed... and you get to move in this same turn, if you so wish.*

Chandu: *20 ft, as before.*

Unknown (Mac): "Behind. Cover me, I need to reload."

Unknown (Giles): "Fontaine, get here! We gotta extend the line." Giles pulls out a stick of dynamite and begins planting it on the corner wall here.

Unknown (Giles): "Get the wire here!"

Chandu: *No demo roll necessary. Vardas is treading along forward.*

Unknown (Mac): "ALRIGHT CHANGE OF PLANS EVERYONE SECURE PERIMETER!"

Chandu: *Carlyle, you can move up to 40ft.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I DO THAT!

SA Bryan Carlyle: ...While telling Selma to follow.

Chandu: *She does so, looking at the ground and covering her head with her arms.*

Unknown (Fontaine):My turn is done just to be clear. I moved.

Unknown (Fontaine): Setting up aim though!

Chandu: *The slime is not yet back...*

Chandu: *This is an exceptional situation, and your move was short. Set your aiming line.*

Chandu: *Cool.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nothing I can see there so I'm moving up.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: 40ft?

Chandu: *We're back to 20 only at the front.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Fontaine turns his head some. "Hey, Greek, keep an eye out on that canal."

Unknown (Mavridis): "VARDAS GET TO THE NEGRO NOW!"

Chandu: *Are you setting up an aiming line or something?*

Unknown (Mavridis): Im tossing a flare up that tunnel.

Unknown (Giles): "FUCK YOU YOU BOUREKAS EATING SHIT!"

Unknown (Mavridis): The signal flare.

Unknown (Mavridis): Aiming if i can and thats it

Chandu: *He's skipping over past you.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): He better fucking hustle

Chandu: *The line's connected.*

Unknown (Vardas): "WE HAVE TO SET UP MORE!" He points deeper, understanding the layout.

Chandu: *You can confirm that, Giles—you make the same connection.*

Unknown (Mac): The flares... We're out of WP but we still have fire. I wanna pull one and stab the pools around me with it.

Chandu: *It seems to recoil from the flare's flame— not only that, but you also realize that the spots around your boots are, oddly, not covered in slime.*

Chandu: *Giles' and Vardas' are.*

Chandu: *What else?*

Unknown (Mac): I'm dropping it here as we move further down. Reloading. Speed reload since it's a regular mag?

Chandu: *Valid, go on.*

Unknown (Mac): "Pull a flare at the entrance, make a corridor."

Unknown (Mac): He says as he racks the bolt back.

Unknown (Mac): "This should buy us some time."

Unknown (Giles): Giles is moving to the next 'pillar' of the cave and planting more dynamite.

Unknown (Mac): "FLARE FIRST!"

Unknown (Giles): "Man, fuck!" Giles fumbles with the dynamite and the flare and then rips it open and drops it a little to the side.

Chandu: *Easy enough to do. You drop it at your feet as you go on.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I FLARE THE ENTRANCE

Chandu: *You can do that and move past Mavridis, go ahead.*

Unknown (Fontaine): "You sticking one here too?!" Fontaine points to the tunnel ahead of him.
"I'll flare it if you need it rigged!"

Chandu: *The next spot is there.*

Unknown (Giles): "We need it down here!"

Unknown (Mac): "I got you."

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 5 (Rolling POW Target: 75%)

Chandu: *Also guys, make sure to tick the flares you're spending.*

Unknown (Fontaine): "I'll- OH, Alright!" I'm not moving.

Unknown (Fontaine): End turn!

Chandu: *By now, they're back.*

Unknown (Mac): He taunts the useless flaccid cock creatures.

Chandu: *Let's see if this one's agile enough.*

Unknown (Mac): "It's just some fire bitch!"

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 99 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Slime of a-Abhi: Condition Changes Stunned

Unknown (Mac): "Nolan. Throw one over there."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I want a short burst with my AKM on the middle one.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: But can I also flare? Not aimed.

Unknown (Mavridis): TOSS IT AT THEM FUCKER

Chandu: *Either or.*

Unknown (Mac): Throw it towards the ramp I'm pointing towards it so they don't climb up.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Flare it is.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'll get vision for Fontaine.

Chandu: *That's a flare down. You get to turn around and put your aim up at whichever of these guys you choose.*

Unknown (Nolan): Condition Changes Aiming

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Aimed at the middle one.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Over.

Chandu: *As for the flares, we're doing 1d4 ROUNDS for them. We're assuming the ones placed before rolled 4, they're on 3 now.*

Chandu: 4

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "ONE UP HERE IN THE CREVICE!"

Chandu: *This one is gathering up more slime to its mass and propelling itself straight towards Giles in pure malice.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 88 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Chandu: *WHAT?*

Chandu: *It sizzles as it stops short... and melts down into the ground.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 18 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Unknown (Giles): "What the-"

Chandu: *This one is shooting at... Nolan.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 17 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Chandu: *It's going for...*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls 1d10 -> 1 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Chandu: *Sure. Take a shot at +20%, Nolan.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Success** -> 54 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

Chandu: *DMG.*

Chandu: *Tick off lethality.*

Unknown (Nolan): 7

Chandu: *Just enough. It melts down into the ground mid-air.*

Unknown (Mac): "This is getting dire. Is that the last pillar or do we need more fucking dynamite?"

Chandu: *This one is going to creepily fucking crawl its way up the wall and onto the roof to reach at Fontaine.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 2 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Unknown (Fontaine): Nolan alerted me to its presence.

Unknown (Fontaine): So I should get an early shot.,

Chandu: *Hit it at +20%.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 21 (Rolling Firearms Target: 70% (50%+20%))

Chandu: *DMG, normal.*

Unknown (Fontaine): 3

Chandu: *You graze some of its mass off. It's still slithering.*

Slime of a-Abhi: 4

Unknown (Fontaine): "Oh God damn it—"

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls 1d10 -> 7 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls 1d6 -> 5 (Draws a result from the Torso Minor Wounds (3, 4 Dmg) table)

Chandu: *For a mercy, after it launches itself at your chest, it disintegrates and melts down into the ground.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): Taking a shot at the one im clicking at rn

Unknown (Mavridis): Any plus for aimed

Unknown (Mavridis): Actually was aiming down the corridor so idk

Chandu: *Not this instance, you swung around. Hit it normal.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Condition Changes Aiming

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 90 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Ineffective! It goes wide.*

Chandu: *Connecting...*

Unknown (Mac): "How many more do we need?"

Chandu: *It goes deeper, Giles and Vardas reckon. Southeast.*

Chandu: *In fact, the seal was here.*

Unknown (Giles): "Man, it'll take less if you stop bitchin'! We go deeper southeast!"

Unknown (Mac): If we blow that one will this shit be over?

Chandu: *Maybe.*

Unknown (Giles): It won't be 'over' over but it'll be over for us specifically.

Unknown (Mac): Alright. I'm slowwalking down besides these two and long bursting the one in that corridor.

Chandu: *Hit it at -20%, right?*

Chandu: 2

Chandu: *You feel euphoric at the moment. The deeper inside you go, the softer it feels. Not in a numbing way— in a rewarding way.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 46 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

Chandu: *Normal DMG.*

Unknown (Mac): 9

Chandu: *It melts down.*

Unknown (Giles): Giles grabs another flare and lets it rip, he carries it to that spot and drops it at his feet as he pulls out a stick of dynamite.

Unknown (Mac): "Tell me this is it. I'm running out of ammo here."

Unknown (Giles): "Man, fuck..... Deeper? This should be enough to collapse most of this shit!"
Giles looks at Vardas.

Chandu: *It gets wider... further southeast.*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Is this slime here active? I wanna shoot it.

Unknown (Fontaine): Fontaine shouts, "Can't you just end it over there?!"

Chandu: *It is! Hit it normal.*

Unknown (Mac): Oh we need to get the other side.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart.Attachments: No attachment(s).Fire rate & range: Short range, short burst.Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Chandu: *You can walk across this little pit here, by the way— it's where the seal was lifted.*

Chandu: *Carlyle, just hit your Firearms roll.*

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Success** -> 54 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

Unknown (Giles): "Man we don't need to collapse the whole fuckin' thing. We just need to collapse the entrance then put a sign that it's radioactive or some shit!"

Chandu: *Tick off lethality for the next one.*

Unknown (Carlyle): 3

Chandu: *It was stunned— you put it back down in the mud.*

Chandu: *Fontaine?*

Unknown (Fontaine): Since I can't see any, I'll try to listen in past the crackling of the flares.
Where is the slime pooling up now?

Unknown (Mac): "Throw one in the pit."

Chandu: *It looks like it's retreating further inside, towards the pit. Like it's protecting something.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Jog was uh, 40, yeah?

Chandu: *The ground is still muddy where it's unlit, but it's no longer splashing.*

Chandu: *Yup.*

Unknown (Mac): "Actually save that for now."

Unknown (Mac): "It looks like they are leaving."

Unknown (Mac): "Keep securing the perimeter."

Unknown (Fontaine): "OK."

Unknown (Fontaine): I'll stay here, aiming down this line.

Unknown (Giles): "I'm out of flares, man."

Chandu: *Put it up.*

Unknown (Mac): "Me too."

Chandu: *Now, as we go into this round, everyone hit a SANLOSS test.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "I GOT ONE LEFT!"

Chandu: *This is a check.*

Unknown (Giles): just the macro?

Chandu: *Fontaine, you specifically: the mound, the cave, the slime, they resonate. Somehow. You hear the voices of thousands, maybe hundreds of thousands of dead over centuries. Thousands of years, even. Anything that dies here is remembered for eternity. It's blissful. It's a form of immortality...*

Chandu: *The slime, it keeps your memory alive.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Uh... I don't like that! Not at all.

Chandu: *Turns!*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Done.

Unknown (Mavridis): "YOU BOYS NEED FLARES DOWN THERE?"

Unknown (Giles): "Deeper here!"

Chandu: *Hopping off the ledge here is no issue, it's a little slide on your feet.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Trying to make it to the demo guys as much as i can

Unknown (Mavridis): Athletics?

Chandu: *40ft, no roll.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Can i toss the flare.

Chandu: *YEA*

Unknown (Mac): "Over there."

Unknown (Mavridis): Right into the pit broski

Unknown (Giles): Is it a pit? Giles is not try to jump it.

Chandu: *We're resolving this as a depression that heads further down, past where the seal was.*

Chandu: *You can walk down, it's no issue.*

Unknown (Mavridis): "ENOUGH FUCKING WIRING LETS JUST LEAVE MAN!"

Unknown (Mac): "Relax."

Unknown (Mavridis): "Nothing to relax about."

Unknown (Giles): "This is where it was sealed! If we blow this and the rest of the dynamite it SHOULD collapse up to the entrance..."

Unknown (Mac): I'm gonna move in.

Chandu: *MAC.*

Unknown (Mac): Anything particular?

Unknown (Mac): I am at the safety of the flare so these fuckers should be at least scared right.

Chandu: *One of them, at least. They're holding their ground here.*

Chandu: *They're recoiling both from you at the light, cautiously... but these don't work by any form of human logic. You can't predict their next move.*

Unknown (Mac): Can I see what they are protecting?

Chandu: *With a flare, you could. It smells worse here. Like a morgue left out without air conditioning in the middle of summer.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm bored. I think I'm gonna throw a frag grenade where they coalesce, not before asking for a flare from one of the guys though.

Unknown (Mac): "Here goes nothing."

Unknown (Mavridis): "What the fuck is he do-"

Chandu: *A grenade is 30ft of shrapnel, 15ft killzone.*

Unknown (Mac): Obviously I am chucking it outside of that damn.

Chandu: *Point at where you're throwing it.*

Unknown (Mac): Straight ahead. I feel like that is where what we are looking for is.

Chandu: *POINT AT WHERE YOU'RE THROWING IT*

Unknown (Mac): Can I hand the flare for the time being?

Chandu: *Sure.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm activating it when I go in gonna conserve it.

Chandu: *You throw the grenade... there'll be no deviation. The range is short enough.*

Chandu: *It explodes in the next turn.*

Unknown (Giles): Is this side done?

Chandu: *It is.*

Unknown (Giles): Where should the next explosive go? I assume we can actually make it viable if we start making it a circle like this.

Chandu: *That sounds good. Go ahead.*

Chandu: *You're the specialist... khehhe*

Unknown (Giles): Planting one here.

Chandu: *15 MINUTES LAST STRETCH LET'S BANG THESE OUT*

SA Bryan Carlyle: I seem to have pretty good coverage here so I'll just take aim in case some more slimes show up.

Chandu: *Put your dingaling up!*

Unknown (Fontaine): Doing nothing. Aim line's the same... don't want my friends flanked.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I want to flare into the room Mac naded.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Reasonable distance.

Unknown (Mac): It should have exploded by now

Chandu: *It should have...*

Chandu: *It should have.*

Unknown (Mavridis): ON YOUR FEET SOLDIER

Unknown (Mavridis): WE ARE LEAVING

Slime of a-Abhi: 15

Slime of a-Abhi: 8

Unknown (Giles): Unless they snuffed that shit out by getting on top of it.

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 69 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "GET THE FUCK BACK MAC!"

Chandu: *It's launching itself at Mac in a suicide attack.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 88 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Chandu: *WHAT?*

Chandu: *Yup. It disintegrated in mid-air, losing consistency.*

Chandu: *MAVRIDIS!!!*

Unknown (Mac): "Give me your grenade."

Unknown (Mac): "Throw it to me."

Unknown (Mac): He raises a hand to catch it.

Unknown (Mavridis): Throws the grenade to Mac

Unknown (Mavridis): Roll?

Chandu: *YOU hit Athletics, Mac will catch it on anything other than a critfail.*

Chandu: *I'm assuming it's not primed...*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Unknown (Mavridis): Duh

Chandu: *It's in your hand, Mac.*

Unknown (Mac): Can I cook it so it explodes on impact or at least before it's absorbed or something? I think the last one went dud.

Unknown (Mac): I kinda have the advantage of thinking here.

Chandu: *You'll try to throw it at an angle so it goes over and behind, where it can't be smothered.*

Chandu: *Hit normal Athletics, success will do.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 45 (Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

Unknown (Giles): Giles grabs another stick and moves up.

Chandu: *Let's process that first— roll the F1's lethality, Mac.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 71 (8 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For F1 GRENADE Target: 15)

Chandu: *Chunks melt away and disperse as the shrapnel blows right behind the amorphous mass...*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Can I hit anything from here without crossfire risk?

Unknown (Mac): Isn't this a large target? we don't just deal full lethality rating to this?

Unknown (Giles): He is technically elevated.

Chandu: *You're technically above the ones in front, hit it.*

Unknown (Mac): Im asking because Nolan has another nade to spare.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Yeah I'm hitting the big fucker with long burst then.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Aim & bodypart: Aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, regular.

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Failure** -> 71 (8 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (3/3) Target: 10)

Chandu: *That's gonna be 16 damage applied on the big blob.*

Unknown (Giles): "Man, fuck, we should've brought a flamethrower," Giles curses to himself as he's fiddling with the dynamite.

Unknown (Mac): "I know!"

Unknown (Fontaine): Fontaine whips around to the blob, eyes wide. "MOTHERFUCKER, CAN'T YOU SEE HOW MASSIVE THAT THING IS? SHOOTING IT AIN'T DOING SHIT! JUST BLOW THE WHOLE JOINT UP AND GET OUT!" Contrary to that, he lets loose a burst anyway.

Chandu: *Hit the roll then lethality rating!*

Chandu: *Assuming it's a long burst here, 2x damage.*

Unknown (Fontaine): Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, huge.

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Success** -> 13 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

Unknown (Fontaine): Unknown (Fontaine) rolls **Failure** -> 15 (6 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) Target: 10)

Unknown (Fontaine): It was worded like it does.

Chandu: *So, what changes? It's still 1 and 5, right?*

Chandu: *-> 12dmg?*

Unknown (Mac): he passed the thing bro

Unknown (Mac): instakill if human

Unknown (Fontaine): Maybe lethality just doesn't work on that thing...

Chandu: *oh... this thing is not human*

Chandu: *DAMAGE APPLIED.*

Chandu: *It doesn't care about the flares, about the grenades, or about anything. Although the little tendrils seem to recoil away from your instinctively, Mac, the large blob appears frenzied by your presence.*

Chandu: *Like YOU specifically, or something with you, is not supposed to be here.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 55 (Rolling Athletics Target: 20%)

Unknown (Mac): "That's right."

Unknown (Mac): "Time to die."

Chandu: *It slowly inches forward...*

Unknown (Mac): Let me blow it down as it does.

Chandu: *Hit the lethality roll, it's so close it's no question whether you hit it.*

Unknown (Mac): Long burst.

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 81 (9 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (1/3) / +PSO-1 Target: 10)

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Failure** -> 78 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Chandu: *It doesn't dare lash at you... yet.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 68 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 41 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Chandu: *The blob itself flings it at you, ignoring its off-balance state.*

Slime of a-Abhi: 1

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls 1d10 -> 9 (Draws a result from the Random Hit Location d10 table)

Chandu: *APPLY 1HP...*

Unknown (Mac): Mac blocks the pathetic whip with his right arm, dropping the empty AK on its sling.

Slime of a-Abhi: Condition Changes Stunned

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'm passing my nade over to Mac, assuming he's still in the clear to grab it after the attack.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Is that fine?

Unknown (Mac): My hands are quite literally empty.

Chandu: *At this point I'm baffled. Hit the roll, fails only on fumble.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls **Failure** -> 90 (Rolling Athletics Target: 70%)

Chandu: *He catches it.*

Chandu: *New F1 in your hand!*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Failure** -> 98 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Chandu: *Why does it not attack, in the face of an existential threat...?*

Unknown (Mavridis): "Vardas, is it done yet?"

Unknown (Vardas): "WE'RE GOOD AFTER THAT LAST ONE!"

Unknown (Giles): "Move the wire here and let's get the fuck outta here!"

Unknown (Mavridis): "Good."

Unknown (Mac): This feels a bit too close for comfort with a grenade, I'm gonna calmly backstep and send this thing home.

Unknown (Mavridis): Sending a long burst into the blog

Chandu: *Hit Lethality only.*

Unknown (Mavridis): Unknown (Mavridis) rolls **Failure** -> 87 (15 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (3/3) / +SUP +PSO-1 Target: 10)

Chandu: *He ties the last of the dynamite together.*

Unknown (Mac): "It's dying. Kill it."

Unknown (Vardas): "SET!"

Unknown (Giles): "Wrap it up, man, it's about to die for real for real!"

Unknown (Mac): "I SAID WE KILL IT!"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "KEEP SHOOTING MOTHERFUCKERS!"

Unknown (Giles): "IT'S RIGHT NEXT TO THE DYNAMITE SUCKA! WE BLOW AND IT DIES!"

Unknown (Mac): I'm getting behind this wall and tossing the grenade in.

Unknown (Mac): Hopefully the guns should clear it out.

Chandu: *Go ahead and roll lethality, we're talking about a soft roll over.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Failure** -> 26 (8 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For F1 GRENADE Target: 15)

Unknown (Giles): Giles is heading to the entrance for the detonator. "Last man out and I blow it!"

Unknown (Giles): "Haul ass!"

Unknown (Mac): "Shoot it first."

Chandu: *You can run to the entrance AT NO RANGE PENALTY, applies for everyone not in relative proximity to the blob.*

Unknown (Mac): "It's standing right there!"

Unknown (Mavridis): "MAN FUCK THIS LETS FUCKING GO!"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "STAND AND FIGHT GOD DAMN IT!"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "It's half-dead you morons!"

Chandu: *Maybe they're getting one of those gut feelings...*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Long burst on big slime.

Chandu: *Lethality only, proceed Bismillah*

SA Bryan Carlyle: Aim & bodypart: Not aimed, no bodypart. Attachments: No attachment(s). Fire rate & range: Short range, long burst. Speed & size: ≤ Normal, huge.

Unknown (Carlyle): Unknown (Carlyle) rolls **Failure** -> 40 (14 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) Target: 10)

Unknown (Mavridis): ALIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIII

Unknown (Fontaine): "It's a fucking slime! Shooting it just stalls it! The tendrils keep sprouting back, as will it! Just run and blow this shit up!" I'm gunning for it.

Unknown (Mac): They won't be partaking in the glory...

Chandu: *Oh, also, Selma followed Giles as he left.*

Unknown (Giles): "Run, bitch, we're blowing this joint!"

Chandu: *What's it gonna do now...*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 11 (Rolling Athletics Target: 20%)

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Failure** -> 79 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 70%)

Unknown (Mac): Can I slash it to death? It's falling apart.

Chandu: *Sure, do you want to try?*

Chandu: *No roll necessary.*

Unknown (Mac): 6

Unknown (Mavridis): hes baiting you BRO HES BAITING YOU

Unknown (Mac): 7 damage?

Chandu: *As you stab at it, your hand becomes ENGULFED by the blob. It makes space for your blade and fist to go inside, then gains consistency to keep them from leaving.*

Chandu: *You do apply what damage applies...*

Unknown (Mac): Condition Changes Restrained

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Failure** -> 34 (Rolling Athletics Target: 20%)

Chandu: *That's not actually the roll.*

Chandu: *It's DEX for 75.*

Slime of a-Abhi: Slime of a-Abhi rolls **Success** -> 62 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

Chandu: *It's going for the easiest target available!*

Slime of a-Abhi: 4

Chandu: *You get a DEX roll to swerve, Mac.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **Success** -> 54 (Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

Chandu: *It goes wide, over your head. It's still consistent.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I want to get a long burst in. From where I stand, hitting Mac shouldn't be a risk.

Chandu: *Hit it. Lethality roll only.*

Unknown (Nolan): Unknown (Nolan) rolls LETHAL -> 9 (19 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For AKMN (2/3) Target: 10)

Unknown (Mac): I'm pulling the flare cord by my teeth and plunging it into this thing if I can.

Chandu: *The mass collapses onto the slithery ground... And as you drop your flare, Mac, the puddles retreat further into darkness.*

Chandu: *They. Are still. Moving.*

Chandu: *...It'll take some time to reform.*

Unknown (Mac): "I don't know about you but I didn't waste all that ammo for nothing."

Unknown (Mac): He says as he reloads.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Come on Mac, let's get the fuck out of here!"

Chandu: *In case it wasn't clear: the goo itself is still alive. It's still moving into crevices, and pooling up. This time even the tendrils are pulling back.*

Unknown (Mac): "Don't you wanna know what it's keeping in there?"

Unknown (Mac): "You don't see shit like this often."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "NO!"

Unknown (Mac): He picks up the flare and one-hands his AK.

Unknown (Mavridis): "VARDAS. WE. ARE. LEAVING. RUN."

Unknown (Vardas): "YEAH."

Unknown (Mavridis): Hauling ass to the exit.

Unknown (Mac): "If you blow me up I'll haunt you."

Unknown (Mavridis): "BITE ME!"

SA Bryan Carlyle: "We've blown up every piece of intel we've came across for the past six months you bunch of ingrates."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Fuck your intel, motherfucker."

Chandu: *The carousel is off for now.*

Unknown (Mac): "Enough."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "You're not killing yourself Mac."

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "GET THE FUCK BACK HERE!"

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Nolan chases after him.

SA Bryan Carlyle: I'm sprinting to catch up with Cillian.

Unknown (Mac): I'm holding a flare.

Chandu: *Inside, Mac, as the fluid reforms, you see that it isn't flowing from one specific point or source.*

Chandu: *Further north is a large pit.*

Chandu: *You can see it well from here. Ancient architecture is recognizable at this point, from Jale's and Selma's explanations to the team. This IS the Hurrian temple, and the slime used to be worshipped here.*

Chandu: *This is its holding place. The mound was erected by the many groups who made war against those who would worship it and feed it with innocent souls.*

Chandu: *Even in your head, despite the resistance, you can hear the voices. The voices of the dead.*

Chandu: *In a myriad of ancient languages... screaming their final words at you. It must be sealed.*

Chandu: *Hit a SANLOSS roll.*

Unknown (Mac): I don't care. I couldn't care less. Anything I can loot before I make this place inaccessible for another millenia?

Chandu: *You get 1 SEARCH roll.*

Unknown (Mac): Unknown (Mac) rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 11 (Rolling Search Target: 40%)

Chandu: *On the floor here, covered in slime, you find some manner of token. It looks like a medallion, one that would be tied around someone's neck.*

Chandu: *It reads incomprehensible Arabic to you. It resembles the artistry of the crafts found in trench #1.*

Chandu: *That makes no sense, though. If this is the Hurrian layer, what is a Seljuk amulet doing here?*

Chandu: *That is all there is.*

Unknown (Mac): I'm pocketing it. No one but me knows, as they didn't dare to see it.

Unknown (Mac): Let's finish this.

Chandu: *ok you walked yourself into that one*

Chandu: *WE'RE LEAVING THEN?*

Unknown (Mac): Yes. Goodbye!

Chandu: *THE CHARGES ARE SET*

SA Bryan Carlyle: "Is that everything? Because the morons outside are gonna blow this place if we waste anymore time."

Chandu: *Walk to the exit.*

Unknown (Mac): "There's nothing down there."

Unknown (Mac): "Just a bunch of cut stone."

Unknown (Mac): "Well. That's it folks."

Unknown (Mac): He stretches.

SA Bryan Carlyle: Am I buying that shit? I wanted to see what was back here too.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: "Stretch outside. Let's fucking go."

Chandu: *The slime is still gathering up further inside. You reckon this is the cue to leave.*

Unknown (Mac): I have no wish for a round two.

Chandu: *I'll just say it: you guys saw him bend over and pick some shit off a pile of rubble.*

Chandu: *You can't tell what it is.*

Unknown (Giles): "WE GOOD?"

Unknown (Mac): "We good."

Unknown (Mac): Where is Selma?

Unknown (Giles): She's right here.

Unknown (Giles): "Let's blow it."

Unknown (Mac): *I'm pulling my mask down and aiming my PB at the bottom of her chin. "You say anything about any of this to anyone, you're done."*

Chandu: *This is what the trench looked like in its final stages, by the way.*

Unknown (Giles): "No one's gonna believe her. But she should probably shut the fuck up anyways."

Selma Aydın: Selma Aydın rolls **Success** -> 10 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

Chandu: *She does nothing but cry and hold her eyes shut.*

Unknown (Mac): "Good. "I'm ruffling her hair in a condescending way and moving on."

Unknown (Mavridis): "Blow it."

Unknown (Giles): "Boy she ain't ever gonna want to dig dirt ever again. Well, she got out alive."

Chandu: *Vardas clicks the detonator.*

Chandu: *EXPLOSION SFX RESTRICTED BY BUDGET*

Unknown (Nolan): "Fuck, my head. Can't hear shit."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: No zombies?

Mule: Condition Changes Dead Dead Dead

05 Ali Karaca: Condition Changes Dead

Chandu: *So, outside. The bodies aren't moving, but some of them aren't where they were left.*

Chandu: *The mules are dead. Clawed at, not eaten.*

SA Michael Giles: "Yeah.... that would've been a problem."

Chandu: *The ground, though humid, is drying up.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Yeah."

Unknown (Nolan): "You pussies ran just to redecorate these bodies?"

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I'm telling Selma that she has 2 minutes to get her shit and seeing if any of the union corpse trucks were left behind with cargo.

Nikolaos Mavridis: "Yeah."

Chandu: *She's straight up unresponsive, Mac. She can barely stand.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: "Be my guest."

SA Michael Giles: We should probably drop her off in front of a Diyarbakir hospital.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Does anyone have a photocamera? I think Nolan did.

Chandu: *He does!*

Unknown (Nolan): I do indeed.

SA Michael Giles: "Let's get her ass to a city and leave her at a hospital."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: A photo of Charles' body would be useful.

Unknown (Nolan): I nod and go for it.

Dimitrios Vardas: "I don't even know..." He rubs his eyes with a hand, stuffing the other in his pocket.

SA Michael Giles: "They all really fuckin' wanted to die, man. A lot of these schmucks fought for no reason at all."

Chandu: *You snap a picture of the charred remains, Nolan. You can photograph anything else at your own leisure.*

Nikolaos Mavridis: "A lot of ouzo."

SA Michael Giles: "The mafia fucks I especially don't understand."

Nikolaos Mavridis: "On me."

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I want him to take a wide angle pic of it so it's not "any corpse".

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: With the backdrop included.

Chandu: *Giles.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: I'll photograph the #2 Trench entrance, and the mercenaries.

Chandu: *As you utter the words "for no reason at all", you tap your assault bag. The bottle of schnapps, full of goo, is inside it.*

Chandu: *Nobody else knows, of course.*

Chandu: *All pictures are taken and in Nolan's custody.*

Chandu: *Anything else?*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Any of the cargo trucks left behind?

SA Michael Giles: I'll keep that 'thang' on me and pass it off to Carstairs later for an IOU or something.

Chandu: *They all bounced. UC survivors and civilians must've taken them.*

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: The clawed donkeys are also photographed.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I wanna take one last look at the storage room.

Chandu: *You can do so without an issue. All of the UC crates are gone except for one, and it's the one with the mummy badly stuffed in it.*

Chandu: *The rest are random archaeological doodads.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Can we carry that to the truck?

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: I have a bad feeling about it.

Chandu: *That can be done by two guys, yes.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Very well. I'm finished.

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: Anyone?

Chandu: *The mummy itself has a strange expression on its face, considering Carlyle stabbed through it a couple of nights ago.*

SA Michael Giles: I'm on Hysterical Girl Protection duty.

Unknown (Carlyle): Has it changed since then?

SA Michael Giles: Let's split.

Nikolaos Mavridis: The two Greeks walk in complete silence back to their MG wielding comrade.

Chandu: *No changes, Carlyle. Looks like the plastic was pulled aside for inspection, then shoved back to its spot once the sabotage was realized.*

Chandu: *Thinking about it, such an abundant UC presence here could be explained by one thing, and one thing only.*

Chandu: *Claude Eury, after being visited by two Federal agents, notified his associates of the meeting, wanting to cover his own ass.*

Chandu: *If there's nothing else to be done, the walk to the truck will be a silent one. Apart from Selma's crying, that is.*

SA Cillian F. MacAllister: He did not know what kind of smoke he had in store for him. Let's call it.

SA Michael Giles: Yeaah well she would've been turned into slime or some shit if we hadn't arrived.

SA Michael Giles: Let's get.

SA Nolan A. al-Attar: Selma had it coming

Chandu: *DELTA GREEN - DE PROFUNDIS*

Chandu: *FIN*